

Prema-vilasa

"The Pastimes of Love"

A poem by Nityananda Dasa

Translated from the Bengali

Translator's note

The *Prema-vilasa* is a Bengali poem by Nityananda Dasa (Balarama Dasa), a disciple of Jahnava Devi, on the lives of Srinivasa Acharya, Narottama Thakura and Shyamananda: their training in Vrindavana under

Jiva Gosvami, the bringing of the Gosvamis' books to Bengal, and their preaching in Gauda, Orissa and Vishnupura.

Source. The edition of 1913 (Calcutta, Bagbazar; public domain), collated from two independent OCR copies (the 1913 edition and its 1999 reprint). **Only the poem itself** is translated: the editors' prefaces and notes are not. Vilasas 1–23 are translated; the twenty-fourth vilasa (a late genealogical addition) and the appendix are not included.

Principles. The payar couplets are translated line by line, without rhyme, and numbered within each vilasa (the original has no numbering); tripadi stanzas, songs and Sanskrit verses are numbered as single units. Corrupt passages are noted in the translator's notes at the end of each vilasa. Names follow GLOSSARY.md.

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Vilasa 1. The Description of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Mahaprabhu's distress that Gauda has lost bhakti; counsel with Sarvabhauma; Jagannatha's command to grant prema to the son of the childless brahmana Chaitanya Dasa; the Earth gives prema to Lakshmipriya; Srinivasa's birth at Chakhandi

1. I did not worship your lotus feet in the Kali age,
I did not see your golden form in the Kali age,
I did not hear the tales of your truth in the Kali age —
O Chaitanya-chandra, you have left me deprived!¹
2. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Glory, glory to the mantra of Hari-nama in the Kali age!²
4. Glory, glory to Srinivasa Acharya Thakura,
whose disciple Ramachandra is the sprout of prema!
5. Glory, glory to Kaviraja Thakura Govinda,
by whose virtues the beings of the seven islands rejoice!
6. Glory, glory to the listeners — give your attention,
you whose very life the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will become.
7. How the birth of Acharya Thakura came about —
listen, brothers, with devotion and a steady heart.
8. Mahaprabhu sent Nityananda Prabhu to Gauda,
and he flooded Gauda with prema-bhakti.
9. All the Vaishnavas who came from Gauda
Mahaprabhu questioned in every detail.
10. Some said: "In Gauda there is no Hari-nama;
there is no deliverance for good people or for bad."
11. Some said: "Acharya Gosani has left bhakti
and everywhere makes people accept mukti as the chief thing."
12. Some said: "He has no word but mukti;
speaking of mukti, Gosani has flooded the world."
13. As he listened, the Lord's anger arose,
and the grief of separation from Nityananda grew in him.
14. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
they wished to speak, and there was joy in their hearts.
15. "Come in, come in, it is good that you two have come!
Gauda has become empty of bhakti — hear the reason.
16. Advaita Acharya, the very form of Ishvara,
has left bhakti and expounds the five kinds of mukti."³
17. I cannot understand Advaita's mind.
Tell me, both of you, how bhakti is to be kept.

18. I cannot believe that he teaches mukti,
for he is a chief participant in these pastimes.⁴
19. I hear it from people's mouths, but I am not convinced:
to expound mukti, leaving bhakti, is not his intent."
20. At this time a letter came from Nityananda:
"Leaving the path of bhakti, the Acharya preaches mukti."
21. On receiving the letter the Lord was greatly alarmed;
holding the letter in his own hand he went for darshan.
22. With his devotees the Lord went into the temple
and beside Garuda⁵ beheld the Lord with joy in his heart.
23. At that time Sarvabhauma Bhattacharya came;
seeing him, the Lord was overcome with ecstasy.
24. Crying "Bhakti, bhakti!" the Lord was filled with prema
and, rejecting the explanations of mukti, began to extol bhakti.
25. Embracing the Bhattacharya, he came out
and, reaching Mishra's residence,⁶ grew somewhat calmer.
26. Nityananda Prabhu's letter was in his hand.
"Read the letter, Bhattacharya," the Lord commanded.
27. Reading the letter, the Bhattacharya flew into a great rage:
"It seems no one in Gauda has any understanding!
28. Who is this who rejects bhakti and preaches mukti?
The three of us will go to that place.
29. In debate, Prabhu, I will silence him,
and if he is obstinate I will bind him and bring him here."⁷
30. At the Bhattacharya's words the Lord's heart rejoiced:
"There will be no hindrance to bhakti — listen, Mahashaya.
31. One letter under my own signature will go to Advaita,
and another he will write to Sri Nityananda Prabhu."
32. Saying "Good, good," they settled this plan firmly
and sent the letters to Gauda by the hand of Vaishnavas.
33. Hearing this, the high-minded Bhattacharya
joined his palms and told of his own former plight:
34. "Studying logic, I knew not a speck of bhakti;
now, leaving the explanations of mukti, I find a special joy in bhakti.
35. How long I spent chewing the dry oil-cake of logic!
Then I came to talk with Gopinatha Acharya.
36. He is not ill-minded nor under maya — he is the Lord's devotee;
how should he not know the truth of the Lord's own nature?
37. Through my bond with him the Lord showed me mercy:
all my wrong thinking went, and bhakti was born in my heart.
38. He is very dear to the Lord, a king among devotees;
his work is to bring the world to understanding."

39. All went off to their own places,
yet joy did not arise in the Lord's mind.
40. The more he thought, the more his anxiety grew:
"Living beings have become empty of bhakti!" — and fear arose in him.
41. "How will bhakti remain upon the earth?
I want to send some prema and the Name to Gauda.
42. While Nityananda is here, how is this to be done?
And when he is gone, how will bhakti remain among the beings?
43. To reveal the scriptures of bhakti, Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, went to Vrindavana.
44. That bhakti I want to reveal in Gauda;
I want a vessel to be born who is prema in form."
45. "Avani! Avani!"⁸ the Lord called out,
and the Earth with joined palms came before the Lord.
46. "Listen, listen, Earth, and be attentive:
bring a vessel who is prema in form and give him a dwelling."
47. "The prema that you, my Lord, have left in my keeping —
give the command, and I will make it manifest in a form."
48. Delighted, the Lord gave the Earth his command,⁹
but of who was worthy to be the vessel, and of his name, nothing was said.¹⁰
49. At this time Svarupa and Ramananda Raya came to the Lord;
bowing to the Lord, they wished to speak to him.
50. "What am I to do, what will happen? It is good that you have come" —
and he told them all that had passed with the Earth.
51. Crying "Prema, prema!" the Lord was overcome
and, calling "Nityananda!", began to weep.
52. The Lord fell senseless; the third watch¹¹ went by;
in a sweet voice Svarupa sang Hari-nama to him.
53. On hearing Hari-nama the Lord came to himself:
"Come, Svarupa, let us go and see the Lord."
54. At this time Sarvabhauma appeared before the Lord;
seeing Sarvabhauma, the Lord was very glad.
55. "It is good that you have come; sit here.
There is a special matter — listen carefully.
56. Advaita Acharya has put away the path of bhakti.
What am I to say, what am I to do — tell me, Bhattacharya."
57. Hearing of this hindrance to bhakti, the Bhatta was much grieved,
and then he spoke at Mahaprabhu's feet:
58. "Advaita Acharya is the lord of the world;
such words will never come from his mouth.
59. Some insolent people¹² came and told this to the Lord.
Bring those people before me!"

60. They searched, but those people could not be found,
and the Bhatta declared them to be great ignoramuses.¹³
61. "Listen, listen, Bhattacharya, I will tell you of the past:
ever since I left Navadvipa, he has been in great sorrow.
62. I cannot tell what is in his mind in that sorrow:
to frighten me he acts as he pleases.
63. He has the power to do anything:
what he does comes to pass and is never in vain.
64. I have faith in his word,
and I cannot go against his command.
65. Devise a plan, then, so that his command is not slighted
and that, by this plan, prema is preserved hereafter."
66. The Bhattacharya said: "Prabhu, while Nityananda is here,
while he is present, prema will meet no obstacle.
67. What will happen when he is gone — what can I say?
Do whatever is in your mind.
68. Of this, Prabhu, my own Mayavada is witness:
leaving mukti, I expound bhakti by your grace.
69. By seeing you, Prabhu, my bondage was destroyed,
and leaving mukti I became a servant on the path of bhakti.
70. The people of the Kali age are very wicked,
and the chief cause of it is the rule of the yavana kings.¹⁴
71. All that the kings' rule had brought, he did away with,
and he revealed the great medicine, the mantra of Hari-nama.
72. By the mere shadow of the Name he destroyed sins;
Nityananda, your own portion, established bhakti.
73. Such a Nityananda Prabhu you sent to Gauda —
why then do you begin to worry about the future?"
74. "All that is true; but listen with attention:
I sent Nityananda off together with the devotees,
75. I myself parted from Nityananda.
What am I to do — give me your counsel."
76. "No one can counsel you better
than One — in Nilachala there is Jagannatha Raya."
77. "The Bhatta Mahashaya has given a fine solution:
without Jagannatha this cannot be settled."
78. Having so resolved, they all went for darshan
and prayed that prema might be preserved hereafter:
79. "You are an ocean of compassion, most merciful.
We pray to you, Lord — be sure to answer.
80. In the Kali age you descended in the form of Jagannatha;
seeing you and believing, people have been delivered.

81. With the sweetness and fragrance of your prasada you flooded the land,
making the varnas and ashramas and even the chandalas one.
82. In this way let the pastimes of Radha and Krishna spread,
and in granting favour or punishment let no one weigh who is worthy."¹⁵
83. The fourteen-cubit swinging garland¹⁶ broke from the Lord's neck;
the pujari brought it and held it out before the Lord.
84. Delighted, the Lord came back to his lodging,
and his heart was filled with joy beyond measure.
85. Free from worry, he lay down to rest,
and Jagannatha came to his bedside.
86. Smiling, Jagannatha said to him:
"Is my power so very much greater than yours?"
87. For a long time now there has been a brahmana;
childless, he came to pray for a son.
88. Whenever he came for darshan he begged for the boon of a son,
always weeping, with an anguished heart.
89. Seeing the brahmana so distressed, I was moved to great compassion
and, being pleased, granted him the boon of a son.
90. His name is Chaitanya Dasa Acharya;
from him will come that most worthy vessel, the embodiment of prema."¹⁷
91. You shall entrust the prema to him,
so that the brahmana grieves no more.
92. Lakshmipriya is his wife, the daughter of Balarama¹⁸ —
virtuous, devoted to her husband, most blessed."
93. At that moment Mahaprabhu awoke,
and calling "Jagannatha!" he wept a long while.
94. Calling Kashi Mishra, the Lord asked him:
"Show me the Gaudiya Chaitanya Dasa.
95. Jagannatha has given me a command concerning him;
take pains and bring him quickly."
96. Mishra said: "Prabhu, many days have passed;
weeping, the brahmana went back to his own country."
97. The Lord said: "Do you know where his home is?"
Mishra said: "I will find it out for certain."
98. At this time Jagadananda came from Vrindavana,
and the Lord began to ask him about Sanatana's welfare.
99. He said: "All are in perfect fulfilment and bliss,"
and told the Lord how each one was.
100. "After seeing Mother's feet I came to Navadvipa,
and then I came to Shantipur, to the Acharya.
101. At my leave-taking Gosani gave me a command:
'What I say, repeat it to Him.'¹⁹

102. And he spoke a riddle."²⁰ Hearing this, Mahaprabhu said:
"Words such as he spoke I have never heard."
103. Svarupa and others were there together with Mahaprabhu;
hearing the riddle, they all began to laugh.
104. From that day the Lord's condition changed:
the malady of separation from Krishna grew twofold.
105. "What was said has come to pass"²¹ — you two have heard it.
Consider how prema may be preserved.
106. Jagannatha has commanded me to see the brahmana;
take pains to bring him — I wish to send him to his country."
107. Meanwhile the Earth could not bear the weight of prema,
and an earthquake struck all of Nilachala-puri.
108. Day and night Nilachala shook.
"This is no earthquake, brothers — it is Chaitanya doing all this!
109. Earlier Chaitanya gave prema to the ocean
and flooded Nilachala-puri with prema.
110. The ocean, it seems, could not hold that prema;
taking the prema from it, he gave it to the Earth.
111. The Earth cannot hold it and is shaking;
houses may collapse and people may die!
112. All this time we have lived in Nilachala, brothers —
and now Chaitanya-chandra has come and does such things!"
113. They all took counsel together on what should be done:
"Let us go to a land where everyone's life will be safe."
114. One says: "There is no land apart from the earth;
come what may, I shall stay right here."
115. One says: "You have no sons or children,
and besides, you are poor and own no property —
116. for fear of what would you leave Nilachala?
Either way we shall all die.
117. If Jagannatha protects us in this calamity,
then easily, brothers, we shall remain in the world."
118. One says: "Brother, what will Jagannatha do?
Chaitanya's rasa, brother, will only grow twofold!"
119. One says: "Let us all gather together,
go to Sri Krishna Chaitanya and lay it before him."
120. Saying "Good, good," they all gathered together
and arrived at Mishra's door.
121. The crowd made a great uproar at the door,
and the Lord came out with Svarupa and the others.
122. Seeing the Lord, the distressed people of Nilachala —
children, old men, young men, householders and ascetics — cried out:

123. "When the city was floating in the water, you saved it;
now the city is shaking — a calamity has come.
124. This time save us, Lord Gaurachandra!
With what mantra have you made the earth unsteady?
125. There is none but you to save us in calamity;
in fear we have come to plead with you.
126. You are the purifier of the fallen, most merciful;
do not forsake us who have taken refuge in Jagannatha."²²
127. At this time the pujari, bringing Jagannatha's prasada,
came to where the Lord was.
128. Seeing the prasada, Mahaprabhu rose,
bowed down and placed the prasada beside him.
129. The pujari said: "Prabhu, I cannot perform the service:
whenever I lay my hands on Jagannatha, my whole body spins."²³
130. What am I to do? Save us, Prabhu — the service has stopped!
In fear I have come to tell you."
131. Then the Lord called the Earth:
"For some days stay still."
132. Hearing what people were saying, the pujari was afraid:
"It is Advaita Mahashaya who has landed us in this calamity!"
133. With joined palms the pujari addressed the Lord.
"Do your service," said the Lord, and he laid his hands on Jagannatha's body.
134. Dismissing the pujari, the Lord said before the people:
"Go, go, brothers, all of you go home in peace.
135. There will be no earthquake; I will pray to Jagannatha,
and I will beg it of the Earth as alms."
136. Humbly dismissing all the people,
he began to think about the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa.
137. Thinking so, he called the Earth to mind;
the Earth came and bowed to the Lord.
138. "What is your command, Prabhu?" the Earth asked.
The Lord asked where Chaitanya Dasa lived.
139. The Earth said: "Prabhu, many bear that name;
how shall I know for certain?"
140. The Lord said: "For the sake of a son, before Jagannatha,
for a whole year he prayed with body and mind.
141. That Chaitanya Dasa you must seek out;
the father of his wife Lakshmipriya is Balarama Dasa."²⁴
142. "As you command," said the Earth and departed,
and on the third day she came and reported to the Lord:
143. "He lives at Chakhandi, very pure in conduct;
in his body there is no trace of sin.

144. For the sake of a son he began a purashcharana,²⁵
and soon he left, entrusting it to Jagannatha."
145. The Lord said: "Earth, you have been a great help:
Jagannatha has kept his word about prema firm.
146. Listen, listen, Earth, listen with care:
take the prema and give it to Lakshmipriya.
147. Give her all the prema, keep nothing back.
My word is true — you must carry it out."²⁶
148. Overjoyed, the Earth began to dance,
brought the prema and laid it before Lakshmipriya.
149. And here the Lord, free from worry, began kirtana
and started to dance in the courtyard of Jagannatha's temple.
150. Before Jagannatha, with joined palms, the Lord
wept aloud, crying "Srinivasa! Srinivasa!"
151. Seeing this, Jagannatha laughed with delight
and sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
152. Seeing Jagannatha laugh, the Lord laughed too,
and by his command sent prema to Chaitanya Dasa.
153. "From this a son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him there will be a great play of prema."²⁷
154. To reveal the various scriptures I sent Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, to Sri Vrindavana.
155. In Rupa's scriptures the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be revealed,
and by command they will be entrusted to Srinivasa."
156. Having prayed to Jagannatha, he came back to his lodging
and joyfully summoned Kashi Mishra.
157. He took secret counsel with Svarupa and Ramananda;
having received Jagannatha's command, his mind was at ease.
158. "Tell us, tell us, Prabhu, give us the news!" —
"In Chaitanya Dasa's house prema will be made known.
159. In Gauda Nityananda Raya is anxious;
send him a letter and set his mind at rest."
160. "Good, good," and the Lord wrote in his own hand:
"Hari-nama sankirtana will be in every house.
161. You shall send a letter to Advaita Acharya,
that he should count the state of mukti without bhakti as worthless.
162. Do not worry about me hereafter;
the world will float in Hari-nama sankirtana.
163. By Jagannatha's command a son will be born by a boon,
who will flood the world with the pastimes of Radha and Krishna.
164. Near the bank of the Ganga is a place called Chakhandi;
there lives a worthy brahmana named Chaitanya Dasa.

165. To him a son, Srinivasa, will be born, prema in form;
he will appear in the form of a Vaishnava."
166. Having written the letter thus, he sent it to Gauda,
and having made prema manifest he remained at peace.
167. At this time a letter came from Sanatana;
he wrote in full about the arrival of Gopala Bhatta.
168. Hearing of Gopala's arrival in Vrindavana,
the Lord was overjoyed together with his devotees.
169. "Listen, listen, Svarupa and Ramananda, to the news:
Gopala Bhatta has come to Vrindavana."
170. The Lord spoke much of the Bhatta's greatness,
and all rejoiced to hear it from the Lord's mouth.
171. The Lord said: "Consider now what I should do:
what thing of unprecedented sweetness shall I send?"
172. I am a poor sannyasi; I have no wealth;
all I have is my cord²⁸ and a seat to sit on.
173. In them is my power — hear the reason;
these two things I will give to the Bhatta,
174. so that he may sit on it in Rupa's company.
I will have Svarupa write the letter."
175. But to Sanatana the Lord himself wrote in his own hand:
"Let Rupa take up the describing of the pastimes in scriptures.
176. This letter of mine, read it out to Rupa;
hearing it, your hearts will rejoice.
177. In Gauda I will cause a jewel of a vessel to be born;
when his body is grown and fit, I will send him to you later.
178. His name is Srinivasa, born in a brahmana family;
he will make known in Gauda the very heart of Radha and Krishna's pastimes.
179. When I am no longer present, he will go to Vrindavana;
you shall entrust your books to him.
180. To Gauda I have sent Nityananda,
and with him Ramadasa, Gadadhara and Sundarananda.
181. For a son Chaitanya Dasa stayed in Nilachala;
Jagannatha gave prema, and he accepted it.
182. I too am coming soon to see you all;
make a secluded place for me in some grove.
183. Only Svarupa and Ramananda Raya are with me;
it is by the kindness of these two that my life is kept.
184. I am sending you the seat by a Vaishnava's hand,
and through Ramananda I have given him money for the road."
185. Taking the cord and the seat, the Vaishnava went to Vrindavana.
That day Rupa and Sanatana were together.

186. On receiving the letter the two brothers rejoiced,
and seeing the cord and the seat they swooned in prema.
187. Placing the cord round their necks, they wept a long while
and fell to the ground, crying "Gaurahari!"
188. "Shall we ever again see, Lord, the face of Gora-chand?
Not hearing your sweet words, our breasts are breaking!"
189. Rolling on the ground, they wept, clasping the seat to their breasts,
and perceived the sweet fragrance of his holy body.
190. At that moment Bhugarbha and Lokanatha arrived
and fell to the ground, a hand pressed to the breast.
191. In passing I will write something — listen, hearers —
a mere particle about Lokanatha's renunciation.
192. With no companion at all, he sits in seclusion;
with eyes closed, now he weeps and now he laughs.
193. Lokanatha Gosani is most deeply dear to the Lord;
Rupa and Sanatana honour him constantly.
194. Such will be his disciple Narottama;
he will make prema manifest on earth.
195. Narottama by name, a resident of Garerhat,²⁹
the son of Krishnananda Raya, a treasury of prema.
196. As Rupa and Sanatana are one body,
so, know for certain, are Narottama and Srinivasa.
197. Narottama, whose name Gauranga himself gave —
what shall I say of his virtues? They are all beyond compare.
198. That same power, those same pastimes he spread abroad;
who can be compared with such a chosen one?
199. The virtues of the two Mahashayas cannot be written —
of those who made prema manifest in Gauda.
200. The virtues of the two Mahashayas that are recorded
I shall write later, following in their wake.
201. Now I shall write of the pain of separation that befell;
seeing it, how could a poor, wretched person keep alive?
202. Seeing Sanatana's state, Rupa was stunned:
"If you become like this, everyone will die!"
203. You are the Lord's second body, Mahashaya;
seeing you so distraught, who can keep his senses?"
204. With many efforts Rupa brought him back to consciousness,
but the dreadful trembling of separation grew twofold.
205. From that day Sanatana had no rest:
the malady of separation from Gauranga grew twofold.
206. Seeing Sanatana, Rupa grew anxious
lest Govinda leave this Vrindavana empty.³⁰

207. Regaining his composure, Rupa took the seat
and went reverently to the Bhatta.
208. The two brothers, carefully holding the two things to their breasts,
went in great happiness to the Bhatta's lodging.
209. Prostrating themselves, they gave him the seat and the cord,
and reading the letter they made him hear the sweetness of prema.
210. Hearing the honour the letter did him, the Bhatta swooned,
and then, clasping the seat to his breast, he began to weep.
211. With care Sri Rupa steadied him somewhat,
and on seeing Sanatana the Bhatta grew calm.
212. Sanatana said: "Listen, Bhatta Gosani:
at the time of discourse sit on this seat — there is no fault in it."
213. "How can I sit on the Lord's seat?" —
"The Lord has commanded it — how can you disregard it?"
214. "The Lord's command is mightiest," said Sri Rupa;
and placing the cord round his neck, the Bhatta sat on the seat.
215. All their hearts were filled with joy,
and they went off each to his own grove.
216. That night, as Sanatana slept, in the guise of a dream
Gaurangachandra, embracing his neck, said:
217. "There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa,
endowed with the greatest steadiness and other virtues.
218. You are my second body, Sanatana;
through Srinivasa you shall accomplish my purpose."
219. Having seen the dream, Sanatana rejoiced,
and in the morning, sitting in the assembly, he began to tell it.
220. Sanatana said: "Listen to a wondrous account:
the Lord is going to depart, and there is a reason for it.
221. The pastimes of Radha and Krishna, through sankirtana,
the Lord savours together with Svarupa and the others.
222. The pastimes that he will describe by infusing his power into Rupa
he will make known by sending a vessel.
223. There is a brahmana youth named Srinivasa;
through him the Lord will spread these pastimes in Gauda.
224. As prema in form he will cause him to be born in Gauda,
and Srinivasa will come here when the Lord's pastimes are ended.
225. You, staying in Vrindavana, will see him;
whether I am alive or not, he will be seen.
226. To see one chosen by Chaitanya's mercy is a matter of fortune,
and I suppose that such fortune is not mine.
227. If Chaitanya's mercy rests on everyone,
then in due time you will all see him in your midst."

228. The Bhatta said: "The Lord will send such a treasure —
if fortune allows, I shall see him with my own eyes."
229. Rupa said: "I have laboured by the Lord's power;
my labour will bear fruit if he comes soon.
230. While I live I will entrust everything to him,
and teaching him all the books, I will make him a pandit."
231. Thus all rejoiced together,
knowing that he would deliver the poor, the wretched and the wicked.
232. From then on Gopala Bhatta made it his rule
to keep all his observances with the cord tied round his neck.
233. One day in the assembly he raised the matter
of what he had seen of Srinivasa in a dream that night:
234. "In Chaitanya Dasa's house, in Lakshmipriya's womb...
As soon as he is born he will proclaim the name of Radha and Krishna,
235. and joyfully he will deliver all, down to the chandalas."
It turned out that they had all seen this in a dream.
236. All at once it dawned on them all:
they had seen a joyful dream and understood its reason.
237. Yet all were anxious about the Lord:
"We cannot understand what he intends by this."
238. So Sanatana and Rupa remained anxious:
when would Srinivasa come, the embodiment of prema?
239. And in Nilachala Svarupa's mind was uneasy:
night and day he saw inauspicious dreams.
240. One day Svarupa found the Lord alone
and asked him: "Who is this Srinivasa?
241. Tell me his virtues in detail, Prabhu;
merely to hear of his virtues gladdens the heart."
242. On hearing the name, Svarupa's joy grew,³¹
and he wrote a letter to Sanatana once more.
243. A wondrous letter he wrote to Sanatana:
"Reading it, he will understand the whole matter."
244. Meanwhile, in his own house, the brahmana Chaitanya Dasa
was performing purashcharana for the sake of a son.
245. Seven purashcharanas he performed near the Ganga,
and in a dream a command came to him from One of golden form:
246. "A wondrous son named Srinivasa will be born,
and through him prema will be made manifest."
247. To Lakshmipriya the command was given with a hand laid on her head:
"A wondrous son will be born — remain joyful."
248. At the mere touch of the Lord's hand she became mad with prema;
coming to herself, Lakshmipriya began to weep.

249. Tears, trembling, hair standing on end — and she lost all composure:
Lakshmipriya's body was filled with prema.
250. Lakshmipriya said: "Acharya, pay heed:
see, a great being dwells within my body.
251. I laugh, I weep, I dance, I sing — such is my state;
all sorrow is gone, I tell you.
252. Do not go anywhere and leave me;
perform nama-sankirtana at home day and night."
253. The Acharya said: "How shall we get by?³²
There is no wealth in the house — what shall we eat?"
254. Lakshmipriya said: "I have gained great wealth:
your poverty is at an end, your life is fulfilled."
255. The village had suffered oppression from the ruler and many troubles;
now it had all calmed down, and the ruler had become well-disposed.
256. The zamindar had left the village and was living in another,
but now that the trouble was over he was to return to his own place.
257. As soon as he³³ entered the womb, hearts were filled with prema and joy,
and all fear of the yavanas went away without effort.
258. Until then people had kept saying "Durga, Shiva";
now no one uttered any name but Krishna's.
259. There was an old brahmana there of wicked ways;
he whispered slander into the zamindar's ear:
260. "The village will be ruined, brother, by this name;
forbid the people!" — so he came and said.
261. "They have left Shiva and Durga and keep saying...³⁴
I will plunder their homes — by what strength will they keep them?"
262. Calling the kotal³⁵ and a drummer, Durgadas said:
"Let them say 'Shiva, Durga!' — or else it is ruin for all!"
263. The drummer struck his drum for the first time —
and the drum began to sound "Radha-Krishna"!
264. Children dance in prema, saying "Radha-Krishna";
women dance, with longing in their hearts.
265. At the sound of the drum all the people became intoxicated
and, saying "Radha-Krishna," began to dance.
266. The drummer, possessed by prema, dances, weeps and laughs;
the boys dance and tumble down.
267. At the sound of the drum all the people were intoxicated
and danced merrily along with the children.
268. Dancing, they came to Chaitanya Dasa's house;
seeing the zamindar, the brahmana grew anxious at heart.
269. With honour he seated him on a seat,
and in his flurry knew not what to do or say.

270. Courteously he dismissed the people³⁶
and with honour had Durgadas bathe.
271. A great deal of food came together,
and the Acharya brought it and set it before Durgadas.
272. Seeing the provisions, Durgadas was pleased,
and seeing such things in a poor man's house he smiled gently.
273. Having eaten, the Raya stayed in the Acharya's house
and lay down to rest with joy in his heart.
274. In the night came the sound of khol and kartals;
heavy with sleep, at the mere hearing of the sound
275. he awoke — but could hear nothing more;
and the Raya fell senseless where he was.
276. Lakshmi priya says: "Acharya, attend:
two golden children are dancing in sankirtana!"
277. The two golden children together,
laughing and laughing, laid their feet upon her head.³⁷
278. And the command came: "For ten months take care of yourself;
once again I shall dance in your courtyard."³⁸
279. Durgadas, sitting up on his bed, beheld it;
he heard every word — he saw it in a dream.
280. Intoxicated with prema, the Raya cried out and wept,
fell to the ground and could not be calmed.
281. In haste the Acharya lifted him and took him in his arms:
"Be steady, Raya," he said to him gently.
282. "I do not know what sound I heard ringing in my ears;
when I came to, I do not know where it had gone."
283. The Acharya said: "In a dream I saw what those two were like;
my sleep broke — where has such a treasure gone?"
284. The Raya said: "It was no dream — why do you dissemble?
Be kind and tell me; it will make me very happy."
285. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are a very sober man;
why should seeing a dream unsettle you so?"
286. The Raya said: "It was no dream; I saw it with my own eyes:
I found the Creator, and he left me bereft."
287. The Raya said: "Acharya, I will confess to you:
I have forgotten my own chosen deity, and I do not know why.
288. Having seen the dream I have forgotten my chosen deity:
the name of Radha and Krishna has entered my body.
289. To abandon one's chosen deity is death, as the shastras attest;
I have heard this word from the shastras; it cannot be otherwise."
290. The Acharya said: "Raya, you are very learned;
consider, and do whatever your mind accepts."

291. The Raya said: "I have heard people say
that in Navadvipa the Creator was born in the form of Gaura.
292. That same Creator has entered my heart,
and entering in the night, he made me forget my own deity.
293. That same Creator danced in your courtyard:
I saw two golden ones in my dream.
294. What am I to do? Give me your counsel."
The Acharya said: "You are the ruler, and I am under your protection."
295. The Raya said: "I have told you everything as it was;
it is in my mind to take the mantra of Radha and Krishna."
296. So saying, the Raya went to his residence,
and set his mind on taking a guru in a worthy place.
297. Finding a worthy place, the Raya received instruction.
Merely from his entering the womb, such was the fruit!
298. To such a Srinivasa's feet I bow:
from the womb he flooded the world with the name of Radha and Krishna.³⁹
299. In Navadvipa the Lord could not make every being take the Name,
but Srinivasa from the womb made them take it in Chakhandi.⁴⁰
300. Even pashandis openly take the name of Krishna —
so great a dawning of the Lord through Srinivasa!
301. There has been no such avatara, brothers, in any yuga;
yet we, not honouring the two brothers, feed upon poison.
302. Worship, worship, O brothers, Chaitanya and Nitai:
such a merciful Thakura I have never seen.
303. Meanwhile Lakshmipriya and the Acharya rejoiced:
the bodies of both were filled with prema.
304. Whoever got anything anywhere brought it and gave it;
poverty vanished, and everyone was glad.
305. When ten months and ten days were complete,
at an auspicious moment the boy was born.
306. On the full moon of Vaishakha,⁴¹ on an auspicious day at an auspicious moment,
Lakshmipriya beheld her son's face.
307. The Acharya entered the room,
and seeing his son's face he was filled with great joy.
308. Brahmanas recite the Vedas, bards their songs of praise;⁴²
in the sky the gods utter blessings.
309. The women raise the auspicious ulu-ulu cry;
old men and children dance and clap their hands.
310. Lowing, the cows with their calves
roam about with tails held high and grass in their mouths.
311. The villagers bring gifts, filling their plates;
everyone gives, rejoicing greatly.

312. Durgadas Raya, bringing musicians and instruments,
came to the Acharya's house uttering blessings.
313. Coming into the courtyard, he began to dance at length
and distributed many gifts to the brahmanas.
314. No sound was heard but "Radha-Krishna,"
and a voice from the sky said: "Sing, sing!"
315. *Today there is no end to my joy:
after so many days Madhava is in my house!* (refrain)⁴³
316. Having this song sung, he began to dance;
there was no bound to the joy, and so the day ended.
317. With his people the Raya went back to his home,
and brahmanas and good folk came thronging.
318. For the son's welfare they made offerings to the brahmana:
whatever wealth they had at home they brought and laid before him.
319. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the first vilasa, called "The Description of the Birth of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura".

1. A Sanskrit verse prefixed to the poem; in the 1913 edition it is preceded by the usual invocation "Obeisance to Sri Krishna-Chaitanya-chandra".
2. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; in the 1999 reprint its first line has dropped out.
3. The five kinds of mukti are salokya, sarshiti, sarupya, samipya and sayujya.
4. The beginning of the line is corrupt in both copies ("dṛā" / "ḍi ri"); translated by the general sense ("I cannot believe").
5. The Garuda pillar (garuda-stambha) in the Jagannatha temple at Puri, beside which Mahaprabhu used to behold the Deity.
6. Kashi Mishra, in whose house Mahaprabhu lived at Puri.
7. Variant: "if he behaves unreasonably, I will bind him and bring him."
8. Avani, "Earth"; the Earth (Prithivi) appears here as a goddess.
9. Variant: "embraced the Earth".
10. The sense of the line is unclear; perhaps "nothing was said of the measure of the vessel's worth, nor of his name".
11. A watch (prahara) is about three hours; the third watch of the day falls in the afternoon.
12. Variant: "some ignorant people".
13. Both copies read "baḍa ajñā sei loka bhaṭṭa ānāila", literally "the Bhatta had those very ignorant people brought"; translated by the sense.
14. So according to the variant reading; the main text has "the chief cause of it is the rule of the kings".
15. That is, that grace (prema) be given to all without distinction.
16. The long garland hanging from Jagannatha's neck; its falling is a sign of the Deity's assent.
17. Literally "that most worthy vessel, full of the form of prema"; the future son, Srinivasa, is meant.
18. Balarama (Balarama Dasa), a brahmana, Lakshmipriya's father; not to be confused with Balarama as Nityananda. In the 1913 edition this couplet is set in brackets.
19. Variant: "repeat it to the Lord".
20. Advaita's famous "riddle" (tarja), sent through Jagadananda (cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Antya 19): "Tell the Baul that the people have gone mad; tell the Baul that rice no longer sells in the market..." — a hint that Mahaprabhu's mission was complete.
21. In Sanskrit in the original: "yat kathitaṃ tat phalitaṃ".
22. Variant: "do not forsake us who have taken shelter with you".
23. Variant: "trembles".

24. In the 1913 edition this line too is set in brackets.
25. Purashcharana, a vow of repeating a mantra a great number of times for a specific end.
26. Variant of the second line: "You will not be able to bear this weight of prema."
27. "Premera vilasa", a play on the title of the poem (Prema-vilasa).
28. Dor, a sannyasi's waist-cord (sometimes understood as a cord of beads).
29. Garerhat (Gaderhat), the district where Kheturi, Narottama's home, lay.
30. That is, lest Sanatana leave his body; Govinda here is the Deity of Vrindavana served by Rupa and Sanatana; the sense of the line is somewhat unclear.
31. Variant: "anxiety".
32. The 1999 edition reads "nidrā kemane haiba", "how shall I sleep?"; in the 1913 edition the word is corrupt. Translated by the sense of the second line.
33. Srinivasa.
34. The line is corrupt in both copies; only the discernible sense is given.
35. The kotal was the village watchman, who announced orders to the people by beat of drum.
36. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
37. Literally "held the feet at the head"; it may also be understood as "bowed their heads to her feet".
38. Couplets 276–278 are set in brackets in the 1913 edition.
39. Variant: "spreading bhakti, he delivered the world".
40. Variant of the second line: "the Mahashaya would be born to deliver the world".
41. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition. The full moon of Vaishakha falls in April–May.
42. "Raybar", songs of praise sung by court bards (bhats).
43. A song (pada); cf. Vidyapati's well-known line "cira-dine mādharma mandire mora".
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Vilasa 2. The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya's Birth

Chakhandi rejoices at Srinivasa's birth: the father gazes on his son's face; music, dancing and crowds of people who forget their sorrows

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Hearing of the son's birth, people forgot their sorrow and grief;
men and women set out to see him.
The lame, the dull-witted and the blind run along, singing the virtues of Radha and Krishna,
forgetting home and sons.¹
4. The Acharya went into the room, his eyes brimming with joy:
he beholds his son's moon-like face.
Tears flow from his eyes; gazing, he is beside himself,
again and again offering up his life for him.²
5. Having seen, he cannot come away; tears stream from both his eyes:
"Blessed is the mother who bore him in her womb!"
Whether gandharva or kinnara — there is none to compare him with;
and he sank into the ocean of prema.
6. The dancing girls dance, and all the dancers
dance and sing in the sweetest voices.
The bhats recite many wondrous pastimes of Krishna,
their bodies thrilling with delight.
7. Mridanga, jhanjh and dhol — the music is a tumult;
kartals and pakhoajs are played.
Mahuri and pinaka sound, damp and saptasvara thunder;³
the sound pierces the sky.
8. The blind and the deaf count themselves blessed,
yet they too reproach Providence:
"I would have gazed my fill — in such sorrow I die!
O Fate, you are pitiless!"
9. So saying they dance and sing, weep and roll on the ground,
exulting and crying "Radha-Krishna!"
Hundreds of thousands of people run, casting off fear, sorrow and grief;
many worldly men and pandits run too.
10. Bodies were filled with joy, homes were filled with wealth and grain,
and all swooned in prema.⁴
11. Such is the birth of Srinivasa — I have told it to you, brothers;
whoever hears it, his life is fulfilled.
Nityananda Dasa in his song will distribute the wealth of prema,
to purify his own body.

12. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the second vilasa, called "The Description of the Festival of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's Birth".

1. Stanzas 3–11 are in tripadi metre.

2. "Nichhiya nichhiya": the nichhani rite, in which one circles the hand round a child as though giving up one's own life for it, to ward off misfortune.

3. Mahuri, a reed wind instrument like the oboe; pinaka, a stringed instrument; damph, a frame drum; saptasvara, an instrument "of seven notes".

4. The stanza survives only as a half; in the 1913 edition its opening words ("ānande purila deha") have been displaced to the top of the page.

Vilasa 3. The Interruption of Srinivasa's Studies

The author's address on the cause of his writing; Srinivasa's childhood — the first rice and the sacred thread; the break in his studies and the boy's grief; his teacher Dhananjaya admits that the pupil has surpassed him; Sarasvati, by Chaitanya's command, bestows all learning on Srinivasa

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya Acharya, glory, glory!
Glory, glory to Lakshmipriya of compassionate heart!
2. Glory, glory to the listeners — listen with care,
you whose life's treasure is the pastimes of Radha and Krishna's prema.
3. Of one shortcoming of mine I will write once:¹
at the feet of Krishna's devotees I bow.
4. I have not studied, and there is not a trace of bhakti in me;
yet I write by the command of the Ocean of compassion:
5. "All my devotees who wander upon the earth
descended along with me and bear the same virtues.
6. Some have described the pastimes of Radha and Krishna,
others have revealed scriptures about Gaura's pastimes.
7. Whoever writes of the virtues of Krishna's devotees,
to him I show mercy with a joyful heart.
8. After my departure there will be prema upon the earth;
I bid you write and describe their virtues.
9. Srinivasa and Narottama are the two Mahashayas;
write of the virtues of these two abundantly.
10. Write of the virtues of both and of their way of bhajana —
how the earth spread prema in their form."
11. I have never known a speck of the gift of description;
yet I write by the strength of the command of the two Lords.
12. Sri Jahnava and Virachandra, at whose feet my hope rests —
from them came the command to reveal these virtues.
13. Srinivasa is my breath, Narottama my life;
with care I write of the virtues of these two.
14. By that command I write whatever words come to my mind;
O Vaishnava Gosanis, do not count it against me in any way.
15. For six months the Acharya did not go out anywhere;
seeing his son's power, he remained at peace.
16. Both rejoiced as they looked on their son's face,
and raised their son with happy hearts.
17. The time of the annaprashana² came;
they brought an astrologer and fixed the day firmly.
18. At an auspicious moment they put prasada into the son's mouth,
and both rejoiced, clasping their son to their breasts.

19. The time of the chudakarana³ came;
performing the rites according to rule, they gave him the sacred thread.
20. A crimson cloth gleams upon his body;
seeing him, his father and mother rejoice at heart.
21. On the third day the Thakura grew restless:
his lessons had stopped — he stayed at home and began to weep.⁴
22. At this time the pandit Vidyanidhi came by;⁵
hearing of the break in the lessons, he was greatly pleased:
23. "The boy has such a longing for learning —
it seems Srinivasa will become an expert in the sciences."
24. One night Srinivasa saw in a dream:
"Study quickly, Srinivasa — you will go to Vrindavana.
25. Gauda is very dear to Chaitanya;
through you he will make books of the pastimes arise here.
26. Why have you stopped studying for three days?
At your parents' word I will teach you.
27. But if you act against this word,
what you have learned will not come back to your mind."⁶
28. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — he did not go to study.
29. Lakshmipriya and the Acharya were astonished:
they could not understand what kind of birth this was.⁷
30. He constantly uttered the name of Radha and Krishna with his tongue,
and so his learning went — yet there was joy in his heart.
31. Sitting at home, what does Srinivasa say?
"I have not become a pandit" — such is the pain in his mind.
32. "I cannot understand Krishna's mercy;
scholarship comes from study — such is its way."⁸
33. Therefore I will not live in Yajigrama:
for the sake of learning I will go to another land."
34. After ten days his mother bade him:
"Go and study, my son; your lessons have been interrupted."
35. "As you command," he said, and taking a book in his hand,
Srinivasa went to his guru's place.
36. Dhananjaya Vidyanivasa said a wondrous thing:
"Looking at your form, I feel joy.
37. Listen, listen, Srinivasa, I will tell you:
learning no longer comes alive in me — why have you come?
38. You have stolen all my learning;
I am an empty body, I tell you.
39. I cannot understand your nature;
it seems Sarasvati has turned against me."

40. Ashamed, Srinivasa bowed to his guru,
and Dhananjaya started up in fear, crying "Alas, alas!"
41. Srinivasa's shame grew all the more, doubling;
dejected, he tied up his book and went away.
42. His father and mother knew nothing of all this;
grieving over the break in his studies, he lay down alone.
43. The meal was ready, but the boy was not at home;
his father went to look for him with an anxious heart.
44. The pandit said: "He left a long time ago."
Finding no trace of him, the father was greatly distressed.
45. Going into the house, he entered the room
and saw him asleep with a book in his hand.
46. Hearing his father's voice, out of shame he said nothing,
and saying "Give me food, Mother," began to laugh.
47. Having eaten, Srinivasa rinsed his mouth
and, laughing, lay down again.
48. Suddenly a voice from heaven was heard in the room —
the sound came: "All learning shall awaken in you!"
49. I am Sarasvati; by Chaitanya's command
I have come in the guise of a dream to give you learning."
50. Opening his eyes, he looks — there is no one in the room.
"By the goddess's boon I shall have great learning!"
51. Laughing, he came out happily
and stood before his father and mother.
52. "Come, come, my son, let me take you on my lap;
do not grieve over the break in your studies," and she kissed his cheek.⁹
53. From then on there was no further break in his studies,
and beyond that, the name of Radha and Krishna awoke in him.
54. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the third vilasa, containing the description of the interruption of Srinivasa Acharya Thakura's studies.

1. Variant: "Do not hold the irregularities of my writing against me."

2. Annaprashana, a child's first feeding with rice.

3. Chudakarana, the rite of the first tonsure; the sacred thread is normally given at the upanayana, but the text runs the two rites together.

4. After the upanayana a boy customarily spends some days in seclusion and does not go to his teacher.

5. Variant: "Sri Rama Vachaspati came by".

6. Variant: "you will forget what you have learned". Who speaks in the dream is not stated; from the context, apparently the teacher.

7. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

8. The second line is unclear; literally "having studied, his scholarship in such conduct".

9. In the 1913 edition this couplet is in brackets.

Vilasa 4. Srinivasa's Wanderings: Srikhanda, Puri, Navadvipa, Shantipur

Srinivasa meets Narahari Sarakara; longing for Mahaprabhu and a voice from the sky; the death of Chaitanya Dasa; the move to Yajigrama; Srikhanda and Raghunandana; the journey to Puri and Gadadhara's passing; Navadvipa and Vishnupriya's grace; Shantipur: the vision of Advaita and Sita's account

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. One morning, as Srinivasa was going to bathe,
he met Sarakara Thakura¹ on the road.
3. He was on his way from Gajipur to Khanda,
and he saw a wondrous form of golden hue.
4. Suddenly the Lord's feet came to his mind:
it seemed to him that he had seen that very form in person.
5. "Srinivasa is his name, born in a brahmana family" —
seeing the boy's radiance, the Thakura grasped the secret.
6. "If I ask his name, I shall learn who he is," he thought;
and the boy, prostrating himself, stood before him.
7. In a sweet voice he began to ask him:
"What is your name, boy? Tell me truly."
8. Respectfully Srinivasa answered:
"Your own servant, born at Chakhandi."
9. Hearing the name Srinivasa, the Thakura was delighted
and became firmly convinced that this was Chaitanya's power.
10. "Come, come, my son, let me embrace you!" —
and holding him to his breast, he bathed him in tears.
11. "Nityananda is anxious about you."²
I had a wish, and now I have met you.
12. I had heard nothing of you from anyone, nor seen you;
I cannot tell how much hidden treasure lies in this.
13. Virachandra called me in Jahnava's presence:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'
14. He was born on the bank of the Ganga and is still a mere child —
that is why I have not met him.
15. Without any effort Chaitanya has brought us together on this road;
through you he will reveal the pastimes in Vrindavana.
16. Now there is no need to ask anything more;
meeting you in Khanda will make me happy."
17. The Thakura went on to Khanda, and Srinivasa crossed the Ganga;
and at home his father and mother were sorely anxious.³

18. On reaching home the boy lost all composure in prema:
he laughs, weeps, dances, sings and falls to the ground again and again.
19. Crying out, he weeps very loudly,
and a great lamentation arose in the Acharya's house.
20. "Why has this happened to him? We know nothing;
when we ask, he weeps the more," and their hearts were torn.
21. The Acharya heard the weeping inside the house
and saw his son weeping with an anguished heart.
22. He asked: "My son, why are you weeping?
You went to bathe — why do you weep? I do not understand."
23. One by one the villagers gathered,
and seeing the boy's behaviour they cried out in dismay.
24. Among them was an old brahmana:
"Be patient; listen, I will tell you the cause of this.
25. Narahari Thakura Mahashaya, who lives in Khanda,
met the boy on the road at the time of his bath.
26. From seeing him the boy has come into this state;
do not worry, be patient," he said truly.
27. Hearing the name of Narahari, the boy laughed,
and at the brahmana's words regained some outward awareness.
28. But from that day his state was changed:
the malady of separation from Chaitanya grew twofold.
29. "I never had the sight of Chaitanya Prabhu,
I never saw the feet of Nityananda Prabhu,
30. I did not see the form of Advaita Acharya,
I did not meet Svarupa, Ramananda Raya, Sanatana or Rupa,
31. I did not hear sankirtana together with the devotees —
sinner that I am, I was not born at that time!"
32. Lifting his face to the sky, he cried out long:
"By giving me a later birth, Fate has barred my happiness!"
33. Then a voice sounded from the sky:
"Your birth is in the form of prema — why do you worry?
34. Through you the pastimes of Radha and Krishna will be spread;
with what Chaitanya savoured you will flood the world.
35. In Vrindavana Rupa and Sanatana,
the two brothers, have written scriptures of rasa for your sake.
36. Foreseeing the future, Chaitanya Gosani, for your sake,
sent the two brothers to compose these books.
37. The two brothers are anxious in Vrindavana;
if you go quickly, you will see them.
38. If you delay, you will not see the two brothers,
and when you reach Vrindavana your sorrow will be all the greater."

39. "The grief in my father's and mother's hearts — this is my great dilemma;
if only the Mahashaya would help me in this!"
40. For a while he grew calm, and the people went home;
seeing him well, his father and mother were glad at heart.
41. Understanding his father's heart, Srinivasa smiled
and asked to eat: "I am very hungry."
42. At their son's words they were overjoyed
and lovingly fed him many dishes.
43. "While my father and mother live, how can I leave them?
Besides, I am only a boy — how shall I go to Vrindavana?"
44. But Chaitanya's mercy is very deep;
all sorrow vanished, and there was joy in his heart.
45. Suddenly a fever came upon Chaitanya Dasa,
and within seven days he attained the Ganga.⁴
46. Seeing this, Srinivasa wept much in his grief,
and then performed the prescribed rites with special care.
47. At the loss of his father he suffered great sorrow,
and seeing his mother weep, his face withered.
48. "To the childless the Lord gave a son, Srinivasa,
and now bereavement has come, and our hope is unfulfilled.
49. O cruel Fate, what shall I say to you?
So soon you have given the boy such sorrow!
50. My diamond of a boy⁵ — how will his days pass?
We have no one to call our own — what will become of me?
51. O Srinivasa, where has your father gone?
How shall we pass our days? We are orphaned!"
52. Seeing his mother's grief, Srinivasa was stricken
and wept long, crying "Father, father!
53. With whom have you left me, where have you gone?⁶
You loved me so, Thakura, and yet you have left me!"
54. Thus, after lamenting long on the bank of the Ganga,
he performed the rites according to rule and gave the bones to the water.
55. Coming home, he wept a great deal,
and women came to console Lakshmipriya.
56. "Listen, listen, Thakurani, why do you grieve?
Look at your son and restrain yourself.
57. What comfort can we give? Listen, steady your heart;
look at your son and forget your sorrow; do not weep."
58. At this time a voice sounded from the sky:
"Why do you grieve, mother, why are you anxious?
59. You know nothing of the boy's virtues;
when you go to Yajigrama, you will learn everything later.

60. For the sake of these two⁷ Sri Chaitanya and Nityananda
began the books in Vrindavana through Rupa.
61. Take care of your son — listen, Lakshmi-priya;
do not grieve in vain; be steady of heart."
62. All her grief for her husband went away,
but in her breast remained a sprout of sorrow over Srinivasa.
63. Having duly performed all the customary observances,
Srinivasa visited Yajigrama and saw Narahari.⁸
64. A great longing arose in him: "I will leave this village;
settling my mother in Yajigrama, I will go elsewhere."
65. At night, as he slept in the village,
the command of Chaitanya came in a dream: "Go to Vrindavana."
66. Having seen the dream, he awoke:
"How can I go so soon and leave her?"
67. Besides, I have not yet received initiation;
I have no right to go to Vrindavana.
68. Delay is not good; I will go and settle there,
and then follow whatever counsel Thakura Narahari gives me."
69. After living some days in Chakhandi,
he left that place and came to Yajigrama.
70. On the fifth day of the month of Phalguna they settled there,
and at that time he met the zamindar of the village.
71. Seeing his radiance, the zamindar showed him honour:
"Live in this village — I will build you a house."
72. Seeing his wondrous form, he counted himself fortunate:
"We too are blessed; our life is fulfilled!"
73. Thus he stayed some days in that village,
and then the wish arose in him to go to Khanda.
74. He chose and made ready a very charming place —
a beautiful dwelling on the western side of the village.⁹
75. Leaving his mother in that village, he went to Khanda.
At the outer gate, under a tree, sat Sri Raghunandana.
76. Seeing his radiance, he asked: "What is your name?
Where have you come from? Tell me your news."
77. "I have just come from Yajigrama for darshan;
my name is Srinivasa," he answered respectfully.
78. Hearing the name Srinivasa, Raghunandana was overcome with prema;
stretching out his arms, he came and embraced him.
79. "From the Thakura's holy lips I have heard all about you;
at the mere sight of you all my distress has gone.
80. Come, come, brother, to the Thakura;
we two will have our talk later."

81. Taking him by the hand, he led him to the Thakura.
"Come, come, my son, sit down, Srinivasa!
82. A letter has come from Virachandra about you:
'Send Srinivasa to Vrindavana quickly.'"
83. Kindly he passed his holy hand over his body,
and at the touch of that holy hand Srinivasa was deeply absorbed in prema.
84. Nearby was Nayana Sena Mahashaya;¹⁰
supporting Srinivasa, he took him to his own house.
85. That day he was holding the worship of his guru and his father's memorial rite;
in the afternoon the Thakura came to his house with Raghunandana.
86. "Tell me, tell me, Nayana, where is Srinivasa?
Bring him — I will ask him about going to Vrindavana."
87. Then Srinivasa, seeing Narahari,
bowed to him, and he was glad to see his smiling face.
88. "Tell me, Srinivasa, about your going to Vrindavana:
how will you manage it, my son? Tell me in detail."
89. "Listen, Thakura, I must tell you:
without a refuge,¹¹ how can I do this?"
90. "Concerning you, Chaitanya gave the Bhatta a command:
he will give you initiation in every way."
91. Weeping, Srinivasa said:
"Why do you deceive me and send me to Vrindavana?"
92. Coming from Chakhandi I received your darshan,
and at that very moment I surrendered myself to you."
93. The Thakura said: "What you say is true;
but Gopala Bhatta is your guru, I tell you.
94. I cannot go against the Lord's command.
For now live here and serve.
95. Hari-nama is Mahaprabhu's own power;
understanding this, you shall receive it."
96. Having heard this, he went to his lodging
and began to ponder what Sarakara Thakura had said.
97. "From whom shall I receive Hari-nama?" —
turning this over in his mind, he lay awake all night.
98. Towards the end of the night his sleep broke, and he was half awake,¹²
and Gaurachandra mercifully said to him:
99. "Listen, listen, Srinivasa, why are you troubled?
You were born as prema in form for my purpose.
100. Why, then, do you wait?¹³
I have told you: you were born as prema in form.
101. Go to Vrindavana; do not delay;
take refuge at the feet of Gopala Bhatta.

102. He was born in the land of Telanga; he is my very life;
and Sanatana and Rupa are one soul in two bodies.
103. All the books that Rupa and Sanatana have written
they will entrust to you when you go.
104. They are anxious at your delay;
the work is done — go quickly."
105. In ecstasy he bowed to the Lord,
who laid a hand on his head and said: "May your heart's desire be fulfilled."
106. The Lord vanished, and his sleep was broken;
waking, Srinivasa reflected:
107. "The Lord has commanded me to go to Vrindavana."
And he went and told Sarakara Thakura.
108. Thinking thus, Srinivasa came to Narahari,
bowed to him and offered him praise:
109. "Listen, Mahashaya, to what I saw in a dream:
a golden-bodied boy came and spoke to me..."
110. All that he had seen in the dream he told;
the Thakura said: "Mahaprabhu's mercy has come."
111. Laying a hand on his head, he blessed him:
"May Vrindavana show you mercy without delay.
112. I have sent a letter to Virachandra:
'I have kept Srinivasa with me — give your command.'
113. Whatever answer comes, I will act on it;
until then stay here, close to me."
114. Thus he lived some days in Khanda,
and a wish arose in him to see Jagannatha.
115. "I greatly wish to study the Bhagavata;
I will see Jagannatha and stay with the Pandita.¹⁴
116. Going to him I will study the Bhagavata,
and having studied it with commentary I will go to Vrindavana."
117. With this in mind he went to Narahari.
"What you have said, my son, is right.
118. I will give you a Vaishnava as a companion;
delivering a letter, he will give my news."
119. He put a respectful letter into the Vaishnava's hand,
and setting out, the two went along the road to Jagannatha.
120. Travelling on, they reached Jagannatha-puri,
and having seen Jagannatha they came to Gopinatha's abode.¹⁵
121. The Pandita Gosani was stricken in separation from Chaitanya:
now he swooned, now he laughed, and a stupor lay within him.¹⁶
122. Saying "Chaitanya! Nityananda!" Srinivasa prostrated himself;
hearing Chaitanya's name, Gosani was stirred.

123. "Who are you? Who are you?" he said, opening his eyes.
"Come, come, my son, let me hold you to my breast.
124. What is your name, my son? Tell me.
What wondrous words I have heard from your lips!
125. By letting me hear the Name you have bought me.¹⁷
With separation in my heart I saw a dream:
126. 'From Gauda will come one named Srinivasa,
born at Chakhandi as prema in form,
127. to his father Chaitanya Dasa, from the womb of Lakshmipriya,
so that the pastimes of Radha and Krishna may be spread.'
128. Are you that one, my son? Tell me who you are;
soothe my body — tell me for certain."
129. "I am he," he said, and smiled gently.
"You are the master, and I am wretched, luckless and low."
130. "It is good that you came, my son, and told me who you are.
The Lord commanded me to teach you the Bhagavata.
131. At the time of his last pastimes the Lord told me:
'When Srinivasa comes, let him hear Krishna's pastimes.
132. For his sake you shall stay at Gopinatha,
and send him to Vrindavana with a letter in his hand.
133. Sri Rupa and Sanatana, the two brothers,
have revealed the Lord's heart through their scriptures.
134. Those scriptures you¹⁸ will bring to Gauda,
and reveal the scriptures of the pastimes in every particular.'
135. The Lord's command is to teach you the Bhagavata,
but the letters of my book have all been washed away by my tears.
136. Give my letter into Narahari's hands;
he will send a new book with you.
137. The Lord's command concerning you is mighty;
do not delay; settle everything.
138. In the pastimes of Radha and Krishna there is Sri Guna-manjari —
she is none other than Gopala Bhatta, of equal sweetness."
139. "I will become his disciple, Prabhu!" — a great longing was in Srinivasa's heart,
and on hearing the name Guna-manjari his ears rejoiced.
140. "I see the Lord's command has been given to the Manjari;
in Navadvipa you will receive a witness from Ishvari-ji.¹⁹
141. Partake of the remnants of Gopinatha's meal;
today is an auspicious day — set out for Gauda.
142. If you delay on the road, you will not find them."
With closed eyes Srinivasa listened to these words.
143. "Where has Prabhu Chaitanya gone, where is Nityananda?" —
for a moment he weeps, then gently laughs.

144. Bearing the pain of separation, he loses all memory:
it does not occur to him that Gopinatha is before him.
145. The raving of separation, all kinds of changes in his body;
lifting his face, now and again he cries out.
146. Seeing these changes, Srinivasa was stunned:
"If I go to Gauda, I shall not see him again."
147. Taking the reply, he prostrated himself.
"Set out for your country, if you would study the Bhagavata."
148. Taking the road, he came to Narahari;
that day Virachandra was in the house, and many people had gathered.²⁰
149. Then the Mahashaya prostrated himself,
and the word was given: "Srinivasa, it is good that you have come.
150. Listen: this letter has come from Vrindavana —
study the Bhagavata and set out for Vrindavana."
151. He made known the Pandita Gosani's command in the letter
and told everything just as he had seen it.
152. He read the letter out to Virachandra Gosani
and asked leave to go and study the Bhagavata.
153. "If you delay, you will not find him;
go to the Kshetra without delay."
154. The Thakura again gave him the same Vaishnava as a companion,
and saying "Gadadhara! Chaitanya!" Srinivasa set out.
155. In anxiety Srinivasa went as far as Jajpur,
and as he entered the village he received the news that the Pandita had passed away.
156. Receiving the news, he swooned on the spot,
and the frightened Vaishnava clasped his feet.
157. Coming to himself, he bowed down many times:
"My purpose is not fulfilled — Fate has turned against me!"
158. That night he fasted there;
seeing how wasted he was, the Vaishnava was greatly afraid:
159. "How shall I bring him to Gauda?
The Thakura will punish me!" — and his heart sank.
160. With much care he got him to eat,
and entreating him, they went on to Gauda.
161. Weeping and weeping, he came back to Gauda,²¹
and in the afternoon entered the village of Srikhanda.
162. Prostrating himself, he told the whole story
and, crying "Alas!", wept long.
163. Who can describe that lament of separation —
the lament of one whose heart holds the grief of separation from guru and Vaishnavas?
164. From that day another state came over him again:
"How shall I get to Vrindavana?" — and his longing grew.

165. In the morning, leaving Srikhanda, he came to Navadvipa,
and living as a renunciant he stayed near the Lord's house.
166. Crying "Pandita Gosani!", he weeps aloud;
for two or four days at a time he takes no food.
167. When his hunger becomes unbearable,
he gathers a chhatak²² of rice,
168. cooks it on the bank of the Ganga,
but what he truly eats is the pain of separation.
169. By the eighth day his body was utterly wasted;
and he met Vamshivadana Dasa.
170. "What is your name? Where do you live? I have never seen or heard of you." —
"In separation from Gadadhara I am staying here.
171. My name is Srinivasa; my home is in Yajigrama;
I could not study the Bhagavata, and my heart is in pain.
172. Gadadhara Pandita had the Lord's command —
I would have studied with him, but by my misfortune it did not come to pass."
173. As he spoke, a great weeping overcame him.
At that moment Ishana arrived.
174. Such is Ishana's nature: he is compassionate to living beings,
and on seeing a great bhagavata, prema rises in him.
175. Seeing him so wasted, he questioned him,
and seeing him entirely alone, he was much pleased.²³
176. He understood that Chaitanya's power was in the boy:
"I ought to tell Ishvari of this."
177. He went back home to Ishvari:
"I have seen a wondrous boy at the bathing ghat on the Ganga.
178. He is always weeping, calling on Gadadhara Pandita;
he has no companion, and his eyes are full of tears.
179. Seeing him, I was moved to compassion:
without food his body has become utterly wasted.
180. If you permit, I will give him some food,
and later bring him here, and you may show him mercy."
181. "Go and give him rice, as much as is fitting;
but now that Chaitanya is gone, his renunciation troubles me."²⁴
182. Ishana took excellent provisions
and went joyfully to Srinivasa.
183. "Listen, brahmana: take these provisions,
go to the bank of the Ganga, cook them and eat."
184. "As you command," he said, and bowing he took them.
And here Ishvari herself understood everything.
185. Having given him rice, Ishvari rejoiced at heart:
"I see the boy has been born as prema in form."²⁵

186. When the brahmana took the rice and cooked it,
she sent ten vairagis to him.
187. When the food was ready, they came in the guise of vairagis
and appeared before him just at the time of the meal.
188. Seeing the Vaishnavas, he was overjoyed,
and receiving them all, he showed them great honour.
189. They said: "We are very hungry;
give us food, Mahashaya, and then we shall be pleased."
190. "Most kindly you have come and given me darshan;
the prasada is ready — sit down and eat."
191. "You have cooked very little, and we are many;
our hunger will not be satisfied — that is plain to see."
192. "Your hunger will be satisfied — such is the nature of prasada."
And the ten Vaishnavas sat down in a circle.
193. In this way he served them all,
filling plate after plate with great joy.
194. Half a ser of rice, made into prasada,
was partaken of by eleven Vaishnavas, and they were content.
195. Ishvari heard of this through Ishana
and understood in her heart that he had been born as prema in form.
196. "How delightful it is to hear of such a boy's virtues!
I must certainly see the boy's face."²⁶
197. At night, going with a maid to bathe in the Ganga,
she saw the boy, full of the sweetness of prema.
198. Having bathed, while it was still night, she went back to the inner apartments;
having seen the boy, she was glad at heart.²⁷
199. "How can I bring him here and question him?
How can I ask, looking at the face of a strange man?"
200. If he is the Lord's power, my shyness will go far away;
then I shall know that abundant mercy rests on him."
201. Ishvari bade Ishana bring the boy:
"Why does he weep day and night?"
202. Ishana came and said: "Listen, Srinivasa:
Ishvari is calling you — come to the Lord's house."
203. Raising his arms, Srinivasa began a long dance:
it seemed that the Pandita Gosani's state had come upon him.
204. Weeping, he went along behind Ishana;
on entering the inner chamber he grew shy.
205. Trembling, he went into the inner apartments,
but did not come close and stayed at some distance.
206. Ishana said: "Here is Srinivasa;
he bows down to you; he is your dear servant."

207. Drawing aside the inner curtain, she looked at him
and understood the reason: it is my Lord's power.
208. Setting her shyness aside, she called him herself:
"Why do you weep and wander about alone?"
209. He told her the Pandita Gosani's words:
"By his kindness I would have gone to Vrindavana.
210. What I heard from his lips in Nilachala...
Not having studied the Bhagavata, my birth has been in vain.
211. I heard the Lord's command to go to Vrindavana,
but it has not been fulfilled," he said at her feet.
212. "Now I weep without ceasing for Gadadhara;
therefore the Lord's power rests with you."
213. "I see you are still very young and tender.
Have you taken up renunciation? Go home, brahmana boy.
214. Renunciation is hard — it needs very great strength."²⁸
With joined palms he pleaded long:
215. "Let me stay near your feet;
my soul will be soothed, and I shall escape from danger.
216. I have no one in the world; only my mother is living;
how can I go to Vrindavana and still keep my life?"
217. "Without Chaitanya's power there is no such mercy."²⁹
When you are mature, then you will go; it is not fitting now.
218. Having received this command, live outside the house,
eat prasada, and let your mind grow steady."³⁰
219. Vishnupriya, in separation from Gauranga, was sorely afflicted:
her grief doubled, and she lost herself.
220. Ishvari called Ishana and said: "Listen, Ishana:
the night has gone by, and it is dawn."
221. Ishana said: "He spends the night weeping;
crying 'O Pandita Gosani!', he stays awake."
222. That day they did not meet again;
in longing for darshan, night and day went by.
223. Hear, brothers, how Ishvari took the Name —
hearing it, one comes to realise the pastimes.
224. She brings new clay pots and sets them on either side:
one pot empty, the other full of rice.
225. Each time she chants the sixteen names of thirty-two syllables,³¹
she places one grain in the pot, with joy in her heart.
226. Until the third watch she chants Hari-nama,
and whatever grains have been gathered she takes and goes to cook.
227. Cooking only those grains,
she feeds them to the Lord with tears.

228. Day and night, Hari-nama, so many rounds for the Lord!
I cannot fathom that endeavour — my mind is utterly helpless.
229. What can be said of her who is the Lord's beloved?
Day and night she ever chants Hari-nama.
230. What is impossible for her, with such longing for the Name?
She chants the Name, and in it she plants the Lord's power.
231. By the mere shadow of the Name all sins are destroyed,
the heart's desire grows, and prema is made manifest.
232. The Name is a wish-fulfilling tree — this is certain;
whoever chants the Name by count attains every perfection.
233. "The Name is the truth in the Kali age" — so it is said three times;³²
Gauranga accepts those who are free from attachment.
234. It is the best of all means of sadhana;
only by the fortune of many births does love for it arise.
235. Thus, when the third watch of the night had passed,
crying "O Chaitanya!", she lay down on the ground.
236. At the end of the night the two brothers together, in sankirtana,
dancing, say: "Where is my mother?"
237. Your daughter-in-law keeps my Srinivasa outside the gate,
while she herself is at ease in her own house!
238. All my work is to be done through Srinivasa;
send him to Abhirama, with Ishana as his companion."³³
239. In separation from Chaitanya she does not sleep at night;
having heard the nectar words of the dream, she fell silent.
240. "Ishana! Ishana!" the maids call out,
but Ishana is fast asleep and does not stir.
241. After a long while Ishana awoke,
and in fear counted himself most unfortunate.
242. With joined palms he came to Ishvari,
and she commanded: "Bring Srinivasa to me."
243. Srinivasa was weeping on a mat of kusha grass.
"Get up, get up, lad, come quickly!"³⁴
244. Standing in the courtyard, he bowed down many times,
and Ishana was told: "Take him to see Abhirama."³⁵
245. So saying, with her toes wrapped in cloth,
she called Srinivasa and raised her foot onto his head.
246. At the touch of her foot he was overcome with prema
and, rolling on the ground, began to weep.
247. "Listen, listen, my son, you are fortunate:
Chaitanya's power is in you — it cannot be otherwise.
248. Go to Shantipur, and then you will go to Khardaha;
on seeing Acharya Gosani, you will be recognised.

249. Going to Khardaha, you will see Nityananda;
finding you, Jahnava will rejoice.
250. Do not delay long; go quickly —
you will hear much and see the sweetness of beauty.
251. Having met everyone, go to Vrindavana;
all will be fulfilled — keep this in mind on the way."
252. Prostrating himself, he went to Shantipur,
and fell into great perplexity: "Where shall I stay?
253. Ishvari bade me see Advaita —
how is that command to be understood?
254. It is now the third year since Gosani passed away;
yet this command cannot be disobeyed" — doubt cast him into a quandary.
255. At that moment one appeared with arms reaching to his knees and a huge body;
seeing his radiance, Srinivasa trembled and lost all composure.
256. Unable to open his eyes, he fell to the ground.
"Come, come, Srinivasa, I have heard your words."
257. So Advaita Gosani had willed it;
prostrating himself there, Srinivasa addressed him.
258. Sighing, Gosani wept a long while:
"Where have Chaitanya and Nityananda gone in their bodies?
259. Where have their companions gone — Svarupa, Ramananda Raya?" —
and lovingly he laid his hand on Srinivasa's head.
260. "Come, come, Srinivasa, let my life be soothed;
let me embrace you and let my heart be comforted.
261. For your sake the Lord sent Gopala Bhatta;
you will become his servant — I tell you for certain.
262. Being angry with me, the Lord caused you to be born,³⁶
and here he has revealed all his own work.
263. He sent Rupa and Sanatana to Vrindavana,
and to make that known he caused you to be born.
264. For your sake he sent Gopala Bhatta;
take instruction there, in order to make prema manifest.
265. Calling 'Come, come!', with the Lord's power infused in you,
you³⁷ will flood the world, spreading prema.
266. For your sake I have appeared here;
never speak of it anywhere else.
267. Going to Khardaha, you will find joy;
having seen Jahnava, you will go to Vrindavana.
268. There you will see Sri Rupa;
go and worship the feet of Gopala Bhatta.
269. By Chaitanya's mercy you will flood the land with prema;
cry 'Advaita! Govinda!' and do not dwell on sorrow.

270. Your Lord, the best of lovers,
has by prema destroyed the corruption among my followers.³⁸
271. Whoever among my followers takes up this doctrine on his lips
will, cut off from Chaitanya and Nityananda, meet with great sorrow."
272. So saying, Advaita-chandra vanished,
and Srinivasa, parted from the vision, fell senseless.
273. At this time Mother Sita was going to bathe in the Ganga,
and she sees a jewel of a boy weeping.
274. "Child, child!" she took the boy on her lap
and comforted him with the sweetest words.
275. She asked: "Who are you? Why are you weeping?
It seems you have had the darshan of my lord.
276. Tell me, boy, where is your home?
Why have you come here, weeping so bitterly?"
277. "My name is Srinivasa; I was born at Chakhandi;
by Ishvari-ji's command I have come to see you."
278. Hearing the name Srinivasa, she rejoiced at heart:
she already knew of him from Achyutananda's letter.
279. "I have greatly wished to see you, my son;
by Chaitanya's great mercy we have met on the road."
280. Gopala Gosani³⁹ was coming from his bath;
seeing him, Srinivasa fell prostrate.
281. "Until I come back from bathing in the Ganga,
look after him carefully."
282. Leaving them together, Mother Sita went to bathe in the Ganga,
and meanwhile Gosani sat with him on one seat.
283. Having bathed, she soon came back
and saw Srinivasa and Gopala together.
284. So she took him into the inner apartments,
glad at heart to have found a wondrous Vaishnava.
285. She gave him the remnants of Advaita's meal to eat:
"I am going to cook; you sit by the door."
286. Having cooked, she offered the bhoga,
gave Krishna water to rinse his mouth and laid him down to rest.
287. Gopala was told to take prasada:
"Sit down quickly together with Srinivasa.
288. I will serve the wondrous Vaishnava myself;
sit with him, my son — it will make me very happy."
289. They sat down together to eat;
at the touch of the prasada from the Lord's lips their hair stood on end again and again.
290. Food cooked by Sita's hand, the remnants of Krishna's lips —
and the transformations of prema in all their variety.

291. Having rinsed their mouths, both in great delight
freshened their mouths and sat together in one place.⁴⁰
292. The day ended, and evening came;
seeing Krishna's joy, their joy knew no bounds.
293. That night he spent joyfully in Shantipur,⁴¹
and in the morning went to Sita to take his leave.
294. "I have one request — listen carefully:
on coming to this village I heard the words 'Advaita, Govinda'.⁴²
295. Tell me, Mother, the true account of this,
and then give me leave to go and see Khardaha."
296. "What need have you to hear this, boy?
Attend to your own business and go on your travels."
297. "Permit me, Mother — I long to hear it;
be gracious and kindly tell me."
298. Such is a boy's nature — he holds fast to what he has said;
and Mother Sita could not refuse him.
299. "Listen with a steady mind, Srinivasa;
when you hear it, you will believe with a calm heart.
300. At the time when Jagai and Madhai were delivered,
Gosani⁴³ in anger said to Haridasa:
301. 'If Gosani does not give me the union of prema,
I will dry up all prema — and the fault will not be mine.'
302. Angry with Nityananda, he came home
and sent a riddle, a tarja, written through Jagadananda.
303. From that day anger arose in the Lord:
to Nityananda he gave companions — Ramai, Sundarananda and others,
304. and to my Thakura he gave Kamadeva Nagara,
and in his anger made the Nagara speak.⁴⁴
305. My lord came to Gauda with the Nagara in his company,
and amid the waves of prema the Nagara set a doctrine going.
306. As soon as I heard it, anger arose in me,
and I never looked on the Nagara's face again.
307. I separated my maidservant Nandini from me,⁴⁵
and I no longer listen to those words.
308. Some of my sons hold to Achyuta's view,
and some, following the Nagara, have gone astray.
309. I rejoice in the sons who hold to Achyuta's view;
and Nityananda, coming to Gauda, flooded it with prema.
310. Gosani could not restrain the Nagara,
and for that reason this circle became hostile.
311. Listen, Srinivasa, my heart is sorely pained:
having quarrelled with my sons, I keep to my house.⁴⁶

312. Whoever stands with Achyuta, the son of Chaitanya's maidservant,⁴⁷
does not speak this doctrine; whoever speaks it has no tie with me."

313. Hearing this, he rejoiced greatly at heart,
and Srinivasa prostrated himself again and again.

314. The Mother dispelled all the doubts in his mind,
and prostrating himself, he took leave of Sita.

315. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fourth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Narahari Sarakara Thakura of Srikhandā (Khanda).
2. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. The line "khaṇḍa haite gamana haila gaṅgā haite pāra" is unclear; translated by the sense.
4. That is, he died (a euphemism: the dying are carried to the Ganga). In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.
5. Variant: "my very frail boy".
6. Variant: "with whom have you left me, Father?"
7. Apparently Srinivasa and Narottama.
8. The line "yājigrāma dekhīā dekhīa narahari" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
9. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
10. Nayana Sena, a resident of Srikhandā.
11. That is, without having received initiation from a guru.
12. Variant: "towards the end of the night he slept and was half awake".
13. Variant: "Why do you wait for a refuge?"
14. Gadadhara Pandita, who lived in Puri at the temple of Tota-Gopinatha.
15. The Deity Tota-Gopinatha in Puri, served by Gadadhara Pandita.
16. Variant: "now he swooned, now he laughed, and his body trembled".
17. That is, made me your own.
18. Srinivasa.
19. Ishvari here is Vishnupriya, Mahāprabhu's consort, who lived in Navadvīpa.
20. The line "se divasa vīracandra-bāṛite bahu saṁghaṭe" is understood thus; perhaps Virachandra was then a guest of Narahari.
21. Variant note: "Not having studied the Bhagavata, he was sunk in grief."
22. A chhatak is a small measure, about 60 g.
23. Perhaps one should read "was much grieved" (duḥkha for sukha); both copies have sukha.
24. The line "caitanya aprakaṭe virakta manera saṁśaya" is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
25. In the 1913 edition couplet 184 (second line) to 185 is in brackets.
26. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
27. Variant: "she was filled with great compassion".
28. Variant: "Hearing that renunciation is hard, he was greatly afraid."
29. Variant: "there is no such state".
30. Variant: "'As you command,' he said, and carefully went out."
31. The maha-mantra "Hare Krishna": sixteen names, thirty-two syllables.
32. An allusion to the well-known verse "harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam...", in which the word "Name" is repeated three times.
33. Chaitanya and Nityananda speak, addressing Shachi ("Mother") in the dream; "your daughter-in-law" is Vishnupriya. Abhirama (Ramadasa) was a companion of Nityananda who lived at Khanakul.
34. This couplet is complete only in the 1913 edition (the 1999 edition keeps only the second line).

35. It could also be understood as "see how lovely he is" (abhirāma, "lovely"); in view of couplet 238 we take it as the name.
36. An allusion to Advaita's "riddle" and his preaching of mukti, which troubled Mahaprabhu (see vilasa 1).
37. Literally "he"; address to Srinivasa and speech about him are mixed here.
38. The couplet is unclear ("tomāra ye prabhu ihā nāgara vara dvāre / gaṇaduṣṭa prema dvārā karila saṁhāre"); the rendering is tentative.
39. Gopala, one of the sons of Advaita Acharya and Sita.
40. In the 1913 edition couplets 282–291 are in brackets; in the 1999 edition the second line of couplet 290 is lost.
41. The 1999 edition has "that night he spent in Shantipur, at the arati".
42. Cf. couplet 269. The point of the request is to learn the truth about Advaita's "riddle" and the mukti doctrine of some of his followers.
43. Advaita Acharya.
44. Kamadeva Nagara is known as a follower of Advaita who preached a doctrine at odds with Mahaprabhu's bhakti. The line "krodha kari nāgara kahila vākya dvāre" is understood tentatively.
45. The line "svatantra karilu āmi sevaka nandinī" is unclear; Nandini was apparently a maidservant (disciple) of Sita.
46. Literally "having quarrelled with my sons, I go to sleep at home"; the sense of the line is unclear.
47. Achyutananda, son of Advaita and Sita, faithful to Mahaprabhu's teaching; "Chaitanya's maidservant" is Sita herself. In the 1999 edition the first line of the couplet is lost.
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Vilasa 5. Khardaha and Abhirama; the Journey to Vrindavana

Srinivasa at Khardaha with Jahnava and Virachandra; the test at Abhirama's and the three strokes of the whip; farewell to Narahari and to his mother; Rupa in Vrindavana awaits Srinivasa; the journey by Varanasi and Prayaga; at Mathura Srinivasa learns of the passing of Rupa, Sanatana and Raghunatha Bhatta

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the Merciful One!
Grant me bhakti, that I may write this book and my desire be fulfilled.
2. Listen, listen, O hearers, behold this vilasa:
at the mere sight Srinivasa was filled with joy.
3. The moment he entered Khardaha,
Srinivasa, maddened with prema, began to dance.
4. Virachandra Prabhu was beside his mother;
suddenly Virachandra began to tremble.
5. The Thakurani¹ said: "My son, be attentive:
it seems some bhagavata² has made his presence here.
6. I think Srinivasa of Chakhandi has come;
otherwise why should the body so rejoice?
7. I hear the clamour of people calling the names of Radha and Krishna;
he was born as the very form of prema — this is his power.
8. I hear there is joy everywhere — why should it be so?
Because joy is being born in everyone's heart.
9. I have remembered my Lord's command;³
I think that boy has come to the village.
10. Find out, my son, be attentive;
then I shall be at ease and my heart will be soothed."
11. At that moment Ishana came and said in haste:
"A wondrous boy has come and is weeping at the gate."
12. "Go, go, my son, take Ishana with you;
when you see him you will know his virtues — [bring him] before me."
13. Crying "Nityananda!", the Prabhu went out,
and seeing the boy's beauty he embraced him.
14. At the name "Srinivasa" he remembered [Srivasa] of Navadvipa;⁴
at the name and the form he was seized by prema and trembled again and again.
15. Srinivasa prostrated himself many times and fell at his feet;
taking him by the hand, he raised him and asked his name.
16. "What is your name? Seeing you, I am glad."
"My name is Srinivasa; my lot is very poor."
17. "Come, come, friend, you have given me great joy;
without any effort fate has brought me a jewel."

18. Taking Srinivasa by the hand into the house,
he led him to the inner apartments where Ishvari was.
19. With that longing with which Ishvari was longing —
without any effort fate gave her the sweetness of prema.
20. Seeing the boy, she was filled with great prema
and cried aloud: "Chaitanya! Nityananda!"
21. Saying "Navadvipa!", she heaved deep sighs,
and in separation from Nityananda a great surge of feeling arose in her.
22. Taking [Srinivasa] by the hand, Virachandra, in Ishvari's presence,
placed him in her hands: "Give Srinivasa prema.
23. He is going to Vrindavana — give him your command quickly;
this is my plea again and again: infuse him with power."
24. "If he makes haste and goes to Vrindavana,
then he will have the sight of Sri Rupa's feet.
25. If he delays on the way, he will not see him;
if he goes quickly, he will have that sight with joy.
26. Srinivasa will be commanded to go quickly;
he will tell all the wonders of the books of the lila.⁵
27. Delay no longer, go to Vrindavana,
and take shelter at the feet of Gopala Bhatta."
28. She commanded: "Feed the boy,
and send a letter to Abhirama with Ishana.
29. [Abhirama,] all blessing and all perfection lie in your whip:
be sure to strike Srinivasa three times with the whip."⁶
30. Ishvari's remnants filled a vessel;
Virachandra brought them and placed them in his hands.
31. Receiving the remnants from her lips, he was flooded with prema:
he laughed, wept, danced and sang like a madman.
32. Taking him by the hand, Virachandra seated him beside him,
and at the touch of his hand he came back to outward awareness.
33. "Quickly, Srinivasa, go to Vrindavana;
if you delay, you will not meet Rupa."
34. Prostrating himself, the Mahashaya took his leave
and then arrived at Abhirama's.
35. Ishana handed him the letter and bowed:
"Ishvari's command: grant prema to the boy."
36. "Tell me, tell me the good news of Ishvari;
I shall carry it out according to her command.
37. Seeing Srinivasa, my heart greatly rejoices:
I have seen prema blossoming in Gauda."
38. He gave Ishana a seat to sit on,
and hearing mention of the whip he rejoiced within.

39. "Let me see what kind of vessel Ishvari has sent" —
and to test him he gave him eight karas of cowries.⁷
40. "How will the boy manage on this?
When I know his renunciation, I shall strike him with the whip."
41. Taking the cowries in his hand, [Srinivasa] pondered long:
"How am I to eat, what provisions should I buy?"
42. To test me he has put eight karas into my hand;
I mean to cook and eat."
43. Going to a merchant's shop he looked over all the provisions
and bought them in due order.
44. Having paid, he went into a banana grove
and went down to the water with all his provisions.
45. Thakura Sri Abhirama said to two Vaishnavas:
"Go and be guests at Srinivasa's door.
46. Knowing the time when he cooks, go to him,
and, [asking him] for food, make plenty of jests and banter."
47. Taking leave, they went to where Srinivasa was,
at the time when he was offering [the food] to Radha and Krishna.
48. At the end, when he was rinsing his mouth, the two arrived;
seeing Vaishnavas, Srinivasa's heart was glad.
49. "We are hungry — feed the two of us."
"This is my good fortune!" he said in humble words.
50. "You are devotees of Krishna, and I a wretched soul;
in your mercy accept [me]."
51. That offered food he divided into three equal portions
and, with joined palms, said: "Come and eat."
52. Having eaten, they rinsed their mouths contentedly,
and the two Vaishnavas went and said before the Gosani:
53. "There were no side dishes, yet the rice was like nectar;
as we ate, our hearts were filled with joy.
54. Radha and Krishna partook of that food;
as we ate, trembling and tears came over us."⁸
55. Hearing this himself, his heart rejoiced,
and he quickly summoned Ishana before him.
56. "Bring Srinivasa before me:
to the one sent by Ishvari I shall give prema."
57. He sent Ishana to where Srinivasa was,
and quickly had the whip brought and kept it at his left.
58. With Ishana came the brahmana Srinivasa
and, approaching, bowed with joy in his heart.
59. He wept in prema with joined palms;
the Gosani rose and struck him with the whip.

60. "I have flooded you, flooded you!" he cried, striking with the whip;
Srinivasa was in great joy, his breast heaving with prema.
61. He struck three strokes of the whip there before his eyes;
then Malini⁹ came out and caught hold of his hand.
62. "You have flooded him with prema, Gosani, strike no more:
this brahmana boy is Chaitanya's power."
63. Taking him by the hand, she led him into her inner apartments;
the Thakurani showed him abundant compassion.
64. That night he spent happily at the Gosani's;
[in the morning he] called Ishana and gave him to Srinivasa as a companion.
65. "Srinivasa, go quickly to Vrindavana,
take shelter at the feet of Gopala Bhatta.
66. You will see Sanatana, Rupa Gosani and Lokanatha;
go and behold Raghunatha's renunciation in person.
67. Chaitanya's mercy cannot be fathomed at all:
through you he will flood everyone with prema.
68. Narahari is watching the road for you;
see him and then go to Vrindavana."
69. At the parting he wept long:
"Command me to remain at your feet always."
70. "I am utterly small, yet you have shown me mercy;
my desire is fulfilled — there is no illusion in this.
71. How shall I spend my time? I am only a child;
give me a command, so that my time is not wasted on a wrong path."
72. "Listen, boy, you do not know yourself:
Chaitanya has shown mercy to you.
73. You are Chaitanya's power to make prema manifest;
do not delay, set out quickly.
74. I too have placed power upon you:
on the way no one will oppose you."
75. With a joyful heart he prostrated himself
and took his leave, saying "Gaurahari!"
76. In this way he went in due course to Narahari,
prostrated himself and told him everything in detail.
77. Seeing his body radiant, he rejoiced:
"Go quickly to Vrindavana — you have obtained everything."
78. He came and took prasada; afternoon came on,
and Sarakara Thakura embraced Srinivasa.
79. He prostrated himself many times, falling to the ground;
his body quivered with prema, his eyes brimmed with tears.
80. "Delay is unbearable, my son; go to Vrindavana;
go quickly and your desire will be fulfilled.

81. Go to your mother, ask her humbly,
and set out on the journey with her leave."
82. In the evening he came and bowed at his mother's feet
and told her everything from beginning to end.
83. At the mention of going to Vrindavana she was stunned;
the grief of separation from her son swelled in her breast.
84. "The Lord took my husband; I have one son, Srinivasa;
how shall I, helpless and alone, go on living?
85. O cruel fate, what shall I say to you?
My son is going — I think you mean to blind me.
86. Leaving your mother alone,¹⁰ have you no fear?
How can you go, my son, and become so heartless?
87. How shall I stay at home — I do not know at all;
in the three worlds there is no one so forsaken."
88. Seeing his mother weep, he was grieved at heart
and, entreating her humbly, consoled her at length.
89. "My body was nurtured by you, I was born of you;
in no way can I repay my debt to you.
90. What am I to do? I cannot steady my heart;
give me leave quickly to go to Vrindavana.
91. Be merciful and command me to go to Vrindavana,
otherwise life will not remain in my body."
92. So both spent the night with separation in their hearts:
there was no sleep; only their souls tossed in anguish.
93. Towards the end of the night, after seeing a dream, he came to himself¹¹
and with a joyful heart rose and set out on the journey.
94. That night in Vrindavana Sri Rupa Gosani,
seeing Srinivasa's delay, was much grieved.
95. From separation from Sanatana illness had come upon his body;
rising at dawn, he went to see the samadhi.¹²
96. He wept long, calling "Srinivasa!":
"Still the sweetness of prema has not come!"
97. Full of anxiety he came to Jiva;
all were together on the bank of the Yamuna.
98. Seeing Sri Rupa, all prostrated themselves,
and he greeted and embraced each as was fitting.
99. "You all sit at ease on the bank of the Yamuna,
while Srinivasa has not come — he has fallen into trouble.
100. He set out to come to Vrindavana;
why has he been so delayed on the way?
101. As the form of prema he was born in a brahmana family;
somehow we would have met, had he come earlier.

102. You are renunciants, none of you will go to Gauda;
so there was no meeting, and now it is very late."
103. As he spoke, he took Sri Jiva by the hand:
"I have no other recourse — what am I to do?"
104. Listen, listen, Jiva, I tell you for certain:
he set out at night from Yajigrama.
105. Be all of you on the watch for his arrival,
until he comes to Sri Vrindavana."
106. Hearing this command, all felt boundless joy
and became attentive to carry it out.
107. I cannot describe the journey on the road in full;
what is needful, that I write in its order.
108. Ever joyful at heart he goes along the road;
in five days he reached Rajmahal.
109. A very young boy travels the road
and at times weeps, crying "Ha Chaitanya!"
110. "Where are Rupa, Sanatana, Raghunatha Bhatta?
When shall I have such fortune as to see them in person?"
111. Seeing Garhi-dvara,¹³ he reached Patna;
sometimes he fasts, sometimes he eats a little.
112. Once in two or three days he eats a roti or two
and spends the nights in gardens.
113. His golden body has dried up; he walks without food
and at times weeps in a choking voice.
114. Twice a day he unfailingly chants Hari-nama;
that day he crossed the Ganga and reached Varanasi.
115. At the ghat where Prabhu Chaitanya had bathed,
he went up onto the ghat and bowed.
116. North of the ghat is the house of Chandrashekara;¹⁴
to the left of the door there is a lovely spot,
117. where Sanatana Gosani, in the garb of a dervish,
sat longing for the sight of the Prabhu.
118. There is a tulasi platform there; he bowed to it,
and, leaving it behind, went into the inner part of the house.
119. Going in, he saw an aged Vaishnava
and bowed to him in deep humility.
120. He rose, embraced him and honoured him:
"Where have you come from, and what is your name?"
121. He told him: "My name is Srinivasa;
my birthplace is Chakhandi, near the bank of the Ganga."
122. Seeing him, the old man rejoiced
and began to tell everything from beginning to end.

123. "Sri Chandrashekhara Acharya is my guru;
by his command I live here — I tell you truly.
124. See, this is the place where Mahaprabhu sat;
I live here and serve — his command is binding on me."
125. Walking around it, he bowed;
now he wept, now he rolled on the ground.
126. "O pitiless fate, what shall I say to you?
You had me born like this only to give me sorrow.
127. Why was this sinner born so late?
I could not see Mahaprabhu's devotees."
128. He lamented long and wept long;
his grief grew and he lost consciousness.
129. Then at length Srinivasa came to himself;
seeing the signs of mahabhava, [the old man] grew very fond of him.
130. He fed him with great affection:
"My great good fortune today is beyond words."
131. The two spent the night in the delight of talk about Krishna,
and at dawn he took leave of him.
132. On the second day he arrived at Prayaga,
bathed at the Triveni and stayed there.
133. The next day he walked on and on along the highway;
a pious man put four paisa into his hand.
134. On that he managed for two days;
from the toil of the road his body grew thin and weak.
135. He asked how far Vrindavana was;
people said: "Four days' journey."
136. The next day, having bathed at a well,
he lay down to rest under a tree.¹⁵
137. From Vrindavana came five Vrajavasis
and sat down under a tree near the water.
138. Srinivasa saw that they were very tired
and gave them water: "Wash your feet, Thakuras."
139. Having bathed and done their remembrance, at the time for a light meal
they put chickpeas and gur into the end of Srinivasa's cloth.¹⁶
140. Sitting down, he ate, and his weariness went away;
they talked a great deal with one another.
141. All the good news of Nilachala and Gauda
he told, and all the Vaishnavas felt boundless joy.
142. "Tell us, Thakuras, in your kindness, about Vrindavana:
who lives where, who is staying where?"
143. They name them, and he bows:
"There live those named Rupa and Sanatana,

144. the two Bhattas, and one named Lokanatha Gosani,
Bhugarbha, Sri Jiva" — so they named them all.
145. "What shall I tell you, brother, if you would hear it all:
when Sanatana withdrew from sight, we felt great pain.
146. It is now four months since he withdrew;
just to hear of it, the soul writhes."
147. Bowing to them all, he goes on along the road,
as though mountains had broken and fallen on his head.
148. "Never since my birth have I known such sorrow:
where I was going to find happiness, fate has given me sorrow."
149. That day, sustained by that food, he walked very fast,
and the next day he reached Agra.
150. As he walked, his heart grew restless;
leaving the highway on his left, he went to Gokula.
151. Crossing the Yamuna, he goes to Nanda's abode
and with great humility beholds it and bows.¹⁷
152. At dawn he came to Mathura, the birthplace of Krishna,
offered prayers there and bowed.
153. Every place that is there he saw;
his body trembled and tears flowed from his eyes.
154. Seeing the beauty of Mathura, he reflects in his heart:
"I have heard from the scriptures that it is higher even than Vaikuntha."
155. A great hubbub, singing, someone dancing;
in this way he came to the Vishrama ghat, where Krishna rested.
156. He beholds it, touches it, sprinkles the water on his head,
and knows in his heart the good fortune of many births.
157. He sits gazing towards the east,
and three Vrajavasis go by, talking among themselves.
158. One speaks and another listens: "What will become of us?
Three have withdrawn from sight — there is great pain in our hearts.
159. First Sanatana withdrew;
some days after him, Raghunatha Bhatta;
160. and now Sri Rupa Gosani has withdrawn;
life will not stay in the body, the soul writhes."
161. Srinivasa hears what they are saying:
"Fate has turned my misfortune into utter hopelessness."
162. With joined hands he addressed them:
"What were you three saying to one another?"
163. They said: "Brother, what are you asking?
What shall we tell you of the pain in our hearts?"
164. Vrindavana is empty, yet death does not come;
in separation from Rupa life cannot be sustained."

165. As soon as he heard this, Srinivasa rose from the spot:
"What blame shall I lay on fate? My heart is bursting.
166. My eyes cannot see the road — where shall I go?
Fate has drowned me in an ocean of sorrow."
167. Until midnight¹⁸ he walks along the road;
weeping and weeping he goes, clutching his head with his hands.
168. Going some way in the direction of his homeland,¹⁹
he came to a tree and lay fallen beneath it.
169. All the torments that came into his heart at that time —
how much can I write? He alone knows them.
170. Steeling my hard heart, I have written this;
hearing it, the heart of this wicked one does not burst.
171. I write only because my guru's command is binding on me;
apart from that, what do I know? I am ignorant.
172. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fifth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. The Thakurani, Ishvari: here Jahnava, Virachandra's mother.
2. That is, a devotee.
3. Nityananda's, Jahnava's husband.
4. Srivasa (Srinivasa) Pandita, Mahaprabhu's companion in Navadvipa; the likeness of the names reminded Virachandra of him.
5. The books of the Gosvamis of Vrindavana about Radha and Krishna.
6. Abhirama's whip: according to tradition, anyone he struck with it was filled with prema.
7. A kara is a group of four cowrie shells; eight karas (32 cowries) is a trifling sum.
8. Couplets 54–55 are found only in the 1913 edition.
9. Malini here is apparently Abhirama's wife (not the wife of Srivasa).
10. Literally "making [yourself] motherless".
11. It is unclear whether Srinivasa or his mother is meant; taken as Srinivasa.
12. The tomb of Sanatana Gosvami in Vrindavana.
13. Garhi (Teliagarhi), the pass between Bengal and Bihar. This line is found only in the 1913 edition.
14. Chandrashekhara, a resident of Varanasi with whom Mahaprabhu stayed (not to be confused with Chandrashekhara of Navadvipa).
15. This couplet is found only in the 1999 edition.
16. Gur: unrefined cane sugar.
17. This couplet is found only in the 1999 edition; "Nanda's abode" (nandālaya) is apparently Nandagrama or Nanda's house in Gokula.
18. Literally "until two praharas of the night".
19. Literally "facing his country"; the sense is unclear, perhaps "wherever his feet took him".

Vilasa 6. The Vision of Rupa and Sanatana; Srinivasa's Initiation

Srinivasa's despair under the tree; Rupa and Sanatana appear to him; the meeting with Jiva at Govinda's temple; Gopala Bhatta; initiation before Radha-ramana and instructions on sadhana

1. Glory, glory to Gaurachandra, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Those two pairs of lotus feet are my shelter.
3. Now hear what I write, O hearers,
you whose life's treasure is the lila of Radha and Krishna.
4. To whoever tells and whoever hears, my obeisance.
[Here is] the full account of Srinivasa's state beneath the tree.
5. He weeps and rolls on the ground like a mad baul,
crying "Rupa! Sanatana!" and moaning "Alas, alas!"
6. "Whatever I long for turns out fruitless;
all the commands given me have proved vain.
7. In Purushottama I did not get to see Mahaprabhu;
with the Pandita¹ I did not get to read the Sri Bhagavata.
8. Sarakara Thakura commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana,
go quickly and see Rupa and Sanatana.'
9. Ishvari commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana,
see Rupa together with Sanatana.'
10. So Sri Jahnava Thakurani told me.
My life is leaving me — to whom shall I tell this sorrow?
11. How many offences have I committed through how many births!
I endure the pain of separation, and yet I do not die.
12. Leaving my own land I have come — to Mathura, or where?
I have not seen Vrindavana; my birth has been in vain.
13. I would have taken shelter at the Bhatta Gosani's feet,
but in separation from the two Gosanis how can life remain?
14. What is the use of going home? I did not get to see them;
my body is in vain — I have not gained shelter at their feet.
15. If Srinivasa dies, who will come to see him?
There remains the hope of attaining those feet in another birth.
16. Taking refuge in this dharma, how many, many people
float in an ocean of happiness, leaving sorrow and grief behind!
17. But all sorrows [fate] has laid upon me;
with what consolation can I console myself? My soul is shattered.
18. O Prabhus Rupa and Sanatana, masters of Srinivasa!
I never saw your forms with my own eyes."

19. In this way he lies on the ground beneath the tree;
his body is motionless, only breath remains.
20. Seeing Srinivasa weeping and crying out,
Rupa and Sanatana came and appeared to him in person.
21. "Rise, rise, Srinivasa, look — we are close by;
you are the Prabhu's image of prema, you are my very life.
22. All these days I have been watching the road for you —
how can life remain in separation from the Prabhu?
23. Why are you turning back, my son? Go to Vrindavana;
may your desire be fulfilled and your longing satisfied.
24. Take shelter at the feet of Sri Gopala Bhatta;
know for certain that through him my mercy will come to you.
25. I have told Sri Jiva about you;
read the books with him, keep his company."
26. He had not slept — Srinivasa rose at once,
and, rising, prostrated himself, offering obeisance and praise.
27. Rising, he gazes at their forms, the craving of the eyes;
standing, he beholds the splendour of the two brothers' bodies.
28. Their bodies golden and full, a thin shikha on the head,
tilaka on the brow, kanthi beads gracing the neck.
29. All over their bodies the two names "Radha" and "Krishna" are written;
over the kaupina an outer cloth is worn.
30. They count Hari-nama on the hand, uttering it with the tongue,
and now and then the names of Radha and Krishna sound forth.
31. The fragrance of their bodies is like kunkuma and other scents;
the rows of their teeth are lovely as kunda flowers, their smile sweet.
32. All sorrow went far away — [there was] an ocean of joy;
Srinivasa's heart became utterly intoxicated.
33. His mind overcome with ecstasy, he fell to the ground;
they themselves lifted him and placed their feet on his head.
34. Both vanished and went to their own place;
Srinivasa came to outward awareness and reflected in his mind:
35. "What more is there to do? Go, my mind, to Vrindavana!
The masters of the masterless are Prabhus Rupa and Sanatana.
36. Sri Gopala Bhatta Prabhu is my life;
may Sri Jiva Gosani show me boundless mercy."
37. Overwhelmed with feeling, he goes along the road,
not knowing whether it is night or morning has come.
38. Meanwhile Rupa and Sanatana themselves commanded Sri Jiva:
"Srinivasa has come.
39. In the evening, at the time of Govinda's arati,
he will surely come for darshan.

40. Seeing Govinda's form, he will be overcome with ecstasy
and in a frenzy fall on the left side of the doorway.
41. When you go for Govinda's darshan at that time,
search for him to the right and left of the doorway.
42. Console him and keep him in your own house,
and then take him to Sri Gopala Bhatta,
43. so that he may show mercy to Srinivasa;
and you, take him with you and read the books of bhakti with him.
44. Teach him those books for the sake of Gauda,
so that people may practise them, abandoning jnana and karma."
45. In the same way they went to the Bhatta Gosani
and told him in detail of Srinivasa's coming:
46. "He has come to Mathura and today will come to Vrindavana;
he will take shelter at your feet.
47. Show him special, boundless mercy,
so that he may go to Gauda with the books of bhakti."
48. Having said this, Sri Rupa vanished.
Now I write the account of Srinivasa's arrival.
49. Rapt in prema he goes along, dancing as he goes,
walking the road and looking to right and left.
50. With his eyes he sees a golden Vrindavana;
with his mouth he says: "Sri Govinda! Gopinatha!"
51. He saw the enclosing wall around Govinda's temple;²
at the sight his heart overflowed and could find no rest.
52. Streams of tears flow unceasingly from his eyes:
"I shall behold Govinda's lotus feet!"
53. Saying this, he arrived there in the evening;
flutes, vinas, pakhawajs and gongs resounded.
54. Standing behind the people, he gazes at the form
and sees tears raining from everyone's eyes.
55. Prostrating themselves, all went inside,
and Srinivasa came into the jagamohana.³
56. He sees Govinda's beauty, with joy in his heart:
as is the form, so are the qualities — just as it was described.⁴
57. Rupa composed an ashtaka⁵ on what he had seen,
and wove prema into it syllable by syllable.
58. Govinda's body surpasses Manmatha himself;
Srinivasa sank into it and found no bottom.
59. Rapt in feeling, he lies to the left of the doorway,
and people whisper to one another: what are they saying?
60. At this moment Sri Jiva arrived;
prostrating himself, he took darshan of Govinda.

61. Many people were with him, carrying lit torches;
the Prabhu's⁶ command had been given, and his heart was glad.
62. He went and saw him lying to the left of the doorway;
sitting down, he calmed him, laying a hand on his body.
63. He saw the intense feeling in the depths of his heart,
and with the people took him through the gate to his own house.
64. When the second prahara of the night came,
he said nothing; only his throat rattled.
65. Then Jiva knew that the ecstasy was coming to an end;
sitting near him, he laid a hand on his body.
66. After a while he cried out "Govinda!",
and tears flowed from his eyes, streaming down his breast.
67. Sri Jiva asks him: "What is your name?
Tell me, let me hear it; let my heart rejoice."
68. Prostrating himself, he gave his name as Srinivasa:
"I was born in a twice-born family; my village is Chakhandi."
69. "Friend, friend!" [Jiva] cried, and embraced him:
"Gauranga, the treasure-house of mercy, has brought you to me."
70. Such an ocean of compassion I have never seen:
Rupa and Sanatana have given wealth to a pauper."
71. The next day, rising, he said: "Listen, Srinivasa:
it is the Prabhu's command — come, go to the Bhatta Gosani."
72. Go and take shelter at his feet."
"As you command," said Srinivasa.
73. So saying, the two went to the Gosani,
and from afar prostrated themselves.
74. "I was born in a brahmana family; my name is Srinivasa;
if you command, I shall take shelter at your feet."
75. "Come, come, Srinivasa, come, my son!
How much affliction has fallen upon me in my old age!"
76. Approaching his feet, he prostrated himself;
in his mercy he placed his hand on his back.
77. Placing his feet on his head, he told him everything:
in separation from the two Gosanis he had suffered great pain.
78. "See, in this body of mine only bones are left;
to whom shall I go now for comfort?"
79. Why have you come so late, my son?
[You were] needed — I would have gone along with you.⁷
80. Why did you not come all this time, Srinivasa?
Everyone hoped to see you."
81. "Prabhu, I beg you: forgive my fault.
I had a great longing to read the Sri Bhagavata.

82. Because of my fault my heart was troubled;
I went once again to the Pandita Gosani.
83. I saw that book — it was in the Prabhu's own hand,
but all the letters were rubbed away, and I was much grieved.
84. The Pandita Gosani said to me:
'Bring a new book from Sarakara Thakura's house.'
85. With his letter I came to Khanda-grama;
I was given the book and came back to Purushottama.
86. While still on the way I heard that the Pandita Gosani had withdrawn from sight;
my heart was stricken and I was in dire straits.
87. Then in Navadvipa I saw the feet of Ishvari,⁸
and with her leave I went to Shantipur.
88. At Khardaha I saw the feet of Jahnava;
she commanded: 'Go and see Thakura Abhirama.'
89. Everyone commanded: 'Go to Vrindavana.'
All that happened I lay before you, Prabhu."
90. Hearing his words, the Gosani wept long
and fell senseless to the ground.
91. "My son, you are fortunate, and I am luckless;
for all those faults I suffer so much sorrow.
92. I never had the sight of Nityananda's feet,
I never saw Advaita-chandra — my life is fruitless.
93. Nor did I ever again see the feet of Ishvari,⁹
and Sarakara Thakura never once showed me mercy.
94. Fate has thwarted all these wishes of mine;
with all these sorrows life will not stay within.
95. And now both Rupa and Sanatana have withdrawn;
fate has fashioned my heart out of wood and stone."
96. Jiva was present, sitting on his seat.
"Fate has deprived me of everything good.
97. I am a sinner: they have all withdrawn from sight,
and through all these separations I cling to this worthless life."
98. Srinivasa weeps, fallen at the feet of both;
how many displays of that feeling can I write down?
99. In a changed mood Sri Jiva goes to his lodging;
Srinivasa bowed and took his leave [of the Gosani].
100. So the two¹⁰ remain in the delight of talk about Krishna;
knowing neither night nor day, they float ever in prema.
101. A good day and an auspicious hour were calculated,
and Srinivasa went with the Gosani.¹¹
102. They took a garland of tulasi manjaris and sandal paste;
carrying them in his hands, Srinivasa followed behind.

103. The two came to Sri Gopala Bhatta;
Srinivasa bowed and offered humble praise.
104. "Rise, my son; I shall speak — hear the word that is the essence."
Having heard him, Srinivasa spoke again:
105. "Mahaprabhu, the guru of the world — the dharma he practised
is all set out in the books of Sri Rupa.
106. The instructor is [guru] to the servant birth after birth;
so is the mood of following established — of the follower and the one followed."¹²
107. At that moment Sri Jiva said:
"As you have said, so accept him."
108. "Good, good," said the Gosani, and rose quickly,
and went with Srinivasa, joy in his heart.
109. To where Sri Radha-ramana disports himself
the two went for darshan.
110. Washing their feet, they bowed,
and, prostrating themselves again, entered the temple.
111. Knowing the time, Srinivasa bows:
"Come, come, Srinivasa, come near me."
112. He sat at the guru's left, facing east,
and with a joyful face beholds the Deity's form.
113. Holding his feet, he surrendered himself;
accepting him as his own, the Gosani said:
114. "Wash both hands once more,
and with joined palms meditate on the son of the King of Vraja.
115. At his left is Sri Radhika, enchanting beyond measure,
and Lalita, the manjaris and others, beautifully adorned."
116. He had him worship each of them separately,
offering tulasi manjaris, garlands, sandal paste and the rest.
117. Hand to hand he joined them all into their groups,
and made Srinivasa the maidservant¹³ of them all.
118. "Worship Sri Radha-ramana once more,
at whose feet all desires are fulfilled."
119. He put fragrant sandal paste on his breast,
and many tulasi manjaris were laid at the [Deity's] feet.
120. Placing his right hand on his head, he spoke the Hari-nama,
and then the rule of the five names of Radha and Krishna.¹⁴
121. Holding both his hands, he imparted the mantra of Radha and Krishna
and let him hear the kama-bija, counting on the fingers.
122. "These mantras you will remember
whenever you meditate, taking shelter in her.
123. Under the shelter of Guna Manjari you are Mani Manjari;
I shall tell you all about your group.

124. Rupa, Guna, Rati, Rasa and Manjulali¹⁵ —
these are the companions you are with; they are favourable to you.
125. The service follows the bhajana of raga that follows the ragatmika;
the words of Sri Rupa Gosani agree with this.
126. "Service" is the name of the sadhaka's great yearning;
when it is perfected, all this is attained.
127. The body performs sadhana, and so it is called "sadhaka";
know for certain that perfection lies in the shelter of a sakhi.
128. I have named many of the sixty-four limbs of sadhana;
understand clearly what is favourable and what is unfavourable.
129. Whatever is unfavourable, reject;
whatever is favourable is the cause of attainment.
130. [Guard against] all offences in service and against the Name:
entering the heart, they ruin bhajana.
131. The limbs of devotion to Krishna are the attainment through sadhana;¹⁶
if one does otherwise, sadhana flies off who knows where.
132. The mind fixed on Krishna is the cause of attaining Krishna;
by practising those limbs, attainment is assured.
133. Listen, Srinivasa, to how offence arises;
I shall tell and explain it in detail.
134. One who does not practise the limbs of bhakti himself and reviles [them],
[...]¹⁷
135. The banyan seed is tiny, but the tree is enormous —
so offence grows day by day.
136. Reviling the gods, causing suffering to living beings and the like —
the heart not drawn to these has bhakti in that measure.
137. When you see the scriptures, then you will know;
at that moment you will accept my words as true.
138. Having set out on this path, be careful;
bhajana of Krishna — the saints and scriptures are its proof."
139. The mercy shown to Srinivasa — in it is all perfection;
fate did not give me a hundred thousand mouths and a hundred thousand ears.¹⁸
140. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the sixth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Gadadhara Pandita in Puri (see vilasa 4).
2. Literally "circular enclosure" (cakrabeṛa). This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. The jagamohana is the front hall of a temple, before the sanctum.
4. The line is understood tentatively: Govinda's form is as Rupa described it (see the next couplet).
5. An ashtaka is a hymn of eight stanzas.
6. Rupa's and Sanatana's.
7. The sense of the line is unclear.
8. Vishnupriya (see vilasa 4).

9. Here apparently Jahnavā.

10. Srinivasa and Jiva.

11. Here with Jiva.

12. The couplet is unclear ("upadeśa kartā sevakera janme janme haya / anugatā anugata bhāvera niścaya"); the rendering is tentative. It is also unclear who speaks, Srinivasa or Gopala Bhatta.

13. That is, in the spiritual form of a manjari maidservant.

14. Unclear; perhaps a mantra of five names is meant.

15. Names of manjaris: Rupa, Guna, Rati, Rasa and Manjulali Manjari ("mañjulāmañjula" taken as "Manjulali Manjari").

16. A variant in the 1913 edition: "...in them is the attainment of rasa".

17. The second line of the couplet is corrupt in the 1913 edition and lost in the 1999 edition; it apparently says that such a person attains nothing and his bhajana is ruined.

18. To describe it. The end of the vilasa (couplets 134–139) is badly damaged in the 1913 edition and is restored from the 1999 edition.

Vilasa 7. Lokanatha and Bhugarbha

The descent of Mahaprabhu's companions: Vishvarupa and Nityananda; Lokanatha comes to Mahaprabhu in Navadvipa; a confidential talk on Radha's mood and the reason for sannyasa; teachings on raga and the mission to Vrindavana; the journey of Lokanatha and Bhugarbha

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Those lotus feet are my shelter.
3. Glory to the hearers! Listen with one mind,
give ear to a most wondrous account.
4. Whatever I have written here is all true;
I write at the command of the Prabhu, my shelter.
5. I write all this about the cause of the descent;
hearing it, you will find joy, and your pain will leave you.
6. When Krishna descended in Vraja,
the scriptures proclaimed it as Vraja and Vrindavana.
7. It is written that the circle of Vraja is eighty-four kroshas;
everywhere in it dwell Krishna's companions.
8. That same Krishna descended as the Lord of Navadvipa,
with mother, father, servants, friends and girl companions.
9. First of all Vishnu himself descended:¹
in Shantipur appeared Advaita, the crest-jewel [of devotees].
10. He is the crest-jewel of devotees, and so he is called Acharya;
through him [all the Prabhu's work] was accomplished.²
11. Madhavendra and others — twenty-four sannyasis:
eight, eight and eight more³ — these are treasures of prema.
12. All of them are Krishna's family in Vraja;
all who came with him I shall describe in detail.
13. Four kinds of friends and servants, five kinds of girl companions —
all this I write by command from the Prabhu's holy mouth.
14. Who was who before and after, and what each one's true identity was —
to avoid controversy I have written no more of it.
15. As I was commanded by the Prabhu to write,
so with deep faith I write it fully.
16. Shachi Thakurani, wife of Jagannatha Mishra —
know that her first son was Vishvarupa.
17. His beauty had no equal, and he was very learned;
seeing and hearing him, his mother and father rejoiced.
18. The house of Shachi's father was at Belpukhuria;
it is needed for the story, and so I write of it.

19. Yogeshvara Pandita was her father's eldest son,
[then came] Ratnagarbha Pandita; Shachi was younger than they.
20. His son, Lokanatha Pandita, rich in virtues,
went along with Vishvarupa wherever he went.⁴
21. They studied in one place with great delight;
what became of him I shall write a little at the end.
22. Both mother and father held [Vishvarupa] as dear as life;
after some days he came into Advaita's company.
23. He expounded the scriptures and spoke of much learning,
and in a short time plainly became a great scholar.
24. Weary of worldly life, he went off to distant lands;
his father and mother weep, their life nearly at an end.
25. He gave up shikha and sacred thread and took the staff,
and wore a kaupina and ruddy cloth.
26. His name became Shankararanya Puri;
what shall I say of all his kinds of virtue?
27. Pandita Lokanatha became his disciple;
he visits the holy places with him and serves him constantly.
28. After two years he attained perfection;
this, it is said, was the doing of Yogamaya herself.⁵
29. In Rarh there is a village called Ekachakra;
there lived a brahmana rich in virtues —
30. Hadai Pandita; his wife was Padmavati;
from her womb came the birth [of the Lord].
31. On the day of Rama-navami she conceived,
and the joy in the hearts of mother and father grew boundless.
32. Day by day the child grew in the womb, and ten months passed;
the joy of the brahmana and his wife kept growing.
33. In the month of Magha, in the bright fortnight, on the thirteenth day,
with every auspicious sign he was born at that moment.
34. They named him Nityananda, and all rejoiced;
at times he would stay stock-still, at times laugh aloud.
35. For fourteen years he played from house to house;
one day a sannyasi came to the house.
36. [Hadai] fed him with a joyful heart;
pleased, the sannyasi spoke these words:
37. "Hadai Pandita, hear my request:
give me one alms — I have need of it."
38. "As you command," he agreed.
"Give me as alms this son of yours.
39. In my old age he will take me round the holy places;
you will have every happiness — do not grieve."

40. Stricken by the parting, he placed his son in his hands,
and the sannyasi at once took Nityananda away with him.
41. He made him his disciple, but he did not take the staff,
and wandered with him in the guise of an avadhuta.
42. His heart was overflowing with the mood of Nanda's son;
what he did, where he stayed — he had no outward awareness.
43. That great soul was Ishvara Puri himself.⁶
One day he smiled and said to Nityananda:
44. "We have wandered through all the holy places there are;
do this one thing, my son, and all will be accomplished:
45. the son of Nanda has descended in Navadvipa;
seek him out with a joyful heart."
46. I write the simple account — [elsewhere] it is told at length;
just to hear it brings happiness and boundless joy.
47. Sankarshana and Balarama are one and the same being;
Vishvarupa and Shankararanya are a difference of form in different kalpas.⁷
48. At home his name was Nityananda, in the ashrama Avadhuta;
in the same way the son of Nanda is the son of Shachi.
49. All of Mahaprabhu's own companions descended [before him];
I write of them as I heard from the Prabhu's mouth.
50. After them he descended in Shachi's womb,
and the devotees descended in various lands.
51. On the full-moon day of Phalguna, at an auspicious moment, was the birth;
thus Mahaprabhu grew day by day.
52. As on the earth all the rivers and streams
come and meet together in the ocean,
53. so to Gaurachandra, the ocean of prema,
[the devotees] come one by one and join him with joy in their hearts.
54. East of Navadvipa is a land called Yashohara;⁸
listen further, I shall tell of it.
55. In it is a village called Talagadi;
there was born one named Lokanatha.
56. His father was named Padmanabha Chakravarti,
his mother was named Sita, the abode of every virtue.
57. They were high kulinas, as everyone in the land knew;
with great care they had their son educated.
58. In that land there was no scholar to equal him;
day by day more virtues entered into him.
59. His mother and father were anxious, seeing his state:
"If our son stays at home — that is our great hope."
60. They prayed especially to God
that Lokanatha should suffer no hardship.

61. A great fear constantly gripped his mother and father:
"If only by some good fortune our son would stay at home!"
62. They wished to get him married with all care;
seeing his parents' efforts, he reflected in his mind.
63. He thinks: "How am I to leave worldly life?" —
and every impulse of renunciation arose in his heart.
64. Constantly he remembers Chaitanya's feet;
his mind longs: "I shall go and see him."
65. In the month of Agrahayana, in the cold, having lain down to sleep,
he took counsel within his own heart.
66. At midnight he left the house and went out,
and went eight kroshas; morning came.
67. Rising, his mother and father did not see him
and wept long with stricken hearts.
68. That pain, that sorrow cannot be told;
he alone knows it in whose heart it arose.
69. Meanwhile he reached Navadvipa
and walked slowly, pondering.
70. Asking people the way, he goes to the Prabhu,
thinking in his mind: "What shall I do, what shall I say?"
71. When I see the Prabhu I shall tell him who I am;
but who knows whether the Prabhu will be kind to me?"
72. Saying this, at times he weeps and walks slowly on:
"Accept me!" he says, "Lord of my life!"
73. The Prabhu is seated, with devotees all around —
Gadadhara, Srivasa, Murari and many more.
74. Beholding the Prabhu's form, he weeps
and bows, his heart overflowing with prema.
75. He joins his palms, but what is he to say? No words leave his mouth;
at that moment the Prabhu rushes to embrace him.
76. "O Lokanatha, you have forgotten me!
How have you spent your time, to what lands did you go?"
77. Saying this, Gaura weeps as he embraces him:
"It seems fate has brought me a treasure.
78. I had been as one blind, forgetting everything."
Lokanatha weeps, clasping the Prabhu's feet.
79. Taking Lokanatha by the hand, he seated him beside him;
now he gazes at his face, now he laughs.
80. There too he met the Pandita;⁹
bowing, the two embraced.
81. "Having seen with my own eyes such a jewel as you,
after so many days my eyes have been blessed with good fortune."

82. All were in great joy, rapt in talk about Krishna;
no one had outward awareness, all floated in the ocean of prema.
83. He met Nityananda, Advaita and all the others;
he bowed to them and they embraced him.
84. Thus for five nights his meeting with the Prabhu went on;
they relished much talk about Krishna and kirtana.
85. One day the Prabhu said: "Listen, Lokanatha:
how did you leave worldly life and come here?"
86. He told in every detail how he had come:
"All sorrow is unreal; these feet alone are real.
87. How I could break free I do not know:
you put the rope of mercy around my neck and drew me here."
88. Thus Mahaprabhu, sitting in seclusion,
called Lokanatha and gave him a command.
89. Holding his hand, he said: "Listen, Lokanatha:
to whom shall I tell the sorrow that rises in my heart?
90. Why have I come, and where are you all?
That work is not being accomplished, and my heart aches.
91. To Nityananda, Advaita and all the devotees
I shall speak to each according to his realization.
92. But the realization of my own heart — to whom shall I tell it?
Seeing me, some revile me, some go away laughing.
93. Taking on Radhika's mood I have come to Gauda,
[...] a joy boundless and special.¹⁰
94. For my sake Radha gave up caste, family and wealth;
leaving everything, she surrendered her very self.
95. She made me the lord of her life; in separation from me
day and night she pines for my beauty and my virtues.
96. Her body has become like a lotus-stalk fibre,
her clothing soiled, she wanders like a madwoman.
97. Hundreds and hundreds of times she blames the Creator:
'He did not give me a hundred thousand eyes, as I wished.'
98. With her eyes she looks on no other man's face;
she hears of my virtues and speaks of them with her mouth.
99. She is ever restless for union with me,
and speaks of it so much from grove to grove on the Yamuna's bank.
100. I am a rogue, impudent, an utter libertine,
turning truth into untruth, a cheat and a deceiver.
101. And yet, if she sees me face to face,
her pique departs and she feels a hundred thousand joys.
102. And if on some day there is no meeting with me,
a moment's separation she reckons as a hundred yugas.

103. She whose love is such, whose longing is such —
even the scriptures cannot tell such virtues of hers.
104. She who sports in Vrindavana is my beloved;
she is my life, and I am her life.
105. For her sake I dwell in Vrindavana,
and day and night I think of her play.
106. That rasa of which friends, servants, father and mother are deprived,
that rasa which enchants [me] — only the sakhis know it.
107. For her virtues and her love I remain in her debt;
this I have told you, Lokanatha.
108. That is one sorrow of my heart; hear another thing:
seeing me, a certain brahmana went away reviling me in every way.
109. Earlier he committed an offence against me;
it has borne fruit, and he does not know it.
110. Not knowing that Krishna is the guru of the world,
he wanders about drunk with false pride.
111. He says that Krishna's body is [nothing...],¹¹
and, leaving such feet of Krishna, clings to another shelter.
112. From his¹² mouth [the brahmanas] were born, yet he does not accept it;
he worships one thing, says another, and drinks wine.
113. Holding Krishna's power, he is mighty in the world,
yet what Vyasadeva wrote he twists into something else.
114. He will not call Krishna guru, but worships a maidservant;¹³
for this offence how many will go to Yama's abode!
115. Having left Krishna, his mind has lost its strength;
he does not know that such a person is lower than a shudra.
116. That is one sorrow, and there are other matters too;
I shall tell — hear a little of the reason for this.
117. Between lies the month of Pausha; in the bright fortnight of Magha,
on the third day, I shall take sannyasa, for all to see.
118. All brahmanas accept the staff-bearer as their guru;
I have told you this firm resolve of my heart.
119. Truly, for the sake of these brahmanas I shall take sannyasa,
leave home and wander from land to land.
120. That is the outward reasoning; and now the intent of my heart —
listen, Lokanatha, I tell it to you for certain.
121. The whole purpose is to take on Radhika's mood;
who will understand, who will hear what is in my heart?
122. The colour of my body Radha wears as her clothing —
that is why blue garments give her such delight.
123. In separation from me she wears ruddy cloth
and ever regards herself as my own maidservant.

124. For my sake Radha and her companions,
distraught in separation, were ready to give up their lives.
125. I too shall give up my life for her sake;
that state will come — you will remain and hear of it.
126. I shall take on her lustre and wear ruddy cloth,
and with a joyful heart become her servant.
127. That is why I shall clothe my body in ruddy cloth;
I shall chant her virtues — so I have told you.
128. All her virtues I can never repay,
even if I had a lifespan of a hundred births on earth.
129. For her virtues and her love I have become her debtor;
this I have told you, Lokanatha.
130. I shall flood the world with her fame and glory —
then I shall know that she has shown me such mercy.
131. I shall attain her prema, my eyes will weep,
and, grey with dust, I shall dance in sankirtana."
132. Saying this, Gaura-raya weeps aloud
and, crying "Radha! Vrindavana!", rolls on the ground.
133. Lokanatha held the Prabhu in his arms and calmed him;
but as he spoke of Radha's virtues, he began to tremble.
134. "How much sorrow, how much joy — my heart knows;
only the groves of Vrindavana are witness to it.
135. Rise at dawn and go to Vrindavana;
after you will come Rupa and Sanatana,
136. and those named Sri Gopala Bhatta and Raghunatha Bhatta,
and then Raghunatha Dasa, a treasury of virtues.
137. All gathering together in Vrindavana,
they will describe the lila in books and perform their own bhajana.
138. As I have told you, so I shall tell Rupa,
and send him off, infusing him with power.
139. I shall say more — hear what is in my mind:
as that shelter is, so is the attainment, and so the bhajana.
140. To make it firmer still I say it again:
when one hears from the guru's mouth, everything becomes certain.
141. The lila that is my cherished goal — that is the worship;
can other people come to know it?
142. You are the crest-jewel of the wise, you know every secret;
still I shall tell you the essence of that dharma.
143. The scriptures speak of full, fuller and fullest;
the difference of forms points to a difference in substance.¹⁴
144. There are two kinds, svakiya and parakiya;
hear also the views on this.

145. All the women of Dvaraka are called svakiya;
among the parakiya, know that the gopis are the best.
146. The maidens devoted to the vow of Katyayani —
know for certain that they are in that same Vraja.
147. Among them there are two chief group-leaders in Vraja:
Radha and Chandravali are there.
148. The natures of the two are of two kinds:
Radha and hers are vama, Chandravali dakshina."¹⁵
149. As he spoke, another state came over the Prabhu;
holding Lokanatha's hand, he began to speak:
150. "There is one desire of my heart, a kind of corollary;
in that which is of gain to me you shall be my helper.
151. In another body the perfected devotee forgets the lila
and regards himself as entirely like prakriti."¹⁶
152. Chaitanya himself instructs him,
and as he listens he remembers everything.
153. Such is the Prabhu's mercy to the perfected devotee;
only he whose mind is firm knows it.
154. What I shall do, what I shall say, the word of my heart —
that will become the renowned scripture in every way.
155. When I send Rupa and Sanatana to Vrindavana,
they will reflect on many books and treatises.
156. All of you together will approve it well;
let no one slight it — that would grieve me."
157. Lokanatha said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
dispel my doubt and purify my mind.
158. Vyasadeva wrote many books
and set forth in them the bhajana of Krishna.
159. But not all of that accords with this way of bhajana;
give your command, Prabhu, I bow before you."
160. "Kalas, amshas, vilasas and the rest are one self, one form;
hear what is the nature of each one's lila.
161. Descriptions of all this in the scriptures are endless,
but the worship of Vraja is not set out in detail there.
162. Dasya, sakhya, vatsalya, madhura — the essence of the moods;
here no one accepts aishvarya."¹⁷
163. And to compose on the mood of madhurya —
no one's mind enters into that.
164. The way of madhura no one knows;
madhura is known to him to whom its account is [revealed].
165. One qualified for another rasa does not know this love —
in it is the lila of the hero with his beloved.

166. Radha's dear attendants know its bounds;
no one else knows its greatness.
167. This parakiya lila is most profound;
no one else knows its inner heart.
168. The Bhagavata, the Puranas and the rest are Vyasa's descriptions;
in them power and majesty are made manifest.
169. All this bhajana he did not set forth;
what is set forth there is aishvarya and the like, mixed with knowledge.
170. So that people might be careful in entering [the path],
he wrote in them of the excellence of Krishna's bhajana.
171. Where each one dwells, with whom each stays —
who has the power to describe it?
172. Sri Rupa saw Krishna's lila with his own eyes;
still I shall infuse [him] with power.
173. For firmness, what he hears from his guru's mouth
he will describe with joy and delight.
174. From the scriptures and converse with the saints deep prema arises;¹⁸
one surely leads to the company of the other.
175. He will bring many scriptures, and their intent will be shown;
when the events of the lila are set forth, the meaning will be understood.
176. He will place established proofs among them;
seeing firm statements, all will accept them.
177. Where that rasa is not found in those scriptures,
he will write the word of his heart, full of rasa.
178. Just now he¹⁹ is in the king's presence;
in my mercy I shall send him after you.
179. All will be together in that Vrindavana
and spend their time together relishing the lila.
180. They will propagate the worship of Vraja in the scriptures,
by which the son of Nanda is attained.
181. What should and should not be done, what is gain and what is loss —
hearing this, all people will take shelter.
182. In this is my joy; this is the word of my heart;
and then whatever I say will fully agree with that.
183. Age after age people worship Krishna,
but who attains Radhika's feet?
184. All those firm scriptures of many kinds —
hearing them, I shall have boundless joy.
185. I myself shall be intoxicated and intoxicate²⁰ the people of the world —
for this my heart pines every moment —
186. so that people may attain Radhika's two feet
and practise bhajana and remembrance, leaving sorrow and grief behind.

187. For your sake I shall beg alms of her;
to whom else shall I tell the sorrow of my heart?
188. Wherever the lord of Radha's life performs his lila,
there, together with all the sakhis —
189. I have no power to describe it.
I am a poor sannyasi, and I have a need:
190. I shall eat myself and distribute to all the people of the world;
let them know that you have made me rich with your wealth.
191. In my sorrow you will be sorrowful, in my joy joyful;
whenever anything happens, write and send me news.
192. And I shall write and send to all of you,
and through those letters you will know what is well and what is ill.
193. Go to that place, your own Vrindavana;
if I have the good fortune, I shall get to see [it]."
194. I am ignorant and foolish — how much of this can I write?
I write what I have heard; devotees, do not find fault.
195. "Hear something more, O steadfast one;
what I say, hear with a steady mind.
196. If one gives up everything — the dharma of varna and ashrama —
he alone knows the inner essence of that dharma.
197. One who holds to varna and ashrama does not have exclusive shelter,
and Krishna himself does not accept him.
198. After staying some days in Nilachala I shall come to Gauda,
and, having renounced everything, wander in the garb of a pauper."
199. Lokanatha said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
hearing from your holy mouth, doubt is dispelled.
200. Hearing this, my heart was amazed;
I have a request — please accept it.
201. If such followers of varna and ashrama go beyond varna,
then all will take shelter at Krishna's feet.
202. Whoever worships whomever, he accepts him;
having taken shelter, where will the soul go?"
203. The Prabhu said: "Lokanatha, listen once more:
what you have asked — hear it to the end.
204. [People of] the four varnas and ashramas took shelter in Krishna;
[hear] by what bhajana Krishna shows them mercy.
205. Hear it carefully, with a steady mind:
the scriptures to be read and the intent of the saints are deep.
206. He who can understand gains Krishna's company;
whoever transgresses [this order] is broken by it.
207. The people of Vraja do not regard Krishna as God:
they always serve him in love and float in prema.

208. For that joy they gave up everything;
and they have one more mighty saying:
209. the mark of raga is that it does not take the reasoning of scripture;
he who does thus attains that treasure.
210. He who, abandoning karma, performs bhajana turned towards raga,
attains such feet.
211. He who in body, speech and mind holds another view
does not attain Vraja — that is another aim.²¹
212. If one does this, all those moods are attained in this body;
if not, the nature of sadhana is attained in another body.
213. Lokanatha, you have forgotten your own nature:
who you are, where you dwell, what your mood is,
214. in which group you are, what your name is,
whom you serve, wholly absorbed.
215. You are the sakhi Manjulali, of old a companion of Radha;
your service is to anoint her body and put on her girdle of bells.
216. You are ever at play with Radhika,
and, regarding yourself as a maidservant, you serve her constantly.
217. Happy in Radhika's happiness, sorrowful in her sorrow —
such is the renowned sakhi devoted to service."
218. As he heard this from the Prabhu's mouth, everything was revealed to him;
gazing at his face, he began to weep.
219. "Intoxicated with that rasa, stay in that place;
save my life — go to Vrindavana.
220. Girikunda, Govardhana, Javata, Varshana,²²
Sanketa, the secluded groves, all the places of the lila:
221. live in those places and your heart will be happy;
leave your attachment to me and set out on the road.
222. Dwell there where your birthplace is,²³
perform bhajana and remember Kishora and Kishori.
223. Chir-ghat, Rasa-sthali, the rows of kadambas,
and to the east of them a grove of supreme sweetness.
224. Tamala, bakula and banyan trees grow there;
live in that place and your heart will be happy.
225. Rasa-sthali, Vamshivata, Nidhuvana —
rest in the midst of Dhira-samira.
226. Bathe in the Yamuna, live on alms you do not ask for,
perform bhajana and remembrance, and teach living beings.
227. Become perfected — from you a branch will spring,
and its followers will be past counting.
228. Rupa and the others of your circle will soon come together;
then you will know [everything], when all are gathered."

229. The night passed; in the morning the Prabhu was seated;
saying something to Lokanatha, he seated him beside him.
230. The Prabhu said: "Lokanatha, go to Vrindavana;
all sorrow will leave you and you will find your own happiness.
231. I have told you the pain of my heart only as instruction."²⁴
Rising, the Prabhu embraced him with love.
232. He prostrated himself, and [the Prabhu] placed his feet on his head,
and then began to weep, holding his hand.
233. "I have given you my own land, Vrindavana, as a gift."
Lokanatha lost outward awareness and began to weep.
234. Who but the master and the servant can understand all this?
Who knows what the two of them experienced?
235. Gadadhara Pandita was there;
his disciple Bhugarbha made a request:
236. "Prabhu, command me too to go to Vrindavana;
I have had this wish for many days — be merciful."
237. Mahaprabhu said: "Gadai, give your leave:
let Lokanatha and Bhugarbha go together."
238. Gadadhara said: "Bhugarbha, go with him;
the two of you will go happily, delighting in talk about Krishna."
239. Bowing, they set out for Vrindavana,
and the devotees joyfully raised the cry of Hari.
240. When Lokanatha Gosani went to Vrindavana,
the Prabhu wept in distress.
241. Gadadhara weeps for his Bhugarbha;
why he sent him and why he weeps — who can understand?
242. The master and the servant know, but no one else knows
in what manner the two departed.
243. So [the Prabhu] joyfully disports himself in Navadvipa
together with Nityananda, Advaita and the other devotees.
244. Now hear attentively what I shall write,
for the words of the Prabhu's heart are of great import.
245. The two go along the road rejoicing;
in their feeling for Gaura, their hair standing on end, they fall to the ground.
246. Now they walk along rapt in talk of Krishna,
now they sing aloud of Gauranga's lila.
247. In humility, weeping, they say: "Prabhu, ocean of mercy,
show me even a drop of mercy, Prabhu!"
248. Step by step they arrived at Rajmahal,
and the two considered how to go on.
249. At that time, for fear of robbers, people did not travel;
[fearing that] the Prabhu's command would go unfulfilled, they lamented much.

250. The two deliberate long: which road should we take,
by which road shall we reach the sight of Vrindavana?
251. They ask people: "Brothers, which road should we take?"
And they reply: "You will not be able to get to Vrindavana."
252. The two consider: "Tell me, brother:
if we go by the Tajpur road, we shall fare well."
253. At dawn they set out, remembering their Prabhu,
and so they came to the village of Purnia.
254. Hope rose in their hearts, and they go by that road;
after some days they arrived at Ayodhya.
255. "Will such a day come that we reach Vrindavana
and see with our own eyes all its places and groves?"
256. The Prabhu's command will be kept and our desire fulfilled" —
thinking of all this, they weep.
257. The two love each other as friends, each the other's companion —
that is why Gaura, the ocean of mercy, gave them this command.
258. Then in some days they went to Lucknow,
and on the third day they arrived at Agra.²⁵
259. The Yamuna flows there; they bathed and drank,
and, counting themselves blessed, went on their way.
260. At the end of the second day they reached Gokula;
seeing Krishna's birthplace, they were overwhelmed.
261. "O friend, what great fortune — we have seen the birthplace!
There is no friend as merciful as Gauranga."
262. Gauranga had instructed them about all the places;
the next day they entered Vrindavana.
263. I make my plea at the feet of the Vaishnava Gosanis:
hear a most wondrous account.
264. I wish to make known what else I have heard;
let it pain someone's heart — for me it is joy.
265. Gadadhara, dear to Gauranga, is his own shakti;
let no one admit disbelief in this.
266. I do not know — Gauranga himself knows;
what loss or gain there is in it, he knows.
267. Gadadhara descended in the form of Krishna's beloved;
only he knows it to whom his mercy is great.
268. Bhugarbha Mahashaya, whose name is Nandimukhi,
has great love for Lokanatha.
269. Manjulali and Nandimukhi love each other dearly;
Gauranga let them be together — know this for certain.
270. Chaitanya-chandra himself is the guru of the world,
merciful to living beings, a wish-fulfilling tree.

271. He is qualified for every rasa, he is the goal and what is attained;
that is why he is worshipped by all.
272. He took on the mood of a devotee and established dharma;
the Prabhu, the treasure of my life, knows his own devotees.
273. As many virtues as Gaura-raya has, so many has [his] devotee;
why then does he give instruction to such a devotee?
274. Speaking in dreams, he reveals everything to the devotees;
they can hold the Prabhu's virtues but cannot hold his power.
275. When Lokanatha Gosani wandered through Vrindavana,
the Prabhu's power was infused into him in the course of it.²⁶
276. Like a madman he roams about, looking at everything,
and seeing the places of the lila, at times rolls on the ground.
277. Seeing the beauty of Govardhana, he goes to the bank of the kundas;
seeing fields on the two kundas,²⁷ he weeps aloud.
278. He saw with his own eyes barley and wheat sown there,
and recognized in his heart which lila had been at which place.
279. All the groves of the girl companions' kundas had become [fields];
now his body trembles, now he laughs.
280. The next day he went to Javata, Radhika's abode,
and, recognizing one thing after another, weeps over all the pastimes.
281. He recognized where each of the girl companions had lived,
and there he knew in his heart his own house.
282. All the sorrow that arose within him —
he stands as if transfixed and says nothing to anyone.
283. Then he went to Nanda's abode and saw all the places;
what tale of virtues there is, he alone knows.
284. Then he went to Sanketa and wandered through the groves,
now bowing, now crying "Alas, alas!"
285. Taking Bhugarbha by the hand, he says:
"Tell me, in which place was which lila?"
286. As they spoke, both lost consciousness in ecstasy
and, crying "Radha, Radha!", weep and fall to the ground.
287. That day they stayed in that place;
seeing them, the people of Vraja rejoiced.
288. Having considered, all took them for great siddhas
and brought them wonderful things to eat.
289. The next day, on the hill of Varshana,
the two view the places, their bodies filled with prema.
290. In the morning they go to bathe in the lake,
and, deep in thought, come to the bank of the kunda.
291. Having walked round again, they stay in that village;
the people of Vraja showed the two great love.

292. The next day in Vrindavana they go to the Kaliya-hrada;
he says to Bhugarbha: "Do you remember, brother?"
293. Recognizing the places, they go along the road,
wander through the settlement and come to Rasa-sthali.
294. Seeing it, they knew that Nidhuvana lay ahead,
and, heaving deep sighs, they weep and fall to the ground.
295. Going on, they reached the Chir-ghat
and saw the forest at that ghat, gazing at it.
296. "Where shall we settle?" — they can find no place;
looking everywhere, they wander through all the forests.
297. They saw that place, those trees and creepers,
and, settling there, they remained there.
298. "Gauranga, I shall not see your feet again;
I have stayed here holding only to your command.
299. The lila that the Prabhu will perform with his devotees —
of that he has deprived me and sent me here.
300. When shall I see Rupa and Sanatana with my own eyes?
Then I shall count my life blessed."
301. With cries of anguish he pleads at the Prabhu's feet:
"When will the Prabhu send Rupa and Sanatana?"
302. Then my life will hold — there is no other way;
who knows my sorrow? To whom shall I tell it?
303. I have stayed, making your command my support;
fulfil my desire quickly."
304. Not far from each other the two perform sadhana;
day and night they perform the sadhana that is in their hearts.
305. All the people of Vraja, brahmanas and good folk,
seeing them, ponder in their minds:
306. "Hear of one more wonder:
two brahmacharis have come here.
307. Going to Dhira-samira we saw them,
and we understood in our hearts that they are not human.
308. Sacred thread on the shoulder — how handsome they are!
What brahmachari forms, like Madana himself!
309. All these days we never knew or saw the like;
are they gods or gandharvas who have descended?"
310. All the people of Vraja who go hoping to see them
meet with respect and kind words from them.
311. To all they say: "Follow the teaching about Krishna,"
and hearing it, all are filled with joy.
312. What a manner of bhajana is theirs, all see;
whoever sees them carries out their bidding.

313. People bring so many provisions from distant villages
that a hundred thousand could not eat them.
314. Utterly detached, they say nothing to anyone;
all the people of Vraja hold them dear as life.
315. Without seeing them for a moment, people cannot live;
whatever they command, people carry out.
316. Of all the days the two lived in Vrindavana —
how much can I write, setting it forth?
317. I write this account at the command of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra;
hearing all this, you will feel no pain.
318. When Srimati Thakurani²⁸ went to Vrindavana,
I, a wretch, was with her and saw it.
319. Brother Ramachandra Dasa and many Vaishnavas
who were with the Thakurani saw it all.
320. [They saw too] how Ishvari herself, at Rupa Gosani's place,
met all the Gosanis as they came.
321. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the seventh vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Advaita is held to be an incarnation of Maha-Vishnu.
2. The second line of the couplet is corrupt in both copies; rendered by the sense.
3. Literally "eight, eight, three" (aṣṭa aṣṭa tina), apparently three times eight, i.e. twenty-four.
4. This Lokanatha Pandita, son of Ratnagarbha (apparently Vishvarupa's cousin), is not Lokanatha Gosvami, of whom more below.
5. The line is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
6. So in the text.
7. The couplet is understood tentatively.
8. Jessore (in present-day Bangladesh).
9. Gadadhara Pandita.
10. The beginning of the second line is lost. In the 1913 edition there are fragments of one or two more lines here ("...mōre", "āsvādana nāhi..."); in the 1999 edition the whole passage is missing.
11. The line "kahaye kṣṇera tanu eka datta kare" is unclear.
12. Krishna's: according to tradition, the brahmanas were born from the mouth of the Purusha.
13. Apparently a goddess (an allusion to Shakta worship); the sense is unclear.
14. The line is understood tentatively.
15. Vama ("contrary") and dakshina ("compliant") are types of heroine in the poetics of rasa.
16. The couplet is unclear; the rendering is tentative.
17. Here, in Vraja.
18. Variant: "...prema grows deeper still".
19. Rupa, then in service at the court of the Sultan of Gauda.
20. Variant: "I myself shall dance and make others dance".
21. The couplet is corrupt in the 1913 edition and lost in the 1999 edition; the rendering is tentative.
22. Javata (Yavata) is Radha's village after her marriage, Varshana her father's village. Variant: "Girikunda, Nandishvara, Javata, Varshana".
23. Apparently the place connected with his eternal form as a sakhi.

- 24. Variant: "in brief I have told the pain of my heart".
 - 25. Variant: "on the twenty-third day".
 - 26. The line is understood tentatively.
 - 27. Apparently Radha-kunda and Shyama-kunda, at that time ploughed over as fields.
 - 28. Jahnava.
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Vilasa 8. The Prema Left for Narottama

The glory of sankirtana; Mahaprabhu turns back from Kanai Natashala; in kirtana he calls Narottama; his talk with Nityananda about Garerhat; Mahaprabhu entrusts prema to the river Padmavati for the future Narottama

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the Merciful One!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, the shelter of devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Vishvambhara, the embodiment of compassion!
Glory, glory to Advaita-chandra, grace to the world!
3. Glory, glory to Virachandra, the ocean of prema!
Glory, glory to Gaura's devotees, crest-jewels of the connoisseurs of rasa!
4. Glory, glory to Gauranga with the host of his devotees!
Whoever hears the story of Chaitanya obtains bhakti.
5. Listen, listen, O hearers, attentively;
hear with faith a tale of prema.
6. The ornament of Gauda is the great sankirtana:
at the mere hearing prema arises — this I say firmly.
7. Hari-nama-sankirtana is this great power;
in the Kali age there is nothing else — all else is false.
8. From a single name of Hari comes every perfection;
by sankirtana prema is born in one's body.
9. In the body of one who has no attraction to Hari's name,
there is no prema — it flies off who knows where.
10. Whoever has the desire to attain Krishna,
let him take Hari's name with great joy.
11. Whatever one's attachment, let all take Hari's name;
taking the Name by count fulfils the heart's desire.
12. Now hear the account of Narottama's birth;
hearing it, you will find joy, and your heart will turn to kirtana.
13. The Prabhu was to go from Gauda to Vrindavana,
but he did not go to Vrindavana — he turned back from Kanai Natashala.
14. That story is told at length in earlier writings;¹
[here] I only describe the virtues of Narottama.
15. At the ghat of Tartipur² he crossed the Padma,
and seeing the beauty of the Padmavati he rejoiced.
16. Claspings Nityananda round the neck, he sat down right there:
"I shall not go to Vrindavana; I shall stay here."
17. Hearing the Prabhu, Nityananda laughed:
"Leaving Navadvipa, you took sannyasa,
18. and now you have conceived the intention [to live] on the bank of the Padmavati!"
"Good, good," said the Sripada,³ and began to laugh.

19. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, pay attention:
where one sits happily, that is one's birthplace.
20. The reason for which I left Nilachala —
when you meet him, you will hear it all."⁴
21. The Prabhu said: "That is the truth, this is no lie;
I shall explain in detail, listen if you wish.
22. When I am together with Sanatana and Rupa,
then all the Acharyas will hear all of this."
23. "Good, good," and the Prabhu rose quickly
and came to a village near Gauda,
24. named Chaturpura, not far [from there];
there was a meeting with Sanatana, full of prema.
25. Having accomplished the purpose of that meeting,
from there he went on and arrived at Natashala.
26. Hearing the village's name, "Krishna's Natashala,"
prema surged in his body, mistaking it for Vrindavana.
27. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, ever since you left the Padmavati,
you have had a mind to live on a river bank."⁵
28. Listen, listen, O hearers, attentively:
the Prabhu's intentions cannot be understood at all.
29. One day Mahaprabhu, dancing in kirtana,
suddenly called out the name "Narottama!"
30. Leaning his whole body against Nityananda,
he wept, and hundreds of streams flowed from his eyes.
31. Seeing these transformations of prema, [Nityananda] reflected
and, seized with fear, stopped the kirtana.
32. Surrounding the Prabhu, all the kirtaniyas
sing Krishna's name in sweet voices.
33. "Sing, sing!" cried the Prabhu, and fell to the ground,
and Nityananda Prabhu could no longer hold him.
34. Crying "Mathura, Mathura!" he weeps;
hearing it, the devotees' hearts break.
35. At the name of Mathura he lost all sense of direction;
the village of Natashala quaked with prema.
36. The Prabhu weeps aloud, calling "Mathura!";
Nityananda sat down, holding the Prabhu round the neck.
37. Everyone cried out, a great tumult arose;
the housewives and others came to see.
38. Crying "Mathura, Mathura!" he rolls on the ground;
the Prabhu's golden body lies sprawled on the earth.
39. Seeing the Prabhu's beauty, the sweetness of prema,
men and women gaze at his form without blinking.

40. He roars "hum, hum," saying "Mathura!";
the Prabhu became intoxicated with prema like a mad baul.
41. "Where is Radha? Radha!" he says again and again,
"My body burns when I do not see you!"
42. Where are Lalita and Vishakha, where is Champakalata?
Ah, show me — where is my friend, dear as life?
43. Show yourself and save my life — why do you give me sorrow?
I shall throw myself into the Yamuna; I cannot go on living.
44. Come quickly, friend Lalita, let us go to Madhupuri;
why can I no longer see the lord of my life?"
45. Seeing him distraught, the Prabhu⁶ sat holding him
and began to think: "What am I to do, what will happen?"
46. Let us go — why did we come to the village of Natashala?
We have lost Gorachand!" he thinks to himself.
47. The Sripada found a means in sankirtana:
he loudly raised the cry "Jagannatha!"
48. At the name of Jagannatha the Prabhu regained consciousness
and for a while wandered here and there.
49. Calling "Narottama!", the Prabhu weeps unceasingly;
he looks in every direction, but does not see Narottama.
50. All say: "Let us take the Prabhu to Nilachala;
then all my good fortune will be complete.
51. If somehow we can turn the Prabhu's mind,
once we have crossed the Padmavati we shall have everything."
52. At that moment he again calls out "Narottama!"
[They thought:] "It seems some best of bhagavatas is to come."
53. Clasp the Sripada, the Prabhu embraced him,
and Nitai's body was drenched with tears.
54. With effort they calmed the Prabhu,
and, knowing the time had come, Nityananda too grew composed.
55. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
there is great need to go to Jagannatha.
56. Krishna forbade [this road] through Sanatana's mouth:
he told of the crowds of people and the dangers of the way."
57. "Whatever you think best, do that;
whatever you do will be — I am not my own master."
58. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, listen attentively:
there is a reason why we came to Natashala."
59. "What business is there, Prabhu? Tell me, let me hear;
if it seems right to me, I shall take [you] — then I shall agree."
60. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
in the sankirtana you remembered Narottama.

61. So shall I take you, or shall I not go with you?⁷
I have no strength to hold you in the waves of feeling.
62. Seeing the pain of separation, I cannot bear to look;
I think: better that I should die this very moment."
63. The Prabhu said: "Garerhat is a most delightful place;
as soon as you see it, you will want to stay.
64. Listen, listen, Sripada, I shall explain in detail:
I wish to preserve here the sankirtana, the treasure of my life.
65. In Navadvipa the sankirtana was made manifest,
but I have left Gauda and live in Nilachala.
66. From now on I wish to preserve the sankirtana:
I shall lay up prema at Garerhat — so I tell you."
67. "How will you keep prema at Garerhat, Prabhu?
Who is the vessel to whom you will give such prema?"
68. The Prabhu said: "As long as you are present [in the world],
so long my prema will not disappear.
69. If this prema is kept with a worthy vessel, it remains;
if it falls on an unworthy one, prema is wasted.
70. The earth, drunk with prema, does not know proper place from improper;
give prema to such a person that all may drink of it.
71. So come, brother, let us go to Garerhat:
giving prema to such a person, [I] shall make the ghats and the roads weep."
72. "Good, good," said the Sripada, and fell silent,
and began to think how such a vessel would be born.
73. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, I see you are pondering;
you yourself do not know your own virtues.
74. All that you wept on the way to Nilachala —
that prema I have gathered and bound up day by day.
75. That prema I shall lay up on the bank of the Padmavati
and give it to a vessel named Narottama.
76. His birth will be through prema while I am still [in the world];
for now I shall leave it in the keeping of the Padmavati."
77. Nityananda said: "Prabhu, where is Garerhat?
Take me with you and go there."
78. "Both banks of the Padmavati are very cool,
and between them the Padmavati flows in a pure stream."
79. Hearing this, Nityananda's heart rejoiced:
"Make haste, Prabhu, and go there."
80. On the pretext of [the journey to] Vrindavana he came to Garerhat;
thus he turned back from Natashala.
81. Holding Nityananda's hand, laughing and laughing,
he began to speak, seeing the beauty of the Padmavati.

82. So he came to the village of Kudodarapura,⁸
and, seeing the beauty of the bank, was full of joy.
83. There he stayed, in talk about Krishna,
and at dawn the Prabhu went to the Padmavati.
84. Having bathed, the Prabhu began kirtana on the bank;
with roars of "hum, hum," overflowing with prema, he shook violently.
85. How shall I behold that prema, what is its meaning?
A thousand people were not able to hold him.
86. At that moment he cried out "Narottama!"
The Sripada said: "[He is] stealing the play of prema."⁹
87. Listen, listen, devotees, be on your guard:
at this moment, I surmise, he is going to take the prema."
88. At Nityananda's words the devotees were startled,
and Nityananda stopped the kirtana.
89. With the kirtanias the Prabhu began his bath,
and the Padmavati, drunk with prema, began to rise.
90. At the touch of the Prabhu's body the current stood still,
and all the water was filled with prema.
91. Rising and rising, the water flooded the village;
we understood that in this way he flooded [it] with prema.
92. Houses and homesteads floated away; there was an uproar in the village;
"This is not the rains," but no one could understand.
93. The Sripada said: "Prabhu, keep the prema properly;
the village is being laid waste — I have never seen the like."
94. The Prabhu said: "Padmavati, hold it, take the prema;
give this prema to a vessel named Narottama.
95. In Nityananda's presence I have placed prema with you;
keep it carefully and in secret."
96. The Padmavati said: "Prabhu, I beg of you:
how shall I know who is named Narottama?"
97. "At whose touch you overflow the more,
he is Narottama — give him the prema."
98. The Prabhu said: "All is as you have said;
keep the prema at this ghat — I command it."
99. The joyful Padmavati kept it by the bank:
in seclusion she hid the prema at a secluded ghat.
100. The Prabhu stood up to take leave of the Padmavati,
and with Nityananda gazed in that direction.
101. The current moved on, flooding [the nearby] villages,¹⁰
then let go of the water, and the people rejoiced.
102. The Sripada said: "Prabhu, seeing such beauty,
I too have been tempted to stay here.

103. You will cause Narottama to be born and give him prema;
I think you will [abide] near Narottama."¹¹
104. The Prabhu said: "Sripada, it is as you have said:
near Narottama alone do I abide."
105. Then the Prabhu crossed the Padmavati,
and, going on step by step, the Prabhu came to Nilachala.
106. All say: "What sort of thing is this prema?
Who would call dancing and singing prema?"
107. Weeping and falling down too we do not call prema;
who can describe it, who has the capacity?"
108. In the form of prema is Krishna's very self;
this Sri Rupa himself has explained.
109. I write only a particle of it, that it may be known;
by the strength of the Prabhu's command I write this with my hand.
110. [...] ¹² —
and how many more tales there are of her virtues!
111. Thus I have told the sweetness of Garerhat;
with great longing I shall tell of the prema of kirtana.
112. The Vaishnava who hears of this prema with faith
will soon obtain this treasure of prema. ¹³
113. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the eighth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Cf. the Chaitanya-bhagavata and the Chaitanya-charitamrita, which describe how Mahaprabhu turned back from Kanai Natashala.
2. Both editions have "tartibapura" (Tartipur); the reading of the name is uncertain.
3. Sripada, a respectful title of Nityananda.
4. The sense is unclear; perhaps Narottama or Sanatana is meant (cf. couplet 24).
5. This line is found only in the 1913 edition; the second line of the couplet is lost in the 1999 edition.
6. Nityananda.
7. Variant: "So tell him that I shall not go with you."
8. Variant: "Kutubpur".
9. The sense of the remark is unclear.
10. The line is corrupt ("srota calila ... jākti-/jābhigrāma chāilā"); it may contain a village name.
11. Variant: "why, I wonder, will you [abide] near Narottama?"
12. The first line of the couplet ("nava-putra deva rati kanyā tāra mātā" in the 1913 edition) is unclear; perhaps Narottama's kin (son, daughter, mother) are listed.
13. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.

Vilasa 9. The Birth of Narottama

Why Mahaprabhu left prema in Gauda; Virachandra; the plan concerning Narottama and Srinivasa; signs and Narayani's dream; the astrologer's prediction; the birth of Narottama and the universal rejoicing

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. From the road to Vrindavana [Mahaprabhu] came to Nilachala,
and through Vaishnavas he sent prema to Gauda.
3. With Nityananda the Prabhu took counsel in private:¹
"Gauda has surely been left without bhakti."
4. Nityananda Prabhu came to Gauda
and revealed the treasure of prema in all its endless fullness.
5. In the form of prema Virachandra appeared
and began [the work] so that prema would remain hereafter.
6. To the feet of such a Virachandra — millions of obeisances:
from him prema spread through Gauda.
7. All these wondrous events are hidden from people;
no one has written this inner truth in the shastras.
8. Therefore I write — listen attentively;
there is a reason for it, and so I write this.
9. Sri Chaitanya, Nityananda, Advaita and the other devotees —
all of Chaitanya's circle are devoted to this.²
10. In the Kali age they descended in various lands —
all of them, by a former word, at Chaitanya's command.
11. Through the sankirtana of Hari-nama living beings became intoxicated;
for his own secret purpose Chaitanya came.
12. Even if his own circle does not know it,
it is present both inwardly and outwardly — the shastras are the proof.
13. All this Gaura-raya tastes,
and Svarupa and Ramananda assist him in it.
14. The Prabhu tastes it in his own heart;
others taste it by ascertaining the shastras.
15. By the Lord's command shastras come to light;
therefore he sent a letter to Vrindavana.
16. [Those who] went to Vrindavana, the land granted them by Chaitanya,³
none of them will come to Gauda again.
17. One composes a shastra and the others assist;
for this reason they all always stay together.
18. Then Gauranga reflects in his own mind:
"When I go, the world will be left without prema."

19. Those who came with me will go [with me] in every way;
by what means, then, will prema be preserved?"
20. For this reason — two manifestations of prema:
Narottama in Garerhat, Srinivasa in Rarh.
21. What I write, I write by the strength of the Prabhu's command;
otherwise how would I ever know all this?
22. Above all, there is Sri Rupa's description;⁴
I tell [it] — let no one think otherwise.
23. What was seen — all this I write down;
whoever writes it, such a description is accessible.⁵
24. I myself, who write this, am devoid of all power;
the strength of my Prabhu's command — that alone is skilled.
25. As the command is, so I write — do not find fault;
listen according to your need.
26. The Majumdar⁶ performed the worship of his chosen Deity:
for the sake of a son he offered tulasi to the shalagrama.
27. The Lord was pleased by this, and a voice came from the sky;
these words resounded: "A son will surely come.
28. A wondrous son will be born" — all heard it.
"His name is Narottama; [this] I tell you.
29. A boy will be born, and you will have great joy;
everywhere there will be a rain of prema — so I have said."
30. The Prabhu wishes to preserve prema, the eternal substance;
in the month of Vaishakha there will be a conception.⁷
31. Narayani was the name of Raya's wife;
at the conception the whole earth rejoiced.
32. She who was named Narayani, a woman of spotless conduct,
called the Majumdar and tells him a marvellous thing:
33. "This is not a thing to speak of openly — listen attentively
and keep it carefully in your heart."
34. Narayani says: "I saw a dream:
a jewel of a man entered my body."⁸
35. From your body he entered into mine;
such a dream I saw at the end of the night."
36. [The Majumdar] became intoxicated with prema, and his joy was boundless;
everything became joy, there was no more sorrow.
37. One day an astrologer came to the assembly
and, choosing an auspicious moment, began to calculate.
38. The Majumdar [sat] in the assembly with his ministers and friends,
and that man, taking a book in his hand, began the reckoning:
39. "The boy who will be born from Narayani's womb —
at his birth there will remain no grief or sorrow in the land.

40. In this womb a mahapurusha abides;
misfortune will be dispelled, and good will come to Raya."
41. At that time a letter came from the zamindar;⁹
with many assurances he sent a man.
42. In that letter were two thousand coins¹⁰ —
all the astrologer's words were proved true.
43. The astrologer says: "Day by day joy will grow;
as soon as he is born, the misfortunes of all the subjects will depart."
44. The astrologer said: "I give him the name Narottama;
in the highest goal [of life] he will be most excellent.
45. This holy month of Magha that is now coming —
on the fifth day of the bright fortnight he will appear."¹¹
46. Having heard this, they dismissed the astrologer,
honoured him and gave him much wealth.
47. Ten months and ten days came to completion;
the days were counted one by one, and the dark fortnight passed.
48. On the fifth day of the bright fortnight, at an auspicious moment,
at the hour of cow-dust,¹² the jewel of a man appeared.
49. Seeing her son's face, the mother rejoiced;
in that joy the Majumdar smiles softly.
50. Of the joy there was then, what can I say!
The world was filled with blessing — hear the song of his virtues.¹³
51. *Sri-raga*:¹⁴
The world was filled with blessing — Narottama appeared,
Hari-nama in every house.
The blind from birth and all the rest — every body filled with prema,
tears and trembling on everyone's frame.
52. [There rose] the great cry of Hari-nama,¹⁵ all were intoxicated with prema,
all [distinctions of] varna and ashrama went far away.
Brahmanas and shudras play together, all were intoxicated with prema,
all became heroes in [chanting] Krishna's name.
53. The cows together with their calves, lowing incessantly,
all run with their tails raised over their heads.
Brahmanas recite blessings, some run headlong,
abandoning grief and sorrow, all dance.
54. The wives of good families cannot go out of their houses,
yet their hearts long to dance.
All things grow irksome to them — wealth, home, husband and kin:
without seeing [the child] they cannot live.
55. Gathering together: "When shall we all see the boy?" —
they humbly entreat the Creator.
At night, together with their husbands, they came to see the boy
and in joy gaze upon his face.

56. All cast off shame and fear, their hearts full of joy —
 they cannot stay at home.
 Now they rush hither and thither, now they cry, "Alas, alas!
 This pain we cannot bear!"
57. Filling platters with gold and paddy, they go together;
 the house was filled with gifts.
 Seeing the boy's radiance, like the full moon,
 the dark house was lit up.
58. To the bards and dancers — various jewelled ornaments;
 much wealth was given to all.¹⁶
 The prisoners were set free, and they all ran off —
 so sings his praises Nityananda Dasa.

Thus ends the ninth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Literally "Nityananda Prabhu took counsel in private"; by the sense, Mahaprabhu and Nityananda take counsel together.
2. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
3. "dattabhūmi", "the granted land": Vrindavana, where Chaitanya sent Rupa, Sanatana and the other Gosvamis.
4. Probably Rupa's teaching on prema is meant (cf. ch. 8, couplet 108).
5. The sense is unclear. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "whoever describes it, [describes] what he has seen and experienced".
6. Majumdar, an official title (revenue collector); here Krishnananda Raya (Datta), Narottama's father.
7. Vaishakha, April–May.
8. "puruṣa-ratna", "a jewel among men"; the newborn is so called below (48).
9. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition. The zamindar is the landholder to whom the Majumdar was subordinate.
10. Apparently two thousand coins were granted (or remitted) to the Majumdar in the letter — the fulfilment of the predicted good fortune.
11. The fifth day of the bright fortnight of Magha (January–February), the festival of Vasanta Panchami.
12. "godhūli", "cow-dust": evening twilight, when the herds return.
13. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
14. The name of the raga to which the song is sung. What follows are tripadi stanzas, each under one number.
15. The beginning of the stanza is restored from the fragment "harināma mahārava" printed separately at the foot of the page in the 1913 edition; in the 1999 edition the first part of the stanza is lost.
16. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "All there was in the house, all the gifts they received — all was given to the brahmanas."

Vilasa 10. Narottama Receives Prema from the Padmavati

Narottama's childhood; in a dream Nityananda bids him receive prema; the Padmavati gives Narottama prema and he turns golden; his parents' grief; the exorcist; the summons to the ruler and Narottama's departure for Vrindavana

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaita-chandra, glory to the host of Gaura's devotees!
2. Glory, glory to Srinivasa, the shelter of the rasa of bhakti!
Glory, glory to Narottama Thakura Mahashaya!
3. Glory, glory to Shyamananda, king of rasa among devotees!
Glory, glory to Ramachandra Kaviraja, best of devotees!¹
4. As soon as he was born, musicians took their seats at the door;
for eight days the auspicious rites went on.
5. Hundreds of brahmanas from the villages, reciting sacred tales,
read the Vedas for the son's sake — the sound of the Vedas resounds.
6. The days were counted one by one, and six months passed;
with great care they performed the annaprashana.²
7. At an auspicious moment mother and father put rice into his mouth;
with great joy they fed the brahmanas.
8. They held a great feast for the kinsfolk, a large gathering;
to each they distributed gifts as befitted him.
9. The king³ heard of the beautiful boy
and sends gifts of every kind — gold, silver and many other things.
10. Through his agent he sent all the gifts,
and they put golden ornaments on [the boy's] body.
11. When he was five years old, his ears were pierced,
and when the time came for study, they put chalk in his hand.⁴
12. Listening to lessons together with [other] boys,
he then began to read books.
13. He came to the age of twelve;
seeing his beauty, his father and mother rejoiced at heart.
14. For the marriage they called an astrologer in private:
"No delay can be borne — arrange the marriage quickly."
15. Seeing [his parents'] efforts, he grew afraid,
and at that time he firmly resolved in his mind to leave home.
16. That very night in a dream came Nityananda Prabhu,
laid his hand on his breast and smiles softly:
17. "Why are you so unconcerned — have you forgotten everything?
In the morning go and receive prema from the Padmavati.
18. Go to bathe — at your own ghat you will obtain it;
if you marry, you will later fall into trouble."

19. At that Narottama awoke;
not seeing that form, his anxiety grew.
20. Looking neither at father nor mother nor anyone else,
in the morning he rose and went to bathe in the Padmavati.
21. He went along the road alone, chanting Hari-nama;
seeing the Padmavati, he bowed down many times.
22. Saying "Gauranga!", he came and stood on the bank,
and to bathe he went down into the water.
23. At the touch of his feet the Padmavati surged up:
she remembered the words of Chaitanya Prabhu.
24. "He at whose touch the transformations of prema arise in you,
to him you will hand over prema" — so he had firmly said.⁵
25. "Surely this is that Narottama who has come to me" —
and Padma humbly speaks these words:
26. "For you Chaitanya Gosani
has left prema — take that prema from me.
27. Listen, listen, Narottama, this is my request:
leaving prema, the Prabhu went to Nilachala-puri.
28. Take what is yours, holding out your hands:
my strength cannot bear the weight.
29. Under the weight of prema the Padmavati has lost all discernment;
take this prema and preach it everywhere."
30. Because of that prema the Padmavati is restless to this day;⁶
from the transformations of prema her heart is agitated.
31. Heeding no direction, she floods with her waters,
and no longer do all people dwell on her banks.⁷
32. "The two brothers⁸ left prema with me;
take what is yours, and you will find joy in your heart."
33. Narottama says: "What shall I do if I take prema?
What will happen if I take it — I shall see right now."
34. So saying, the Padmavati took him by the hand,
and Narottama went along with the Padmavati.
35. Under the weight of prema, the Padmavati, having found Narottama,
lifted up the prema in rapture and placed it in his hands.
36. The Padmavati says: "Where will you keep it?
If you eat it, intoxication will come; listen, noble one."
37. Holding out his hands, he took the prema from the Padmavati
and, his body racked with thirst, he ate it.
38. As soon as he ate it, his body became golden;
he laughs, weeps, dances, sings — he was filled with prema.
39. Not seeing Narottama, [at home] they raised an uproar;
all received word that Narottama was on the bank of the Padma.

40. Weeping, they came to the riverbank;
not seeing Narottama, they were beside themselves.
41. Because Narottama had eaten prema, his colour had changed;
not recognising the boy, they fell into great distress.
42. They do not see their son — they see a golden child;
not seeing their own son, they were overwhelmed with grief.
43. "Ah, ah, Narottama!" they cried, and fell down on the bank;
hundreds of thousands of people gathered at the Padmavati ghat.⁹
44. Even pregnant women came, walking slowly;
all the people weep, distraught at heart.
45. Of all this Narottama knows nothing;
he has no outer awareness and looks about in all directions.
46. People do not understand what it is — he is like a baul:¹⁰
now he leaps and falls, now suddenly runs.
47. What a sight his body is — blood at the pores of his skin;
crying "O Gauranga!", now and again he laments.
48. At times his body becomes like a dry log,
now it trembles with bristling hair, now it rolls on the ground.¹¹
49. Amid the clamour of the people and his mother's weeping,
mother and father went [to him], and he came to his senses.¹²
50. Mother and father see: he laughs, dances, weeps —
Narottama has fallen into Chaitanya's snare.
51. Seeing his mother and father weeping,
Naru¹³ stands in the midst of all the people.
52. "Here I am before you, mother — why do you weep?"
"Let us go home, child, listen to me!"
53. Saying "Child, child!", she took Narottama in her arms
and kissed his lotus face hundreds of times:
54. "My Narai, a blind woman's staff, my child!
In the blink of an eye, child, I lose you.
55. Seeing you golden, dear one, I cannot recognise you;
yet the sweetness of your beauty is a balm to my eyes.
56. Come, come, dear one, come, let us go home!"
But he cannot walk along the road — he keeps dancing.
57. For the press of the crowd they cannot move along the road;
it seemed as though he had begun to dance in sankirtana.
58. Again and again he gives thunderous shouts and roars without end,
weeps with his face turned upward, a hundred streams from his eyes.
59. The way home became endless;
seeing their son's condition, [the parents] lost their wits.
60. Again and again he leaps, again and again he runs;
the earth seems to split from his repeated falls.

61. Seeing this, mother and father were beside themselves;
holding him together, they calmed him and sat him down.
62. He cannot sit on the ground and lay down;
in the madness of prema, as if in a swoon, he lost consciousness.
63. The mother kept [people] from coming to the outer gate;
taking Naru in her arms, the mother entered the house.
64. Laying him down gently, they left him in solitude;
overcome by grief, mother and father fell to the ground.
65. After a while Naru begins to weep —
hearing it, even a stone would melt.
66. "Chaitanya, Chaitanya!" he cries, slapping his arms:¹⁴
"Not seeing your face, my life is breaking apart!"
67. To whom shall I tell my sorrow, who will believe me?
Mother, my heart does not wish to stay at home."
68. Hearing Naru's words, she was beside herself;
clasping Narottama by the neck, she began to weep:
69. "Listen, listen, my child, why is it so?
For what sorrow do you weep, dear one? Tell me, let me hear.
70. Let me rather die before you:
my heart is breaking, the grief is unbearable."
71. Seeing his mother's grief, he grew afraid at heart:
"Do not worry, mother, I beg you.
72. I am tormented by hunger, mother — bring me something to eat;
when I have eaten, I will tell everything right here."
73. All the food was already prepared;
with great care they fed him all of it.
74. Having eaten, he sat down beside his father
and began to speak: "I have fallen into great trouble.
75. A golden child entered my heart;
since then my life has become like this.
76. I will not stay here — I will go to Vrindavana;
do not try to keep me."
77. As he spoke, prema arose in his body;
his tears drenched both his body and his clothes.
78. He cannot hold his body still, such a trembling came over him;
again and again he leaps with his feet together.
79. Now he calls, "Lord of my life, Gauranga!",
now, coming out into the courtyard, he falls headlong.
80. "We have lost our son!" weep the mother and father;
both of them weep with heads bowed.
81. "Our son went alone to bathe in the Padmavati,
and since then our son has lost his senses.

82. When asked, he stands up and weeps bitterly;
crying 'Gauranga!', he weeps with his hand on his breast.
83. Some golden god [has entered] our son's body;
bring an exorcist to drive out that spirit."
84. With great effort they brought that exorcist:¹⁵
"Tell us in detail what spirit has seized him."
85. The exorcist says: "It is no spirit but some deity;
know for certain that this is the great disease of wind."¹⁶
86. Kill a jackal and prepare shiva-ghrita:¹⁷
the disease will not remain, and the sweetness of his beauty will return."
87. Hearing of the jackal, [Narottama] began to laugh:
"Father, will you keep me by killing a living being?"
88. If out of love for your son, father, you kill a jackal,
the disease will not be cured but will grow worse.
89. Father, mother, it is no disease — I will go to Vrindavana!"
Uttering the name of Vrindavana, he weeps.
90. Father and mother say: "We will take poison and die:
not seeing you, dear one, we will lose our lives.
91. Never say such words again, dear one —
will you go off as a beggar, leaving house and home?"¹⁸
92. Naru says [to himself]: "Now a great calamity has come:
I shall no longer get to see Vraja and Vrindavana."
93. In his mind Narottama devised a stratagem
and began to act like a worldly man.
94. To his father and mother he says: "I am well;
do not grieve on my account."
95. Seeing this, father and mother are very glad;
but when night comes, Narottama is in torment:
96. "How shall I go to Sri Vrindavana?
Otherwise life will not remain in my body."
97. All night long Narottama gets not a moment's sleep,
while father, mother and household are all content.
98. At this time a [horseman]¹⁹ of the jagirdar
came to take Narottama and sat down at the door.
99. [The letter said:] "On reading this letter, come — I wish to see your son;
I shall bestow on him a robe of honour and a horse."
100. Yet out of love for his son [the father] was greatly afraid
and pondered in his mind what course to take.
101. Taking his ministers and friends, he sat down beside Naru
and told him in his ear: "They have sent for you."
102. "Good, good!" said [Narottama], and began to laugh,
and told his father: "I will go with the horseman."

103. His mother says: "Light of my eyes, you shall go nowhere!
Even if I were offered a hundred thousand, I would not send you."
104. Narottama speaks to his mother and father:
"If I go, that king will be pleased at heart."
105. They brought an astrologer and fixed an auspicious day;
at the departure they entrusted Naru into [the horseman's] hands.
106. In his heart Narottama rejoiced:
"Prabhu Nityananda has come to my aid."
107. [The mother says:] "If you go to the king's court, what shall I do?
Not seeing you, dear one, I cannot live.
108. Come back in ten days or so, dear one, quickly;
when you come, we will joyfully get you married.
109. If you go, dear one, then without you
I will go to Vrindavana — so I have resolved in my mind."²⁰
110. [The father] consoled Naru's mother in many ways,
brought Narottama and handed him over to [the horseman]:
111. "Keep Naru carefully, close to your breast;
wherever you go, keep him always before your eyes."
112. Taking his son by the hand, he went out of the house;
taking his son in his arms, he kissed him many times.
113. Naru prostrated himself and took his leave,
turning back again and again to look.
114. Laughing, he hastens along with the horseman,
while in his heart prema surges in waves of emotion.
115. As he goes, he reflects: "Choosing a good moment,
[...] I want to go."²¹
116. That night he does not sleep but stays awake all night:
"How wondrous is Chaitanya's mercy!
117. Prabhu Nityananda has shown me mercy" —
from agitation and joy of heart there is no sleep for him.
118. When the people had fallen fast asleep,
he rose and, saying "Nityananda!", went out.
119. Saying "My Prabhu Chaitanya!", he goes westward;
on the road Naru looks round lest anyone see him from behind.
120. Little by little he got away, and the guards remained [behind];
Narottama was gone — and the news reached his home.
121. Then the mother, receiving the news of Naru,
came out of the house and fell down:
122. "Naru, why have you left your helpless mother?
Not seeing you, dear one, I shall give up my life!
123. Ah, my Naru, my son, where have you gone?" —
with dishevelled hair she weeps like a madwoman.

124. "I do not know where my Naru has gone, leaving me;
cruel Providence has given me such sorrow!
125. How will Naru's tender body walk?
Tormented by hunger, whom will he ask for food?
126. At the time of running away, Naru, you showed such affection —
where have you gone, leaving your helpless mother?
127. Is there anyone who will bring back my Naru?
I will give him everything, whatever he asks."
128. All the kinsfolk gathered together;
to console her, they all sat holding her:
129. "We will send men to catch Naru and bring him back;
how far can he have gone? We will surely find him."
130. They sent out many men in all directions:
giving a hundred coins, they sent a hundred men.
131. The men searched in every direction;
they found him, but he would not come back — so they hurried to report.²²
132. They tried hard but could not turn him back;
they gave him money for the journey and one man to go with him.
133. Returning, the men brought word to the house:
"We tried hard, but even so he did not come back."
134. Hearing that he had not come back, the mother fainted;
crying "Ah, ah, Naru!" again and again, she fell to the ground.
135. All the people went to console the rani;²³
in the rani's despair her heart was breaking.
136. Whoever hears of the manner of Naru's departure,
by that very hearing renunciation grows strong in him.
137. Such is the way of one to whom Chaitanya is merciful;
now I will write of how he journeyed to Vrindavana.
138. All day long he makes no effort to eat;
he eats only after two or three days of fasting.
139. From walking along the road great sores came up on his feet;
he lies beneath a tree, unconscious:
140. "My journey to Vrindavana has not succeeded;
I have not seen the feet of Prabhu Lokanatha!"
141. So saying, he remained lying beneath the tree;
crying "Prabhu Lokanatha!", he was distraught:
142. "Where is Prabhu Gaura-raya? I cannot see him."²⁴
What will become of me, where shall I go?
143. I shall not see Prabhu Rupa and Sanatana with my eyes;
who knows the sorrow of my heart?
144. Hearing [of them], longing arose — but where shall I find them?
I do not know what I shall gain or lose, what will become of me."

145. Now hear of Narottama's condition:
beneath the tree the waves of prema rose up.
146. Who could tell of all the separation he felt?
On hearing it the heart breaks and finds no footing.
147. [There came] a golden brahmana with a pot of milk:
"Narottama, drink this milk.
148. Come, dear Narottama, drink this milk:
your sores will heal, and you will go on your way with ease."
149. Leaving the milk, that brahmana vanished,
and [Narottama], worn out by the journey, fell into a deep sleep.
150. At the end of the night both Sanatana and Rupa came;
laying a hand on his breast, they say: "All your troubles are over.
151. Listen, listen, Narottama, drink the milk:
Sri Chaitanya Prabhu himself came and gave you the milk.
152. We two brothers have come to see you;
come, come, Narottama, let us go to Vrindavana.
153. Gauranga himself brought you the milk:
seeing your exhaustion and pain from the road, he showed great mercy."
154. At this Narottama came to his senses,
and in separation from the three he wept much.
155. "Ah, ah, Gauranga! Where are Rupa and Sanatana?" —
rolling on the ground he weeps, his mind overpowered.
156. How much can I tell of his weeping and sobbing at that time!
Who has the power to describe his condition then?
157. Seeing his distress, Rupa was moved;
unable to bear it, the two came near him.
158. By the fragrance of their bodies he obtained their visible presence;
looking around, his heart was choked with emotion.
159. Their two bodies surpass the lustre of gold;
the sacred thread shines on their shoulders, their lips are red.
160. What rows of teeth! Their smile is a heap of nectar;
on their heads a very fine shikha; they speak with a smile.
161. A lovely tilaka shines on their foreheads;
necklaces of tulasi beads adorn their necks.
162. The two brothers count Hari-nama on the fingers of both hands
and from time to time call out: "Prabhu Chaitanya Gosani!"
163. Thus [Narottama] saw them beneath the tree.
"Listen, listen, Narottama," they say, and tell him something:
164. "This childhood age is no time for renunciation,
yet the Prabhu's mercy upon you is boundless.
165. You, a prince, have never known a trace of sorrow;
in leaving home the body suffers great hardship.

166. You go alone along paths through mountains and caves —
know that this is how Mahaprabhu's mercy comes.
167. Do not worry — rise, dear one, go to Vrindavana;
knowing your heart, he showed himself to you for this.
168. The Prabhu has placed prema within you;²⁵
with it you will flood the whole world.
169. In it many chandalas and yavanas will float;
your followers will cover the whole earth.²⁶
170. The two Prabhus appeared in Gauda
and filled the world with the play of prema.
171. For the sake of their play they are two — yet are they not one life?
Know for certain that there is proof of this.
172. In this his mercy is mighty;
he carefully made it known to his own and to others.
173. We two brothers — what wretched fools we are!
yet he implanted his own power in us."
174. Sanatana says: "Listen, Narottama:
in the two bodies he is one and the same life.
175. In the same way Narottama and Srinivasa:
when the Prabhu became unmanifest, you two appeared."
176. Hearing these words, Narottama gazes at their faces,
humbly offers praises and prostrates himself.
177. He weeps bitterly and rolls on the ground;
the two placed their feet on Narottama's head.
178. Thus I have told of Narottama's journey
and the vision he received on the way beneath the tree.
179. How Sanatana and Rupa showed him mercy —
this I have described by my Prabhu's command.
180. Whoever hears this with faith
will soon attain the feet of Radha and Krishna.
181. One to whom Gauranga himself is merciful
abandons worldly life, and renunciation is born in his heart.
182. [One to whom] Rupa and Sanatana show deep mercy
has his heart's desire fulfilled and his heart full of joy.
183. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the tenth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Ramachandra Kaviraja, the closest companion and disciple of Srinivasa Acharya.
2. Annaprashana, the rite of a child's first feeding with rice.
3. Apparently the local ruler, overlord of Narottama's father; below (98) he is called a jagirdar.
4. "hāte kharī", the rite of beginning to learn letters: chalk (or a slate pencil) is put into the child's hand and he is taught to write his first letters.
5. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "to him you will hand over prema, my deposit".

6. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
 7. An allusion to the turbulent and changeable nature of the river Padma, which often shifts its course and erodes its banks.
 8. Chaitanya and Nityananda.
 9. The second line of the couplet, as well as couplets 44 and 45, are found only in the 1913 edition.
 10. A baul, a wandering mystic singer, a "madman" of divine love.
 11. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "now it trembles with bristling hair, now he breathes heavily".
 12. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; who "came to his senses" — Narottama or the parents — is unclear from the text.
 13. Naru, Narai: diminutive names of Narottama.
 14. "mālasāṭa", slapping the arms or thighs with the palms, a wrestler's gesture of challenge; here a sign of frenzy.
 15. An ojha, an exorcist who drives out spirits, a village healer.
 16. "mahā-vāyu": in Ayurveda a disorder of "wind" (vata), to which madness was attributed.
 17. Shiva-ghrita, ghee prepared with jackal's flesh ("shiva", jackal), a remedy for madness.
 18. So in the 1913 edition; the 1999 edition has: "we will go off as beggars, leaving house and home".
 19. The line is broken off in the 1913 edition ("e kāle jāgiradārera eka ...") and lost in the 1999 edition. "Horseman" (āśoṃyāra) is restored from couplet 102. A jagirdar is the holder of a land grant (jagir).
 20. The words apparently belong to the mother; another reading is possible: this is Narottama's own thought.
 21. The second line is corrupt ("yāiteī cāi āmi rāja barādhari"); the translation is conjectural.
 22. Following the 1999 edition ("pāila nā phirila"); the 1913 edition has "nā pāila nā phirila", "they did not find him and came back".
 23. Rani, "queen", i.e. Narottama's mother as the wife of a lord. In the 1913 edition the couplet is enclosed in brackets.
 24. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "And the Prabhu, the lord of Vraja, I cannot see."
 25. Literally "in your belly", an allusion to Narottama's having eaten prema (see 37).
 26. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "your followers will deliver (fill) the earth".
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Vilasa 11. Narottama in Vrindavana: Initiation by Lokanatha

Narottama's journey through Varanasi and Prayaga to Mathura; in a dream Rupa bids Jiva bring him; the meeting with Lokanatha and the talk on the need for a guru; a year of Hari-nama and Narottama's secret service to his guru; initiation; Lokanatha's teachings on sadhana; Radha grants Narottama a service and the name Champaka Manjari; the burned hand

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the Merciful One!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, whose heart is full of compassion!
2. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
Glory, glory to all who are bound to their mercy!
3. Glory to Srinivasa, glory, glory to Narottama!
Only by great fortune is shelter at their feet obtained.
4. [Rupa and Sanatana] commanded: "Leave your grief, go to Madhupuri;¹
go and see the sweetness of Lokanatha's feet."
5. Thus I have told of the vision of the two brothers;
this meeting on the road made the whole journey auspicious.
6. "In Vrindavana you will find joy — do not delay;
at Radha-kunda bow down to the feet of Raghunatha.
7. Take shelter at the feet of Lokanatha Gosani:
whoever takes his shelter attains every perfection."
8. At that time [he met] five or six Gaudiya Vaishnavas;
on the road they questioned him and he became acquainted with them all.
9. They say: "Let us go together — why do you weep on the road?"
And, his heart overflowing with prema, he went along with them.²
10. With joy in his heart he goes in the company of the vairagis;
the sores on his feet healed, and he walks along slowly.
11. He had heard that the Prabhu had come to Varanasi:
"I shall surely go to see that place.
12. All the more since it is on the way: if I do not see it,
I may commit an offence by neglecting it.
13. The Prabhu went there, and it is an abode of great souls;
whoever becomes acquainted with them there obtains Krishna-bhakti."
14. Having crossed over, he first went to Rajghat —
the ghat from which the road leads to Vishveshvara.³
15. He carefully performed the circumambulation, obeisances and the rest,
and from there he went northward.
16. To the left of the ghat stands a most charming house;
seeing it with his eyes, he rejoiced at heart.
17. A house with its gate facing east, a tulasi altar on the left;
seeing Sanatana's place,⁴ he bowed down.

18. Going inside the dwelling, he saw
an old Vaishnava sitting and performing sadhana.
19. Seeing him with his eyes, [Narottama] prostrated himself;
"Come, come!" said the other, and his heart rejoiced.
20. Rising, he came, returned the obeisance and embraced [the guest],
brought water and offered it to him to wash his feet.
21. Narottama says: "Whatever you command;
if I drink your water, bhakti will arise in me."⁵
22. That mahashaya asked: "Tell me, where is your home?
Seeing you, my heart is filled with gladness."
23. "My name is Narottama, I live in Garerhat;
to see Vrindavana — that is my hope.
24. It has been fulfilled — I have seen you."
["]Be so kind as to eat something here.["]
25. After a while, having eaten and sitting together,
the other, smiling, tells him about himself:
26. "Sri Chandrashekhara Acharya⁶ is my master;
by his command I serve steadfastly at this place."
27. There he spent [the day] in the rasa of talks about Krishna;
he lay down to sleep, and the night came to its end.
28. Then he took leave of him
and, remembering [him] in his heart, went on his way.
29. At Prayaga he bathed, deeming it great good fortune;
staying there, he spent that night.
30. Going on little by little, he came to Mathura;
having seen Bhuteshvara,⁷ he went on to the gate of Keshava-raya.
31. With his own eyes he saw Sri Krishna's birthplace;
tears flow in a hundred streams, no words come from his lips.
32. Having bathed at [the] Vishrama [ghat], he stayed in the town.
Meanwhile in Vrindavana a command came [to Jiva] from Sri Rupa in a dream:
33. "Listen, listen, Jiva: I am sending someone;
he lives in Garerhat, his name is Narottama.
34. With love entrust him to Lokanatha;
since yesterday he has been at [the] Vishranti [ghat] in Mathura."
35. On waking, [Jiva] rejoiced in his heart
and gave a command to the Vaishnavas with him:
36. "Go and bring Narottama from Mathura;
do not delay — bring him quickly."
37. They all came to Vishranti and bathed;
at that very ghat, at that very spot, they found him:
38. "Come quickly, do not delay any longer;
you will come here again and bathe at the ghat."

39. "As you command," he said, and went with them in haste,
anxious with prema to see the temple of Govinda.
40. Seeing the beauty of the temple, his prema surged up;
crying "O Govinda!", he fell into a deep swoon.
41. Seeing his ecstasy, Sri Jiva Gosani
went to Lokanatha Gosani and told him everything:
42. "Come quickly, Gosani, I will go with you;
in this body I see such waves of emotion!
43. He is so young, yet such is his renunciation;
a mighty bhava has manifestly appeared in him.
44. Such beauty of form — what a golden body!
His body sways with waves of prema.
45. My master commanded me to bring him,
and I have brought him from the Vishranti ghat.
46. Gauranga is merciful, gathering all worthy vessels;
I count such company my good fortune."
47. The Gosani [Jiva] came, bringing Lokanatha with him,
and the Gosani saw Narottama lying [senseless].
48. Seeing his great prema, the Gosani sat down beside him
and asks the Vaishnavas: "Which one is named Narottama?"
49. "Here, see — Narottama, lying on the ground."
"Good," he said, and himself laid his hand on his breast.
50. At the touch of his hand Narottama came to his senses;
Narottama clasped the feet of his own master.
51. With tears in his eyes the Gosani took him in his arms;
receiving his touch, Narottama was overwhelmed with joy.
52. "I saw in a dream that you would come today;
meeting you, a blind man has received eyes.
53. In his mercy Chaitanya has sent you:
he has brought a treasure and given it to a poor man."⁸
54. Taking him by the hand, they led him to the temple of Govinda,
and Jiva Gosani, holding his hand, entrusted him [to Lokanatha].
55. Seeing his natural prema, [Lokanatha] was filled with mercy:
"Without effort Providence has brought me a jewel."
56. Taking him by the hand, he showed him Govinda;
seeing Govinda's face, [Narottama] lost consciousness.
57. Supporting him, [Lokanatha] took him to his own kunja;
at the sight of his guru prema rose in him wave upon wave.
58. At this time Govinda's command came;⁹
[Lokanatha] took Narottama with him to partake of prasada.
59. Seeing his renunciation, the Gosani asked him about everything,
and Narottama told him everything from beginning to end:

60. "A golden child entered my heart;
by his power I saw the feet of Sri Rupa.
61. I am still without shelter¹⁰ — how can I sit with you?
How can I sit together [with you] and partake of prasada?"
62. Having heard everything, the Gosani smiled
and once more asked him something:
63. "You yourself said: a golden child —
you saw him directly with your own eyes.
64. He himself entered your heart;
he is the guru of the world, and you want to take a guru?
65. Attend: Chaitanya himself in the form of prema
has bestowed that prema on your heart.
66. That prema for which all perform bhajana —
I have understood its cause in your heart.
67. What need do you have to take a guru?
That which is to be attained is in your heart.
68. Is there any limit to it, listen, Narottama?
Without and within you have such a treasure of prema.
69. With that mercy, with that prema, you have come to Vrindavana;
what need have you of a guru's work, of the goal and its fruit?
70. In whose heart he dwells day and night,
what is there left for him that he has not obtained?
71. By that mercy you have seen Govinda;
his command came — and you partook of prasada."
72. Narottama says: "Prabhu, I am most wretched;
only your command is wise.
73. To speak before you, Prabhu, I am afraid at heart;
I will make my request once more, if you permit."
74. "Tell me, dear one, what have you to say?"
Prostrating himself, [Narottama] set forth everything:
75. "Chaitanya himself descended in the Kali age¹¹
and delivered all — chandalas, yavanas and the rest.
76. He is the guru of the world, all people serve him,
and yet he established the proper order.
77. He himself established the law of [accepting] a guru,
and likewise all his companions, the whole circle of the Prabhu.
78. By whatever command the guru instructs the disciple,
in accordance with his word the disciple attains what is to be attained.
79. I have no guru's command — what can I say?
How shall I ever know what is to be done and what is not?
80. What can I, worthless one, say in the Prabhu's presence?
I have not even the worthiness to make a request.

81. That prema, that child which are in my heart —
when Mahaprabhu's command comes, then all will be fulfilled."
82. Having heard everything, the Gosani smiled
and, filled with mercy, the Gosani told him everything [in reply].
83. [Narottama said:] "Even to sit in the same place [with you] I am very much afraid:
I am not worthy to sit with the Prabhu."
84. Seeing Narottama, all were glad at heart,
and to help him they all entreat [Lokanatha]:
85. "In Vrindavana there is no proper or improper time for giving a mantra;
quickly give the mantra into Narottama's ear."
86. Lokanatha says: "A command alone will not do:
the injunction of the shastras has fixed [a term] of one year.
87. I will give Hari-nama into his ear, since he wishes to sit [with us]" —
and he began to say: "Hare Krishna, Hare Krishna..."
88. "Krishna's name, dear one, holds great power;
if attachment to it arises, you will surely obtain everything."
89. [So] a year passed for Narottama in Hari-nama;
having given [him] Hari-nama, [Lokanatha] partook of prasada [with him].
90. I will tell of this more fully — listen attentively:
I will explain in detail what a guru must be and what a disciple.
91. On hearing this, be attentive at heart;
if anyone acts so, he is fortunate.
92. Taking Narottama inside, the Gosani speaks to him —
[and] only one who knows the heart of it understands this:
93. "There is Mahaprabhu's command concerning Hari-nama:
for the protection of living beings it is to be given now.
94. Wandering through many bodies, a living being obtains a human body;
to protect it, a great medicine is needed.
95. In other bodies, one after another, are the being's sin, suffering and disease,
and there is no means there that destroys them.
96. All the sins and sufferings it undergoes from birth to birth —
and in forgetfulness the being does not know itself.
97. Having obtained a human body, it must remedy all this [by sadhana];
if it does not, it will receive such bodies again.
98. Such a disease Krishna removes in the form of a devotee:
when he gives Krishna's name, he is in the form of the guru.
99. This [teaching] on guru and disciple is in the shastras;
whoever knows it surely acts upon it.
100. If one does not act so, the shastra becomes an empty repetition of words;¹²
for this reason Krishna's grace does not come to such a one.
101. In the form of Krishna he preaches through the shastras;
[the disciple] must weigh the words of one who is a true guru.

102. For a year [the disciple] will observe the guru's nature
and, gaining faith in his heart, will understand his greatness.
103. Carefully observing what the guru does,
he will serve continually as is fitting.
104. The guru, for his part, will understand the disciple's conduct
and judge in his mind whether he is worthy or unworthy.
105. [The disciple] will practise Hari-nama, always staying with the guru,
and will long in every way for the company of Vaishnavas.
106. The disciple must know this, making his attachment firm in his heart;
otherwise how will all the being's evil-mindedness go?
107. Practising the great mantra Hare Krishna day and night,
he feels: 'When will the Prabhu's mercy come — after an entire yuga?'¹³
108. When the longing grows stronger, the guru shows mercy;
only a few people can understand this.
109. Understanding the disciple's heart, the guru [imparts] what is confided in trust;
without worthiness there will be no mercy at all.
110. This is the ancient word, listen, Narottama;
this is the reason why Krishna's mercy does not arise [in some].
111. The Gosvamis do not permit taking many disciples;
in this there is purity — listen attentively.
112. If one takes two or four disciples, prema bears fruit;
if one takes many, everything becomes fruitless.¹⁴
113. What I have told you, listen to carefully;
and how many more accounts of it there are!¹⁵
114. Krishna's name, dear one, bears the fruit of prema;
if attachment to it arises, you will surely obtain everything."
115. [So] a year passed for Narottama in Hari-nama;
from then on he performed this sadhana day and night.
116. Two hundred thousand names were his sadhana, sitting in seclusion;
he chants the names by count, staying awake at night as well.¹⁶
117. In the morning he comes, bows down and offers praises,
and, standing, contemplates the form [of his guru] with his eyes.
118. "Narottama, are you well?" [Lokanatha] asks.
"I am at ease — such is the power of [your] feet."
119. "Good, good," says the Gosani, and smiles to himself.
Prostrating himself, [Narottama] says: "This is my request:
120. whatever you command — you know my heart."
In this way he constantly comes and goes.¹⁷
121. Sometimes he comes at mealtime
and, receiving the remnants from [his guru's] plate, sits in seclusion.
122. Sometimes he serves his feet;
whatever command is given, he listens to it.

123. Sometimes he goes to see the places of Vrindavana
and prostrates himself where Krishna's pastimes took place.
124. Sometimes he converses with Sri Jiva;
hearing of Krishna's pastimes, his heart is swept away in prema.
125. And there was one more sadhana that Narottama performed:
at the end of the night he made this service his rule.
126. The place where Gosani-ji goes to relieve himself¹⁸ —
there he goes and cleans it thoroughly.
127. For [his guru's] cleansing he sifts earth and brings it;
day after day he performs this service.
128. The Gosani says: "Who is it that does this?
I do not understand for what reason he does it."
129. Narottama goes there at such a time
when no one at all is at that place.
130. He keeps a broom buried in the earth;
taking it out, he serves with joy in his heart.
131. He considers himself blessed, his body fulfilled:
"To obtain the Prabhu's feet — this is my strength!"
132. As he speaks, he weeps, pressing the broom to his breast;
five or seven streams flow, drenching his breast:
133. "Prabhu Lokanatha is Narottama's life!
By the good fortune of many births I have obtained your feet."
134. The Gosani, astonished, ponders in his mind:
"How am I to know whose doing this is?"
135. In this way he deliberates within himself:
"Whom shall I ask? Who does such a thing?"
136. Hear, then, of Narottama's sadhana:
whoever hears this will be utterly astonished.
137. Such a thing is seen nowhere, nor heard of anywhere else —
who else will have such love for his guru?
138. Thus he performs sadhana and service day after day;
to the feet of such a Narottama, a thousand obeisances.
139. While he thus served day after day,
the Gosani says: "I must certainly find out [who it is]."
140. From Vaishakha to Vaishakha a year went by;
then the Gosani made a decision in his mind:
141. "When six dandas¹⁹ of the night remain,
at that time I will go out to relieve myself.
142. Then I will find out who does this;
otherwise this pain of heart is unbearable.
143. In separation from Sri Rupa my heart has lost all its zest,
and on top of that, such an offence in Vrindavana!²⁰

144. Is there some Vrajavasi who does such a thing?
To tell people — I would be ashamed.
145. [Otherwise] what can I do? What remedy is there?" —
thus the Gosani's days pass in sorrow of heart.
146. After that Narottama came for darshana;
he prostrated himself, and the Gosani asked him something:
147. "Are you well, Narottama? Tell me, let me hear."
"All perfection is the Prabhu's mercy — this I know."
148. "I am ashamed to say it — it cannot be spoken" —
and, with a wry smile, the Gosani sighs deeply: "Alas, alas!"
149. Narottama bowed and took his leave;
he constantly chants two hundred thousand names by count.
150. The next day the Gosani went out to relieve himself
when six dandas of the night remained.
151. At that time Narottama was at that very place:
he was sweeping, and the Gosani stood behind him.
152. Narottama stands before him, the broom pressed to his breast;
"Who are you? Who are you?" [the Gosani] began to ask.
153. Narottama says: "Prabhu, I am but the semblance of a servant;
I have placed my hope in your two lotus feet."
154. The Gosani says: "Narottama, you do such work!
It pains me greatly, dear one — stop all this."
155. Narottama says: "By good fortune is such service obtained;
show me such mercy that my mind turns to nothing else."
156. So saying, the Gosani sat down to relieve himself,
and Narottama remained at that place all the while.
157. Rising, [the Gosani] comes and calls: "Narottama Dasa!"
With folded hands he stood before him, his heart rejoicing.
158. "Bring earth, bring water — quickly!"
Bringing earth, he also brought [a vessel] full of water.
159. With both hands he offers the earth and pours the water;
obtaining service directly, he was filled with strength.
160. With joined palms Narottama prostrates himself,
and [the Gosani], raising his foot, placed it on his head.
161. The Gosani says: "Narottama, go and bathe" —
and he bathed joyfully in the Yamuna.
162. Having bathed joyfully and gaily in the Yamuna,
the Gosani goes to his kunja, and this one goes with him.
163. Narottama washed his feet with his own hands;
the Gosani sat down on his seat to perform remembrance.
164. He applied tilaka and recited hymns with deep feeling,
prostrating himself again and again, with joy in his heart.

165. Narottama is sitting in the kunja;
[the Gosani] called: "Come, dear one, come into this hut!"
166. Then he prostrated himself and bowed many times;
calling him, [the Gosani] took him into his presence, and he offered many praises.
167. [The Gosani] had tulasi, sandal paste and flower garlands brought,
kunkuma, musk and [all things] for adornment.²¹
168. "Sit on the left side, dear one, listen to my words:
clasp [my] two feet and surrender yourself.
169. In a temple of jewels, in the midst of a jewelled throne,
shines Sri Nanda-nandana, and on his left, Radhika.
170. Make Sri Vilasa Manjari your own self —
Vilasa Manjari, the attendant of Manjulali.²²
171. On Krishna's left are Lalita and the others in their circle;
on Radhika's left remember the manjaris.
172. Place garlands and sandal on the breasts of Radha and Krishna,
anoint their bodies with kunkuma and musk.
173. Worship the sakhis one by one."
And he entrusted him into the hands of the sakhis:
174. "Vilasa Manjari is the attendant of you all" —
so he entrusted her to the sakhi who is in the form of the guru.
175. Having him wash his hands, he made him receive the mantra:
first he made him hear the mantra of Radha and Krishna;²³
176. with great care he made him hear the kama-bija,²⁴
and afterwards, sitting, he explained everything in detail:
177. "Go and bow down to Sri Jiva Gosani;
ask him to accept you."
178. Having washed his hands, Narottama goes outside,
offering entreaties and prostrating himself many times.
179. Calling him, [the Gosani] showed him mercy — placed his feet on his head;
with joy in his heart the Gosani gave him charanamrita.²⁵
180. Narottama goes to Sri Jiva Gosani;
going there, he prostrated himself, bowed down and offered praises.
181. [Jiva] showed him great mercy, embraced him,
and, smiling, says: "Come, Narottama!"
182. With great love the Gosani seated him beside himself
and, glad at heart, asks him questions.
183. "My heart's wish is fulfilled, what I longed for is accomplished:
all perfection comes by relying on your mercy.
184. Protect me, Gosani, by giving me your own strength;
what more can I say — everything has been fulfilled."
185. Then he went back to his own Gosani;
the Gosani [at that time] was eating and saw him:

186. "Come, come, Narottama, sit here" —
and, filled with mercy, he gave him the remnants from his plate.
187. Thus I have told of Narottama's initiation into the mantra;
later I will tell of the Gosani's teachings on dharma.
188. Of the worship and the manner of sadhana that he performed
I, a sinner, write, bowing down.
189. Whoever hears this even once with his own ears,
to him the entourage of Radha and Krishna will show mercy.
190. And of one who practises this sadhana and bhajana,
what can I say by writing?
191. This is truly the most secret worship;
how many people are indifferent to it!
192. From those turned outward this must be kept hidden;
speak of it [only] to one who is such [himself].
193. In the morning Narottama came to the Gosvami
and, bowing down, makes a request:
194. "What shall I ask, Prabhu — about the manner of worship?
Be merciful, Prabhu, give me bhakti [as it is held] in the sampradaya."
195. "Sit down, dear Narottama, I will tell you of the worship:
how to contemplate Radha and Krishna in the mind.
196. Sadhana is twofold — in the siddha body and in the sadhaka body;
I will tell it in order — listen.
197. The chief [object] of sadhana is Krishna in a body [playing] human pastimes;
the measure of his age is up to sixteen years.
198. Such is the established kind of sadhana;
[in it] Radha and the host of sakhis appear as mature.²⁶
199. The highest of the dearest sakhis are Lalita and Vishakha;
the host of manjaris excels [them] in service.
200. They are called sakhis, but think of themselves as maidservants;
I will write down together the list of their names:
201. Sri Rupa, Lavanga, Rati, Rasa, Guna,
Manjulali and others — such are their names.
202. Know the position of the sakhis in the places of the pastimes:
this is what is to be done, this is what to long for, this is what is attained.
203. Nandishvara, Javata, Sanketa, Varshana,
the kundas, the kunjās, [the places of] the rasa — know all these places.
204. Knowing the time of each of the eternal pastimes,
serve, understanding to whose group you belong.
205. Coming and going with the sakhi [who is] the guru's form,
understanding her signs, serve with eager longing."
206. Narottama says: "Prabhu, this is my request:
how am I to understand this teaching on the sadhaka?"

207. "Dwelling [in the mind] in the time [of the pastimes] in accordance with the mood,
know within yourself both remembrance and service."
208. "I will serve, dwelling together with the sakhi;
in what place, knowing which part [of the rite], shall I chant the mantra?"
209. "Fixing your eyes on the window of the kunjā,
chant the mantra while gazing on [the form of] the one whose mantra it is."
210. "At what time should the kama-bija be chanted?
Explain in detail, Prabhu — hear me, O merciful one."
211. "Know that the kama-bija is enchantment;
by the sweetness of the mantra [Krishna] will be subdued everywhere.
212. Chanting the mantra, gaze on each one in turn;
in it the enchantment is revealed.
213. When Radha and Krishna lie down at the time of love,
at that time remember this mantra.
214. Thus I have told you of this — listen;
and whatever more there is, I will tell in due order.
215. All the sakhis are entitled to serve the Samartha;²⁷
take their shelter, following them.
216. One who has taken [their] shelter in every way,
wherever they dwell, will abide there.
217. They are all to be known as ragatmika;
consider [thus]: they alone are my shelter.
218. Know the two groups — of Radha and of Chandravali;
by nature [they are] dakshina and vama.²⁸
219. Know Chandravali in your mind as dakshina, harsh,
and Radha as vama, gentle: this is [our] longing.
220. Know the sakhis of Radhika
and understand their fivefold nature, [expressed] in their names.²⁹
221. Know in your mind who has what entitlement [to service];
by relying on them, [one gains] love for Radha and Krishna."
222. "They alone are my shelter — such is [my] understanding;
be merciful, Prabhu, tell [me more], for I am a sinner."³⁰
223. How much mercy you have shown me, a worthless being!
Such discourse is found nowhere else.
224. A thought has arisen in my mind;
I will put it before you, if you permit.
225. From the mantra you first graciously gave me³¹
I understood in my heart the separation of Krishna and Radha.
226. What service should be done at the time of separation?
Let a command be given me for each one separately.
227. [Krishna] goes home with his companions to Nandishvara,
[while Radha] goes from the kunda to Vrishabhanu's house.

228. Thus I have understood the course of separation from Krishna;
on this my mind shall dwell day and night.
229. How am I to serve, contemplating this in my heart?
Let a command be given me for each one separately.
230. This I have laid before you;
be merciful, tell me, that [it] may shine forth in my heart."
231. "Ah, dear Narottama, if this is not known,
what worship is there, what attainment? I will tell you in private.
232. In separation from Krishna, Radha's heart grieves,
and all the sakhis [tell] of Krishna's pastimes with deep feeling.
233. To calm her heart they speak of his beauty and virtues,
of where he stays and what he does there.
234. Then joy is born in Radha's heart;
know in your heart with whom [among the sakhis] you dwell."
235. "By what means, then, shall I serve?
Tell me about this, Prabhu, by your merciful command."
236. "When Radhika stays with the master of the house,³²
then serve her the more.
237. When they are together, having met,
the sakhis serve with joyful hearts.
238. So contemplate, [in keeping with] the nature of [your] body;
if one does not do this, an obstacle arises.
239. Thus in the group [of sakhis] the longing for service is gained,
the hope [to offer] kunkuma and the rest, water and sandal, and to behold [it all].
240. Whoever hears all this will know it by experience:
all these are the acts of a body made of ragatmika.
241. For attaining that body are all these means;
know that Sri Rupa has written of them in [his] book.
242. Now I will tell of the way of parakiya and svakiya,³³
and point out the places where they dwell.
243. Parakiya is Radha, among the sakhis;
all those of the svakiya [circle] are beyond Vrindavana.
244. Satyabhama and the other queens —
in them svakiya is complete; know this and praise it.
245. My way is the way of parakiya;³⁴
you, following the sakhis, taste this.
246. The body made of contemplation is the way of taking shelter in bhava;
when all that is perfected, that [siddha] body is attained.
247. Ah, Narottama, I tell you of sadhana:
make your mind enter into it completely.
248. Some consider Vrindavana to be Goloka,
others think it equal to Dvaraka and the rest.

249. They take shelter of one thing, and something else is attained:
they do not listen to Sri Rupa's books or come to understand them.
250. Know this for certain through the shastras:
by doing what, one gains what, who goes where."
251. "I am afraid to petition you again and again
[about all] that concerns the mantra, the worship and the name..."
252. "To one who asks with an aching heart, everything is attainable;
why should you be afraid to ask?
253. I will teach you everything — stay in Vrindavana;
I will plant this [in you] so that it may spread.
254. Who knows such worship, such dharma?
Who in all the world discusses it?
255. Prema has arisen in your heart;
it is what makes you speak such words, I think.
256. Hear about the mantra — the essence of [all] the parts of sadhana;
sit and hear all that there is besides.
257. Hear the kama-gayatri — there is no bija in it;
I will also tell of the two fivefold names, how they are used.³⁵
258. To one who has heard this I will tell of sadhana,
of what is to be done and not done, and of all the rules.
259. I will tell of ashraya, alambana and uddipana,³⁶
of what is attainable and unattainable, of causes and non-causes.
260. [I will tell of] the siddha body made of contemplation, and of the parts of sadhana,
and the manner in which it manifests.
261. Taking shelter in Krishna, one abandons the karma that is the cause [of bondage] —
one whose way is exclusive refuge [in him].
262. If one does not act so, [that body] does not manifest;
through association with [people] given to karma³⁷ all this is destroyed.
263. The eternally perfect body [that follows] raga —
when one performs sadhana, it is, as it were, nourished.
264. Taking shelter at the guru's feet and all the rest —
the sixty-four parts [of sadhana], in all their sections.
265. As the body gains strength by eating,
so [sadhana] makes the siddha body strong.
266. One who has no strength in the sadhaka body
is without support — nothing awakens in him."
267. "I have a request, Prabhu — forgive my offence:
I greatly wish to hear from your holy lips.
268. You yourself, Prabhu, spoke of raga and vaidhi;
the sixty-four parts are vaidhi — for what reason?"
269. "You have asked well, dear one, listen further:
when there is doubt, one cannot perform sadhana.

270. One who performs sadhana out of fear of the shastras [that prescribe] good and evil — of him, as the Gosani writes, it is said: [his way] is vaidhi.
271. Mahaprabhu infused his power into Rupa,
and by that command he propagated the shastra on sadhana.
272. He sent the Prabhu this essence of the book
and in a letter set out the discrimination of the essential and the inessential.
273. Taking the book and the letter, a man went to Purushottama;
hearing [of them], the Prabhu rejoiced at heart.³⁸
274. He called Ramananda and Svarupa and gathered them together:
'A letter has been sent from Vrindavana.
275. See, O two great souls: he has written a book —
what is attainable and what is not.'
276. 'As you command,' said the two, and took the book on their laps,
and on seeing the book they read it, overwhelmed with joy.
277. From that day all perform sadhana —
Gauranga himself and all his own circle.
278. The Prabhu quickly wrote a letter with his own hand;
whatever the Prabhu commanded, he wrote in it:
279. 'This kind of dharma is the essence of the parts of sadhana;
one who practises it himself can deliver [others].'
280. Taking that letter, the man came to Vrindavana;
[all] sat down and heard the contents of the letter.
281. From that day all perform sadhana,
and such a great treasure spread through the world.
282. One who himself practises dharma and teaches it to people —
to him Gauranga himself shows mercy.
283. One who teaches dharma to others but does not keep it himself —
to him Chaitanya never shows mercy.
284. One who does not practise himself but [only] draws distinctions
will not attain Krishna in any birth.
285. His offence against the Prabhu grows strong,
and, causing grief to Sri Rupa's heart, he goes to Rasatala.³⁹
286. Even having taken shelter at the guru's feet, he passes his life in vain:
whatever he does flies away like empty words.
287. Narottama, you have heard this account of sadhana;
he attains it whose heart is filled with longing.
288. Chant Hari-nama, making no difference between the name and the Named;
to one attached to it Chaitanya is merciful.
289. First of all he made [people] take Hari-nama;
by it the karma and jnana of living beings were cut off.
290. Therefore he whom we call Krishna Chaitanya is the guru;
therefore there is the command: the name is a wish-fulfilling tree.

291. Whoever would be a Vaishnava will take Hari-nama;
to one who chants the name by count Gaura is merciful.
292. In keeping with [the Prabhu's] original intent all take Hari-nama;
some a hundred thousand, especially singing aloud.
293. Narottama chants a hundred thousand names by count:
by chanting the name he holds all of Gauranga's power.
294. One who chants a hundred thousand names of Hari attains Krishna's feet;
when a knot is completed, let him make one obeisance.⁴⁰
295. Know [that here is] the prema of sweetness, natural attachment;
contemplate it deeply, with a divine mind.
296. These are the parts of sadhana, listen, Narottama;
little by little the sadhana will become perfect.
297. One by one [the names] hold great power to give Krishna;
for the sadhaka's sadhana they are exceedingly powerful.
298. And a very feeble person — where is he to go?
Let him sit at the door and chant the name with devotion.⁴¹
299. Narottama, enter into this with your mind;
your two feet are my life."⁴²
300. One who has the desire to attain Krishna
must be careful that no obstacle arises.
301. The names of Radha and Krishna, and the devotees —
here be careful [not] to commit offence.
302. If one offends these three, there is no welfare:
the two [— the name and the devotees —] possess virtues equal to Krishna's.
303. One who, born in the world, has taken shelter at the guru's feet —
in his heart this offence does not arise.
304. Chaitanya, Bhagavan himself, has love for them;
one who disregards them suffers great loss.
305. An example of this — see Sri Rupa Gosani:
look [at him] and you will know; it is evident everywhere.
306. See the way Sri Dasa Gosvami⁴³ performs bhajana:
to the Vaishnavas he has seen and heard of he shows the greatest devotion.
307. Be careful, Narottama, hear one word:
let no offence arise in any way, within or without.
308. Is there anyone in the world so worthy?
One whose conduct is such — him my heart longs [to see].
309. Having heard and seen this, my child, set your heart's love on it:
on seeing any Vaishnava at all, show him the greatest devotion.
310. Being superior, behave like an inferior:
know for certain that this is the means of attaining Krishna.
311. Cherish all that you have heard day and night;
practise bhajana and remembrance, dwelling in Vrindavana."

312. Going out, [Narottama] prostrated himself and bowed,
and with a joyful heart he took up residence in Vrindavana.
313. Sitting in the kunja, he remembers all the parts of sadhana;
how much can I tell of what was in his heart!
314. As he had been commanded, so he did;⁴⁴
day by day his sadhana-bhakti grew.
315. He serves the Prabhu whenever there is need;
in this way he spends his days and nights.
316. One day he lay down in the kunja,
partly asleep, partly awake.
317. The daughter of Vrishabhanu came into that kunja
and, smiling, speaks to Narottama:
318. "You have taken shelter at the guru's feet and serve the guru;
whatever he commands, that you carry out in your sadhana."⁴⁵
319. In your mental service you have realised so much;
all your service is in the form of supreme longing.
320. Seeing how firm you are in every mood,
my heart became very glad.
321. At midday in my kunja is the meeting with Krishna;
there the sakhis perform much service.
322. There kshira⁴⁶ is cooked, which gives Krishna delight;
every delight is found in Champakalata's kunja.
323. Your eternal service is to boil down the milk;
my delight lies in what makes Krishna happy."
324. Then Narottama came to his senses⁴⁷
and, rising, began to reflect within himself.
325. What mood came over him then, no one knows;
until the third prahara⁴⁸ he rolled on the ground.
326. Coming to his senses, he reasoned in his mind:
"My duty is [to do] as the Prabhu commands."
327. Having reasoned thus, he goes to the Prabhu
and tells him in full what he had seen.
328. Bowing down many times in many ways,
he speaks carefully before the Prabhu:
329. "I was lying in the kunja, partly conscious,
and I see: creepers, trees, ground — all are golden.
330. Before me was a divine woman of incomparable beauty;
she said: 'Wake up, O Narottama!
331. At midday in my kunja is the meeting with Krishna;⁴⁹
there the sakhis perform much service.
332. In Champakalata's kunja kshira is cooked;
from today your service is to boil down the milk.

333. The name given to you is Champaka Manjari,⁵⁰ —
and weeping I prostrated myself [before her].
334. My heart wishes to tell you of this;
you are my master — command as you will."
335. Trembling, sweat and abundant tears came over him;
coming to himself, the Gosani rejoiced at heart:
336. "Blessed, blessed are you, Narottama, fortunate one:
she whose feet [we seek] has herself given you a command.
337. She for whose service I take such pains,
whom I remember in sadhana, staying awake day and night —
338. serve [her] from today; this is your name;
in this is all my happiness and joy."
339. From then on he joyfully performed the service commanded,
and his service to the Prabhu and his sadhana grew.
340. Every day he serves with the greatest delight.
What happened one day I will tell at the end.⁵¹
341. In his mind the Thakura⁵² boils down the milk
and with a joyful heart beholds the pastimes.
342. He feeds the fire with dry wood, and [the milk] boils up again and again;
he ponders in his mind: how can I prevent it?
343. When it boiled up once more,
he held back the milk with his hand.
344. His hand was burned, but in his outward [awareness] he did not know it;
taking the milk off [the fire], he set it down right there.
345. Coming to his senses, he sees that his hand is burned;
he cries: "Alas, alas! What more is there to consider?
346. My service to Gosani-ji will be interrupted;
surely I have committed an offence."
347. Even so, he comes to the Prabhu to report [it];
from afar the Gosani saw Narottama:
348. "You, who know, have acted like one who does not know!"
"Come, come," says the Gosani, lamenting: "Alas, alas!"
349. Covering his hand with his shawl, [Narottama] bows down;
the Prabhu says: "Narottama, come near me."
350. Taking him in his arms, the Gosani wept long:
"The youthful Pair⁵³ has shown you mercy!"
351. Sri Jiva Gosani too showed him great mercy:
"Such bhajana and remembrance I have neither seen nor heard of."
352. The two together held many intimate talks;⁵⁴
they formed a close and heartfelt friendship.
353. Never seen, never heard is such a wondrous thing:
he is one who is in friendship with Sri Jiva Gosani!

354. How much can I write of the bounds of Narottama's prema!
Simply by hearing it one attains prema for Radha and Krishna.
355. Whoever will perform such sadhana and remembrance
will become a companion of the sakhis — this I have understood to be the reason.
356. Such love for one's guru is unheard of in the three worlds;
in Vrindavana he attained every perfection directly.
357. [He is] one in whose heart are Gauranga and Gauranga's prema,
upon whom rests the mercy of Rupa and Sanatana.
358. Diksha and shiksha of every kind [he received] from his guru:
he raises questions and hears the detailed explanation.
359. Whatever the Gosani commands, in that he is diligent;
for one who acts [so], the witness is right there.⁵⁵
360. All that [happened to him] at home, on the road and in Vrindavana —
who could tell it all to the end?
361. By the good fortune of many births he obtained the holy feet;
day and night he floats in prema with a joyful heart.
362. By command I write of the manner of his bhajana,
but my wicked mind cannot touch even a particle of it.
363. He whose nights and days pass in remembrance and sadhana —
I write something of his virtues, but what can I compare them to?
364. Later I will write of the glory of his service and bhajana;
in it all who were touched by it were immersed.
365. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the eleventh vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Madhupuri, Mathura.
2. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "Do not delay, come — we will go along with you."
3. Rajghat, a ghat on the northern edge of Varanasi where the Ganges was crossed; Vishveshvara is Vishvanatha, Shiva as lord of Kashi. Literally "the ghat at which Vishveshvara took the road"; the sense is unclear.
4. Apparently the house of Chandrashekhara in Varanasi, where Mahaprabhu stayed and where Sanatana came to him.
5. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "by your mercy bhakti will arise in me".
6. Chandrashekhara, the devotee of Varanasi who was Mahaprabhu's host.
7. Bhuteshvara, Shiva as guardian of Mathura; Keshava-rama, the temple of Keshavadeva at Krishna's birthplace.
8. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he has brought wealth and given it to a poor man".
9. That is, the invitation to partake of the prasada of Govinda's temple.
10. That is, not yet initiated, without a guru.
11. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "Sri Krishna Chaitanya himself descended".
12. "anuvāda", literally "restatement, repetition".
13. Literally "in what yuga will the Prabhu's mercy come?" — i.e. every moment of waiting seems a yuga.
14. The second line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
15. A variant of the first line given in the 1913 edition: "Such is the conduct of a disciple who has accepted a guru."
16. A variant of the second line given in the 1913 edition: "he comes and performs such service to the Prabhu as befits him".
17. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.

18. "bahirdeśa", going "outside", beyond the dwelling, to relieve oneself.
19. A danda is 24 minutes; six dandas are about two and a half hours. The 1999 edition here has "three dandas"; below (150) both editions have six.
20. Lokanatha considers it an offence that someone in Vrindavana should secretly perform such menial work for him.
21. "keśera racanā", literally "the arranging of hair"; a variant given in the 1913 edition: "and Keshava's garland".
22. Manjulali is the spiritual form (siddha-rupa) of Lokanatha himself (cf. ch. 7, 215); Narottama is given the form of her attendant, Vilasa Manjari.
23. The 1913 edition has "the mantra of Radha".
24. The kama-bija, the seed syllable "klīm", found in Krishna's mantras.
25. Charanamrita, the water with which the feet of the guru or the Deity have been washed.
26. The line is unclear ("vyaktatā pravīṇa rādhā sakhīgaṇa āra"); the translation is conjectural.
27. Samartha, "all-powerful" (samartha-rati), the highest kind of love, belonging to Radha; here Radha herself.
28. Dakshina, "compliant", and vama, "contrary": two types of heroine in Rupa Gosvami's poetics (Ujjvala-nilamani). Below (219) the epithets seem to be distributed unusually — so in both editions.
29. The five kinds of sakhi: sakhi, nitya-sakhi, prana-sakhi, priya-sakhi and parama-preshtha-sakhi.
30. A variant of the second line given in the 1913 edition: "such is my worship too — a part of sadhana".
31. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "from the mantra you gave me separately". Apparently the separate mantras of Radha and of Krishna are meant (cf. 175).
32. That is, in her husband's house (parakiya-bhava).
33. Parakiya, love for another's wife (Radha and the gopis); svakiya, love in lawful marriage (the queens of Dvaraka).
34. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
35. The kama-gayatri, the gayatri addressed to Krishna as Kama. "The two fivefold names" is unclear; perhaps the five arrows of Kama are meant.
36. Ashraya, the bearer of love; alambana, its object and support; uddipana, that which awakens it (terms of the theory of rasa).
37. "karmadrohi", literally "people of karma hostile (to bhakti?)"; the reading is conjectural.
38. The second line is corrupt in the 1913 edition ("śunīkrā kale gra ānandita mana") and lost in the 1999 edition; translated according to the sense. Purushottama is Puri.
39. Rasatala, one of the nether worlds, the underworld.
40. "granthi", a knot on the string or beads used for counting names: after each full round one bows down.
41. A variant of the first line given in the 1913 edition: "if there is strength in one who has attachment".
42. The second line is odd in the guru's mouth; a variant given in the 1913 edition: "soon you will obtain the great treasure, prema for Krishna".
43. Raghunatha Dasa Gosvami. The second line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
44. The first line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.
45. The second line is found only in the 1913 edition.
46. Kshira, milk boiled down until thick. Champakalata is one of Radha's eight principal sakhis.
47. Couplets 324–326 are found only in the 1913 edition.
48. A prahara is a quarter of the day (about three hours); the third prahara is the early part of the afternoon.
49. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "At midday on my bank is the meeting with Krishna" (perhaps an allusion to Radha-kunda).
50. Radha gives Narottama a new spiritual name, Champaka Manjari (cf. 170, where Lokanatha gives him the form of Vilasa Manjari).
51. A variant of the second line given in the 1913 edition: "so day by day he floats in the bliss of prema".
52. The Thakura, Narottama (Thakura Mahashaya).
53. "kiśorī kiśora", the youthful Radha and Krishna.
54. "iṣṭa-goṣṭhī", a conversation among devotees about the object of their worship.
55. The second line of the couplet is found only in the 1913 edition.

Vilasa 12. The Titles Acharya and Thakura Mahashaya; the Story of Shyamananda

Jiva gives Narottama the name Thakura Mahashaya; the meeting of Srinivasa and Narottama; Srinivasa solves the riddle of the withered creepers and receives the title Acharya; the festival at the end of Kartika and the decision to send both with the books to Gauda; the youth of Duhkhi Krishnadasa, his initiation by Hridaya Chaitanya at Ambika and his coming to Vrindavana; his studies with Jiva; Radha's lost anklet and the name Shyamananda; the farewell to Lokanatha and Gopala Bhatta

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to the ocean of mercy!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, the utmost limit of rasa!
2. Glory to Advaitachandra, glory to the life of those who have nothing!
Glory, glory to Gaura's devotees, treasuries of virtue!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava and Virachandra, our lord!
Be merciful and make this fallen one your own.
4. Listen, listen, hearers, attentively
to the account of the virtues of Srinivasa and Narottama.
5. Whatever I have written, still more remains;
yet I write, by the command of my Prabhu.
6. The Creator did not give me a hundred hands, feet and mouths —
then I would write and tell, and the pain of my heart would go.
7. The two great souls who descended as the form of prema —
how they took shelter at the guru's feet in Vraja,
8. how, from the time they settled in Vrindavana,
they practised sadhana and remembrance in supreme delight,
9. how they served the guru and studied the books of bhakti —
with whom each studied what — of this I write.
10. His name was Srinivasa, but he became famed as Acharya;
the reason for this I will write — it is most necessary.
11. And Narottama received the name Thakura Mahashaya;
all this was seen with people's own eyes — of that there is no doubt.
12. How the two of them met one another,
on what day, to which kunja, to which place they would go,
13. how the two came together to Gauda —
of that joy and of that road I will write in detail.
14. I write, making the Prabhu's command my strength,
in just the way he gave me that command.
15. The book Prema-vilasa is by the command of his holy mouth;
whatever remains I shall make manifest.
16. Narottama's sadhana and remembrance —
what is beyond reach for one whose mind is deep?
17. For some days he studied with his own Prabhu,¹
and sometimes he would go to Sri Jiva and put questions to him.

18. He read the dramas and the Sandarbhas with the Gosani;
[Jiva] himself taught him, sitting with him in seclusion.
19. Thus time passed in blissful absorption;
Sri Jiva showed him boundless, special affection.
20. Sri Jiva Gosani says: "Listen, friend —
I will tell you all that is in my mind.
21. How, and what command came to you, from what service
your hand was burned — tell it with joy."
22. Saying "As you command," he told everything in detail;
Sri Jiva's body thrilled, and he wept.²
23. In another mood, holding him by both arms, he says:
"From today your name is Vilasa Manjari.
24. You, mahashaya, are the form of Sri Rupa's play."
[Narottama replies:] "Such names cannot apply to me."
25. Then the Gosani smiles and says: "This is not strange:³
you and I have one and the same siddha-name.⁴
26. Who can fathom the intent of your sadhana?
From today your name is Thakura Mahashaya."
27. The Thakura bows down, the Gosani embraces him;
meekly and humbly he speaks imploring words:
28. "If you permit, I will tell you once more
in what way Radhika's command came to me.
29. With her own holy mouth she spoke the name Champaka Manjari,
knowing that the virtues of both [names] are equal in sweetness."
30. Again Sri Jiva Gosani embraces him:
"Such a state of sadhana and remembrance I have never seen.
31. For you nothing remains unknown any longer:
in Vrindavana you have attained every perfection.
32. You, who were born as the form of Gauranga's prema —
by your prema the whole world will be flooded."⁵
33. One day on the bank of the Kunda⁶ Sri Dasa Gosvami
heard in full about the name "Thakura Mahashaya".
34. Krishnadasa Kaviraja heard from him
that [Narottama's] excellence in bhajana is attested everywhere.
35. Sri Dasa Gosvami says: "Listen, Krishnadasa:
Narottama Dasa has become a manifestation of mercy.
36. The service he gave his guru, his way of bhajana —
of these we have just now seen the evidence.
37. When one performs sadhana with the guru's mercy, so it comes to be —
in Sri Rupa's books there is a decisive statement on this."
38. He the fame of whose bhajana is in Gauda and Vrindavana —
whoever hears of him is helplessly overcome by prema.

39. Lokanatha and Gopala Bhatta, these two Gosanis,
were sitting together in one place, talking of Krishna.
40. At that time they heard of all these things:
such bhajana had fallen to his lot in full.
41. Sri Bhatta Gosani says: "Blessed is this life:
in Vrindavana all one's desires are fulfilled."
42. Lokanatha Gosani laughs, putting his hand to his mouth;
with his mouth he says nothing, but within he is full of joy.
43. Sri Bhatta Gosani says to Lokanatha:
"One to whom your mercy is such as this,
44. whom Sri Jiva Gosani, the shakti of Sri Rupa,
calls his friend — the like of him I have not seen.
45. One in whose heart is the mercy of Radhika-ji —
rightly is he named Thakura Mahashaya."
46. However many of his virtues I write, they cannot be told.
Now I will write in full of the meeting with Srinivasa.
47. This is not Sanskrit — it is set in payar;
[in it] the words grow and much is composed.⁷
48. One day, when Narottama was in the Gosani's presence,
at that time Srinivasa came unexpectedly.
49. Sri Lokanatha Gosani was sitting;
Srinivasa bowed down and stood [before him].
50. Narottama stood in that same place with joined palms;
and then Srinivasa saw him with his eyes.
51. Crying "Come, friend!" he ran and embraced him;
like a blind man who has gained eyes, he deemed his life blessed.
52. "Now I know that fate has become favourable,
since I have met you in Vrindavana.
53. Great joy has come from meeting you —
as if one wretched from birth had found many jewels."
54. Thakura Mahashaya says: "Listen, mahashaya,
be kind and show mercy to me, a poor one."
55. In the presence of the Prabhu he is afraid to speak;
with joined palms he speaks humbly.
56. The bodies of both thrilled with prema, streams of tears in their eyes.
"How long is it since you came?"
57. "For a year and three months I have been seeing the Prabhu;
in the month of Vaishakha I took shelter at the Prabhu's feet,
58. and three months more have passed since — so I tell you."⁸
The hearts of both were overwhelmed; for a moment they composed themselves.
59. On the fifth day of the bright fortnight of the month of Shravana
these two met in a kunja near the Gosani.

60. The Gosani, smiling, says to Srinivasa:
"Do you know now where his home is?"
61. Srinivasa says to the Prabhu:
"He is the son of Krishnananda Raya of Garerhat.
62. He is of the highest virtue, his name is Narottama;
through his connection with your feet he is dear to me as life."
63. From that day their affection grew ever deeper;
sometimes [one] comes to [the other's] lodging, joyful at heart,
64. sometimes the two meet in Vrindavana
and, sitting in seclusion, converse together.
65. Srinivasa serves his own Gosani:
sometimes he cooks and feeds him.
66. He goes to Sri Jiva Gosani to study books;
sometimes he goes off to another kunja and is absorbed in remembrance.
67. All that Jiva had studied with Sri Rupa
he revealed, with all its meaning, in Srinivasa's heart.
68. He taught him the dramas of the Vraja-lila and the Sandarbhas
and made him expert in the meaning of Sri Rupa's books.
69. One day Sri Jiva was studying a book —
what is written in the Lalita-madhava:⁹
70. Krishna's departure for Mathura, full of deep sorrow,
and Radha's companions, ready in that separation to give up their lives.
71. The Gosani [Rupa] wrote it, and Jiva ponders it —
and then, losing consciousness, he fell to the ground.
72. After a long while, coming to himself, he rose and sat;
crying "Ah, I die!" he looks about him on every side.
73. The trees, the creepers, the kunjās — all have withered;
they stand with heads bowed, and moisture rains down from them.
74. But before him is a kadamba tree, and on it have blossomed
two or four flowers; seeing them, he rejoiced.
75. Seeing this, the Gosani fell to thinking;
and at that moment Srinivasa arrived.
76. The Gosani said: "Srinivasa, sit down;
a question has arisen in my mind; I will put it to you."
77. "Prabhu, what capacity have I to understand,
that you should ask me and I should give an answer?"
78. You yourself will speak through the body you have nurtured;¹⁰
if I have fortune enough, I shall hear it all."
79. The Gosani says: "Srinivasa, consider:
the trees, the creepers, the kunjās have all withered,
80. and moisture drips from them — this is most strange:
[for here] the creepers are ever fresh, and the six seasons are constant.

81. Why then should it be so in this Vrindavana,
where the creepers are ever fresh and all six seasons abide always?
82. Seeing this, my heart was astonished;
who else is there who could explain this truth?
83. Tell me and save my life — I am distraught;
if you do not tell me, this thorn will remain in my heart."
84. Srinivasa says: "Prabhu, I beg at your feet:
in a prahara I will come back to you."
85. "Good, good," the Gosani said to him;
"sit in seclusion in your lodging and ponder it in your heart."
86. As he pondered, a thought arose in his heart;
by its power he will tell him everything.
87. Meditating in his mind on Sri Rupa's feet, he went;
arriving, he saw the Gosani sitting there.
88. The other saw Srinivasa from afar with his eyes
and with great affection seated him near himself:
89. "Speak, speak, Srinivasa, so that I may have peace."
With joined palms, standing before him, he sets it all out:
90. "This Vrindavana exists for Krishna's lilas,¹¹
and especially all its kunja-groves.
91. When Krishna goes home, all the kunjās, creepers and groves
grow dejected and wither.
92. But when, at the time of some lila, he comes to that forest,
the withering passes and they bloom, glad at heart.
93. And all the more so his going elsewhere:¹²
how then can the trees and creepers live?"
94. Hearing this hint, the Gosani wept from both eyes,
and again, joyful at heart, he questions Srinivasa.¹³
95. [Srinivasa replies:] "And the kadamba that blooms on it —
[Krishna] planted it in childhood with his own hand.
96. Living in Mathura, Krishna thinks in his mind:
'How big has that plant I planted grown?'
97. That is why it blooms again and again.
This is as far as my understanding reaches — I have told it."
98. Embracing him, the Gosani weeps: "You have given me back my life;
you are the shakti of my Prabhu — of this there is no doubt.
99. From today your name is Srinivasa Acharya;
for the establishing of dharma you will carry out the work."
100. In the evening, [going] to see Govinda's arati,
he took Srinivasa with him.
101. Having seen the arati, he bowed down;
the pujari brought and gave [him] Govinda's prasada garland.

102. He told everyone about Srinivasa:
"Hear, all of you, something of his worth."
103. One by one he related all his virtues:
"From today his name is Acharya."
104. All agreed, saying, "As you command";
they brought and gave [him] Govinda's prasada flower garland,
105. applied a tilaka of flowers, anointed him with kunkuma;
and then all together raised the cry "Acharya!"
106. Acharya Thakura's heart was gladdened;
in tears, he bowed down again and again.
107. He addressed each as was fitting;
Sri Jiva Gosani came and embraced him.
108. From there he returns to his own lodging;
from that day the title Acharya was his.
109. Lokanatha Gosani, hearing of all this,
was filled with supreme joy and grace.
110. [Srinivasa] went to the feet of his own Prabhu and bowed down;
he placed his hand on his head and gave him many blessings.
111. That very moment he went to Lokanatha Gosani
and, bowing, fell at his feet.
112. He himself, with his own mouth, called him Acharya:
"By Sri Jiva's command you have become an arya."¹⁴
113. Thakura Mahashaya came and prostrated himself;
greeting him, the Acharya embraced him.
114. That night Sri Jiva Gosani reflected:
"I will carry out my Prabhu's command in every way.
115. All the dharma that accords with my Prabhu's books —
in Gauda no one knows its essence.
116. Taking all these books, the Acharya will go to Gauda,
and Thakura Mahashaya will go with him as his helper."
117. To complete the Kartika vow [with] a great festival,
Sri Jiva Gosani made extensive preparations.
118. How much shall I write of the provisions?
Cartloads of goods arrived — hundreds upon hundreds of loads.
119. He sends letters to all the Vaishnavas, to the bank of the Kunda —
to Sri Dasa Gosvami and the steadfast Kaviraja.
120. Everywhere he wrote letters: "Arrive on the day of dashami;¹⁵
be merciful, and all of you come together without fail."
121. To Sri Bhatta Gosani and Lokanatha Gosani,
to Bhugarbha and all the others in various places.
122. How much more shall I write of the invitations?
Vaishnavas began to come from wherever they were.

123. Some arrived on the day of dashami,
some came the next day, on ekadashi.
124. With great respect the Gosani gave them lodgings —
to each according to his devotion and his standing.
125. To write of all the comings and goings would be too long;
everyone came — who could count them?
126. From the night of ekadashi the cooking began:
some make flatbreads, some cook rice,
127. they make sweets, fried dishes, vegetable dishes and more;
Sri Jiva Gosvami, seeing it, rejoices beyond measure.
128. By the tenth danda of the day all was ready;
everywhere was the hum of talk about Krishna and Krishna's name.
129. They performed the bathing [of the Deities] with all the rites¹⁶
and carefully set out the food.
130. Before Radha-Krishna, Sri Chaitanya and Nityananda
they brought and placed the food with care,
131. [and also for] Sanatana, Rupa, Raghunatha Bhatta,
Svarupa, Sri Ramananda and the countless associates.
132. The Acharya himself offered the bhoga to all;
Sri Jiva Gosani then directs [what is to be done] in order.
133. Having seated all for the meal, they came out;¹⁷
then Sri Jiva grew somewhat calm.
134. After two more dandas Sri Jiva Gosani
told the Acharya to offer [the Deities] water to rinse their mouths.
135. Then Sri Jiva Gosani went himself
and called and brought Raghunatha and Gopala Bhatta.
136. Lokanatha Gosani came, and all the others;
countless Vaishnavas — hundreds upon hundreds — came and sat.
137. Coming, all sat in the courtyard of the kunja;
hundreds of lamps were lit in that place.¹⁸
138. Acharya Thakura performed the arati with betel;
everywhere many hymns are recited.
139. He looks upon all the devotees with a joyful heart;
coming out, he bows down and offers praise.
140. Then Sri Jiva Gosani humbly [says]:
"If you permit, I will arrange a place for the meal."
141. All together agreed at once
and sat down in their places to take prasada.
142. The seats were arranged as befitted each;
some sat to the right of one, some to the left.
143. Bowing down, the Acharya serves the food;
at the fragrance of the prasada everyone's heart rejoices.

144. Sri Jiva himself has the dishes served to all;
he is in tears and counts himself blessed.
145. He gazes on everyone — how beautiful they are:
like forms made of prema shedding a divine radiance.
146. At that moment the Gosani rises, weeping:
"Where have my Prabhus gone — Rupa and Sanatana?"
147. The waves of prema that arose then —
how much shall I write of every episode?
148. All rinsed their mouths, and were given spices to freshen the mouth;
Sri Jiva's heart was filled with supreme delight.
149. All went to their lodgings and sat in their places,
wholly absorbed in talk about Krishna.
150. The next day there was a great festival in the same way,
and the dishes and provisions were even more.
151. All the Gosanis sat together
and joyfully talk of Krishna's lilas.
152. Then Sri Jiva, finding an occasion in the talk,
tells everyone about Srinivasa:
153. "With great labour I have taught him all the shastras;
now all of you together, show him mercy.
154. The shakti of my Prabhu is upon him;
Sri Bhatta Gosani has shown him great mercy.
155. From the day he took shelter at these feet
he became expert in all the shastras and their reasoning.
156. All of you were formerly one company;
that is why the Prabhu gave [you] Vrindavana.
157. By that shakti and compassion [my Prabhu] made hundreds of thousands [of lines] of books,¹⁹
and you helped him greatly in this.
158. Of all lands, the Prabhu's very own is Gauda:
there dwell all the mahantas, in great numbers.
159. This dharma becomes manifest when the books are spread;
devise the way in which this may come about."
160. All, agreeing, say one thing:
"All know fully what Rupa's nature is.
161. By whatever means this may be accomplished,
we will all help with great joy."
162. Then Sri Jiva says: "Listen, mahashayas:
let Srinivasa Acharya go, if you are merciful.
163. No one else is fit to spread this;
and let Thakura Mahashaya go with him.
164. Lokanatha Gosani has shown him the greatest mercy;
the two are equal in worth and perfect in all things.

165. Loading a cart with books, let them go to Gauda;
at the command of all, these two will gladly go."
166. [All reply:] "Whatever you command has the consent of all.
You two, accept it."
167. Acharya Thakura and Thakura Mahashaya,
prostrating themselves, say humbly:
168. "If you permit, Prabhu, we will stay in Vrindavana
and serve the Prabhu's feet day and night.
169. To see all of you — our minds have no other wish;
all dharma will be preserved if this be permitted."
170. "The highest preserving of dharma, Prabhu,²⁰ is the preaching of dharma;
at the command of all, go to Gauda."
171. Sri Jiva Gosvami says to Bhatta Gosvami:
"Whatever you consider right has my consent."
172. To Lokanatha he says: "What is your command?"
[He replies:] "Whatever you command, he will take as his duty."
173. Then both prostrated themselves;
[the elders], drawing them near and placing their hands on their heads,
174. all together imparted shakti to the two of them:
"Rupa and Sanatana are merciful to you both.
175. Narottama and Srinivasa, you are the life of all;
by Sri Rupa's command, make [this dharma] manifest everywhere.
176. Everywhere the two of you will be victorious;
your branches will spread throughout the world."
177. And that day once again there was a joyful feast;
all stayed there together at their ease.
178. In the morning, having bathed, they took their leave;
I do not know how much happiness there was.
179. Sri Acharya Thakura and Thakura Mahashaya,
prostrating themselves [before all], depart, floating in prema.
180. All showed them mercy with great joy in their hearts;
seeing auspicious signs everywhere, people come and go.
181. "Whose power but Gauranga's could do so much?
Set dharma in motion — may there be victory everywhere!"
182. Taking leave of all, [the guests] go to their own places;
and then Sri Jiva Gosvami reflected in his mind.
183. In the town of Mathura there was a merchant, his servant;
with his own hand he wrote a letter and sent it to him.
184. Hearing the letter, the merchant came in haste,
prostrated himself and touched his head to his feet.
185. "[I need] a good cart and four bullocks that are strong,
and with them ten men — men you know yourself."

186. Calling the Acharya, he introduced them to one another:
"My Prabhu described hundreds of thousands [of lines] of books;²¹
187. in them are the lilas of Radha and Krishna and the conduct of Vaishnavas.
He will take them to Gauda and preach there.
188. Bring waxcloth and wrap them over with it;
on the road they will take it all, keeping it hidden."
189. He put some money into his hand;
and the other, joyful at heart, also helped somewhat.
190. "Within ten days get everything ready and bring it to me;
you yourself will go along with the cart."
191. Saying "As you command," he went home
and quickly got the cart and the waxcloth ready.
192. Sri Jiva Gosvami, through a Vaishnava,
called Thakura Mahashaya and sat [with him] in another kunja.
193. "Listen, Narottama, I will tell you one thing:
this Shyamananda has been living here with me.
194. Take him with you — in the joy of talk about Krishna;
and [from there] send him to his own country, giving him someone to go with him.
195. Give him money for expenses too, so that he suffers no hardship;
help him in every way."
196. "Listen, listen, Shyamananda, to my words:
this Narottama is my life.
197. As you know me, so know him;
about matters of bhajana, ask him.
198. What out of fear you did not ask me,
whatever is in your mind — ask him.
199. Or about the limbs of sadhana and the siddha body —
he will explain all the hidden subjects to you."
200. All the account of him that I have heard from beginning to end
I will write down, making it plain.
201. First I will write of his birth — what land he is from;
I will write in detail of his coming to Vrindavana,
202. of how he renounced worldly life and came —
I write this in detail: such was my guru's command.²²
203. Listen, hearers, put [your doubts] aside;
do not hold it against me that I break the order.
204. I write all this having heard it from the Prabhu's mouth;
hearing all this, you will feel no distress.
205. He was born not in Gauda but in the south;
I relate something about this.²³
206. Born of a good family, in the Sadgopa caste²⁴ —
how did he come to know the essence of Bhagavata-dharma?

207. He had sadhana earned beforehand;
without it, who would come to such a state?
208. His heart turned away from the world: "How can I attain Krishna?
I must certainly take a guru."
209. Rising in the night, he left home and went to a distant land;
he cast everything away and took the dress of a vairagi.
210. His father and mother, grieving, searched for him long,
made many enquiries, but did not find him.
211. Leaving the road on his left, he goes by the lower way;
after some days he reaches the village of Narajol.²⁵
212. Through Chewa-nagara he goes to Khanakul;
seeing Gopinatha,²⁶ he feels great joy.
213. Seeing that holy seat, he counted himself fortunate;
where he is going, where he will stay — he knows nothing.
214. The next day, in the evening, he came to Ambika
and sat alone, having gone to a secluded spot.
215. The beauty of that Thakura's temple-house²⁷ was enchanting;
seeing Chaitanya and Nityananda, he rejoiced at heart.
216. They performed the arati to the sound of many conches and bells;
nothing was heard but the sankirtana of Krishna's name.
217. Some dance, some weep, some roll on the ground;
in that bliss his heart sank, it touched his very soul.
218. A prahara of the night passed; the Vaishnavas [sat down] to eat;
seeing [him], one of the servants came up to him.
219. He asked: "Tell me, brother, where do you live?"
He replied: "I live in the southern country."
220. At the bidding of Thakura Mahashaya — to take prasada —
he entered the house together with the Vaishnavas.
221. He saw the Thakura sitting with the Vaishnavas,
speaking of Krishna — now weeping, now laughing.
222. Seeing him, he bowed down and took prasada;
having taken prasada freely, he rinsed his mouth.
223. Going to his place, he thinks to himself:
"What service shall I do to spend my time?"
224. At night he lay down to sleep; morning came;
he sweeps the rasa-mandala, singing of Krishna.
225. At that moment the Thakura comes; [the youth] prostrates himself;
[the Thakura] looked at him with joy in his heart.
226. Looking at one another, both bowed;
saying "Good, good," the Thakura went into the inner rooms.
227. From that day, as [the youth] went on serving,
[the Thakura], seeing this extraordinary youth, was pleased at heart.

228. He does his work with perfect purity; seeing this, [the Thakura] is glad.
Another day the Thakura called him.²⁸
229. Coming before him, he bowed down again and again;
his body trembling, he stands with both palms joined.
230. "What country are you from, son? Tell me about yourself.
You are detached from the world — whom do you have?"
231. "On earth I have no one; I am wretched from birth.
Seeing your feet, I have become happy."
232. Seeing the extraordinary youth, [the Thakura] was much pleased;
he himself said to the pujari who served there:
233. "Give him prasada freely.
Serve, son, and stay in this place."
234. Day by day [the youth's] service increased;
seeing it, everyone was very glad.
235. The Thakura's kindness grows day by day;
he works splendidly — and in everyone's heart affection for him arose.
236. One day the Thakura, sitting in the natamandira,²⁹
seeing the youth's service, says to him, smiling:
237. "Listen, child, you are alone — have you no one else?"
"Prabhu, in this world what I truly have is your feet."
238. "Whose disciple are you? Of what family [of succession]?"
"These two feet I have truly made my all."
239. I have no one in the world, Prabhu; I am utterly poor;
I am not worthy to speak — and I am without bhakti.
240. Who but you is the purifier of the fallen?
Be merciful, give me shelter at your fearless feet."
241. [The Thakura] understood that he wished to become his disciple;
from that day [the youth] worked with the greatest diligence.
242. One day, when the Thakura was sitting in a certain place,
[the youth], with joined palms, addresses him:
243. "Prabhu, your descent is for the deliverance of the poor and lowly;
and there is no one in the world as fallen as I."
244. Gazing at his form, he weeps: "I have no one;
in life and in death my refuge is your two feet."
245. The Prabhu showed mercy, called him to his side,
and holding his head, gave Hari-nama into his ear.
246. He bows down many times and gazes at his face;
[the Thakura], calling him, placed his feet upon his head.
247. From then on he was bidden to serve [the Thakura] personally;
day by day his zeal and love grew.
248. He is most attentive to the Vaishnavas, devoted to Krishna's name;
on seeing the Prabhu he offers praise with joined palms.

249. The command came: "Go, son, and bathe";
at once all run to the bank of the Ganges.
250. Having bathed in the Ganges, he came to him;
seeing him, the Thakura said: "Sit here."
251. Taking his hand in his own, he graciously gave him the Krishna-mantra:
"Chant the mantra a hundred times, meditating on Krishna."
252. He told him the whole way of bhajana;
tears flow from [the youth's] eyes, his hair stands on end unceasingly.
253. Again and again he prostrates himself and bows:
"True are Krishna's two feet, true is Krishna's name."
254. "From today your name is Duhkhi Krishnadasa;³⁰
serve me, living in this place."
255. From that day he is devoted to Krishna's name:
in seclusion, waking through the night, he chants Krishna's name.
256. Hunger and thirst have left him; he drinks the nectar of prema;
the Vaishnavas sing of his sadhana.
257. Seeing his strong faith, the Thakura himself [says]:
"Sit by me, son, I will tell you something."
258. Listen further, son, about my Prabhu,
whose life is Chaitanya and Nityananda.
259. Subala Thakura, Krishna's dear and intimate friend —
he is my Prabhu Gauridasa, the sprout of prema.
260. Day and night he is with Chaitanya and Nityananda;
I cannot bear the waves of his prema.
261. Even in their presence he showed [the pangs of] separation from the two Prabhus —
he whose play with them is always, before and after.
262. Having manifested [their] images, he set about feeding them;
they did not eat, and spoke not a word.
263. Hearing of this, the two Prabhus [came] to the Pandita,
called him and said something — hear the account:
264. 'We have heard that you have manifested two images;
bring them here — we will look at them.'
265. He brought the two images and set them before them:
they were just like the two Prabhus themselves.
266. 'Go and cook — we shall eat.'
The Pandita cooked, deep in thought.
267. Rice, kshira, many vegetable dishes — he prepared four offerings;
the two Prabhus brought the two images and seated them.
268. They say: 'Eat, let us see — all four of us; let our eyes be soothed!'
The two images and the two Prabhus ate.
269. Having rinsed his mouth, the Prabhu says to the Pandita:
'Know this for certain, Gauridasa:

270. we are two, and these are two — which of us will you see?
The Prabhu says: 'These two will stay in your house.
271. You will not be able to live without seeing us — I tell you;
whenever you wish, we will come to your house.
272. In the form of these two images, we two
will eat in your house every day.'
273. That Prabhu made me his own;
the lord of my life gave me the service of these two.
274. I have told you everything — listen attentively;
I have told you all this, seeing that you are worthy."
275. He is wholly detached, there is nothing else in his mind;
he cries out constantly: "Vrindavana!"
276. One day he stood before the Prabhu;
he is afraid at heart and cannot speak.
277. "Speak, son, do not be afraid — what is it you would say?"
"If you permit, I will go to Sri Vrindavana."
278. "Good, good," the Prabhu said to him;
"may Vrindavana soon show you mercy.
279. Go to Vrindavana, son, and listen [to the teachings there]."
So Hridaya Chaitanya Dasa understood his words.³¹
280. Rising in the morning, the Thakura gave him leave;
he bowed down, and [the Thakura] placed his feet upon his head.
281. There the two Prabhus are seated; the Thakura came [before them]:
"Show abundant mercy to Krishnadasa!"
282. Bringing a cloth that was prasada, he tied it on his head;
bowing down, weeping, the youth departs slowly.
283. In great detachment he sings Krishna's name unceasingly;
without a care for food, he walks along the road.
284. Remembering his Prabhu, he weeps:
"When shall I come and see Vrindavana with my own eyes?"
285. How much shall I write of what happened on the road?
In how many places, how many times [the waves of prema] rose — hundreds upon hundreds.
286. Little by little he came to Mathura;
he weeps and rolls on the ground in prema.
287. Seeing Krishna's birthplace, he wept long;
wandering about, he came to the Vishrama ghat.
288. At night he resolves in his mind: "All Vrindavana
I will wander through and see everything everywhere."
289. Morning came — he walks towards Vrindavana;
he cannot walk, abundant tears fall on his breast.
290. From afar he saw the chakra³² of Govinda's [temple];
seeing it, he lost consciousness and fell to the ground.

291. Beholding Govinda, maddened with prema,
weeping and weeping, he falls down in obeisance.
292. Coming to Vrindavana, he sees all those places
and, bowing down, weeps, beside himself.
293. He sees Dhira-samira and Vamshivata,
he sees the whole bank of the Yamuna,
294. he sees Chir-ghat and Amlī-tala;³³
to see the forests he went to Govardhana.
295. Then he came to the two kundas, the lakes;
he prostrates himself many times before Kundeshvara.³⁴
296. Having circumambulated the Kunda, he bows down;
[people] tell him of the many virtues of Sri Dasa Gosvami.
297. He asked, and people say: "Here [he is]";
gazing at his form, he bows down.
298. [The Gosvami] is absorbed in sadhana and speaks to no one;
tears fall from both his eyes; [the youth] remains standing.
299. After a while the Gosani spoke:
"Where have you come from, Vaishnava?"
300. Prostrating himself, he answers:
"I was born in the southern country; [I have come] to see the Prabhu's feet."
301. "What is your name? At whose feet have you taken shelter?"
"My name is Duhkhi Krishnadasa, I submit.
302. My Prabhu is Hridaya Chaitanya Dasa Mahashaya";
hearing this, the Gosani's heart rejoiced the more.
303. "My parama-guru is Gauridasa Pandita Thakura."
Hearing this, the Gosani was filled with abundant joy.
304. "Sit, sit, son, Duhkhi Krishnadasa!
[Gauridasa is] the joyful play of Sri Chaitanya and Nityananda.
305. Tell me, is all well with your teacher?"³⁵
Whatever he asked, he told him all.
306. Gladdened, [the Gosvami] showed him great mercy:
"Go now to another kunja and see the Kaviraja."
307. Saying "As you command," he goes to see him;
he sees him inside his hut, absorbed in remembrance.
308. Two or four dandas passed — he remains standing;
finding the moment, he falls down in obeisance.
309. [The Kaviraja] is very old, his body frail, his voice barely audible;
after a while he sees [someone] lying on the ground.
310. "Who are you, who are you, son? Tell me.
Why do you pain your body with so many prostrations?"
311. Rising, he gives his name — Duhkhi Krishnadasa:
"I have come in the hope of seeing the Prabhu's feet."

312. "Good, good, come here and tell me about yourself:
where have you come from?"
313. I do not know you, and my eyes see very poorly;
at which mahashaya's feet have you taken shelter?"
314. "I was born in the southern country, in the village of Ambuyavali;³⁶
my Prabhu's name is Hridaya Chaitanya Dasa.
315. My Prabhu's Prabhu is Gauridasa Pandita;
his service to Chaitanya and Nityananda is unbroken."
316. With great kindness he seated him close by,
and, seating him close by, touched his body.
317. He asked for all the good news;
again and again he asks, and the youth tells it once more.
318. Thus, having seen him, he stayed by the Kunda,
[and later] came again to Vrindavana, longing to see it.
319. Coming there, he beheld Sri Madanamohana
and, losing consciousness, fell to the ground at once.
320. Then he came and saw Sri Jiva Gosani;
the Gosani was sitting — and seeing him, he was glad.
321. Having seen him, he cannot take his eyes away;
gazing intently, he bowed down.
322. The Gosani says: "Vaishnava, do not bow;
tell me about yourself — stop all these obeisances."
323. Seeing him, the Gosani was very pleased:
"Where have you come from just now?"
324. What is your name? Tell me the name of your Thakura."
Smiling, the Gosani questions him gently.
325. He says: "My name is Duhkhi Krishnadasa;
my father and mother live in the southern country.
326. Hridaya Chaitanya Dasa is my Thakura,
and the Pandita Thakura is his Prabhu."
327. Hearing this, he shows him great mercy:
"Seeing you, I am truly very glad."
328. Seeing his detachment, the Gosani thinks to himself:
"With me he will find happiness in the end."
329. "Sit, Vaishnava, I will ask you about everything:
will you go back to your country, or stay here for good?"
330. "Who can stay without your mercy?
Such is my wish — I want to stay."
331. Seeing his devotion, his meekness and humility,
he says: "Stay in this kunja; take shelter here.
332. If you have a wish in your mind to study,
I will teach you all the shastras — study diligently.

333. You will receive prasada here and practise sadhana;
doing a chore or two, you will study with me."³⁷
334. Saying "As you command," he bowed down again and again;
[Jiva] placed his hand on his head with joy in his heart.
335. Choosing an auspicious day, he began his studies,
and, studying, became highly proficient.
336. At night he practises sadhana in another kunja;
sometimes he listens to books of bhakti with joy in his heart.
337. Grammar was completed; he reads some poetry;
sometimes, sitting, he copies something from the books of bhakti.
338. Through his studies he became very learned,
and the Gosani bids him study the books of bhakti.
339. The Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu — from the very beginning;
as he studied it, his heart rejoiced.
340. As he went into siddhanta, vaidhi and raga, and tattva,
the Gosani would raise objections³⁸ — and was glad at heart.
341. With him he studies the Ujjvala³⁹ with its commentary
and became competent in everything, in expounding and in hearing.
342. While studying the books on the lilas of Radha and Krishna,
he says humbly before the Gosani:
343. "What mood, what endeavour, what manner of sadhana —
let your command be given to this lowly one."
344. Then the Gosani told him of the five rasas,
and especially let him hear of the madhura-rasa:
345. of this bhava, of the bearer of bhava, of the raga approved [by Rupa] —
he tells him without reserve, as to his follower.
346. As he listened, longing⁴⁰ arose in Krishnadasa,
and humbly he began to speak:
347. "As you have bidden, so accept me —
[into] the essence of dharma approved by Sri Rupa.
348. If one takes shelter of the view of him whose books these are,
then every perfection becomes a giver of boons.
349. Seeing you and relishing these books,
longing arose in my mind, but out of fear I did not speak.
350. You, full of mercy, have accepted me;
by your grace I have learned this essence of bhava."
351. The Gosani accepted him — [his life] bore fruit;
receiving [this], he gained strength like a lion's.
352. After two or four days he seated him close by
and gave him the six-syllable mantra of Radhika-ji.
353. The five names of Krishna and the five names of Radhika —
he explained the rule for the times of chanting them.

354. Then he told him in particular of the kama-bija —
how to chant it joined with the lilas of Radha and Krishna.
355. He took on the mood of a sakhi, as her follower,⁴¹ —
and the time of service, and the sadhana approved for each.
356. "What you have heard here — I have told you the essence;
later you will hear all the rest in full.
357. Listen, Krishnadasa, to what must and must not be done:
Hridaya Chaitanya Dasa is assuredly your guru.
358. He gave you the Krishna-mantra; from his mercy
and together with his mercy all these attainments come.
359. If you commit an offence against him, all will be destroyed;
keep these words of mine in your heart."
360. "Whatever the Prabhu commands is my duty."
Coming outside, he prostrated himself without end.
361. From the day he heard this, he practises sadhana:
he studies with the Gosani and sits in remembrance in the kunja.
362. At night, sitting, his mind absorbed in the lilas of Radha and Krishna,
how many bhavas he feels as he contemplates them!
363. One day Radha and Krishna with their sakhis
were all dancing and singing in the kunja, in manifold waves [of delight].⁴²
364. Radha and the sakhis held one another arm in arm,⁴³
and in the middle Krishnachandra shone all the more.
365. The sakhis dance with joyful hearts;
in the middle dances Krishna, the enchanter of the world.
366. All the sakhis sing and play instruments there;⁴⁴
Radha dances, Krishna watches.
367. The sakhis play many wonderful instruments and sing;
Radhika dances, and sometimes makes the sakhis dance.
368. Thus [they] dance for Krishna's pleasure;
in this rasa all are enraptured, their eyes soothed.
369. Radhika danced there without stint;
from her left foot an anklet slipped off and fell.
370. She herself did not know, nor did the sakhis know,
whether it was on her foot or where it had fallen.
371. After the dance [Radha and Krishna] go and lie down on the couch;
the sakhis watch, putting their eyes to the lattice window.
372. They spent the night in the rasa of love — and the night came to its end;
the sakhis bade them rise.
373. Rising after a long while, their bodies heavy with sweet languor,
in shame and fear they get up and go each to their own home.
374. The sakhis went off to their dwellings;
the anklet lay there — no one knew.

375. At that time Duhkhi Krishnadasa rose,
joyful at heart that he would see the Rasa-sthali.
376. He gazes at the footprints and prostrates himself;
tears flow from his eyes, joy is in his heart.
377. [And there,] covered with leaves, lies a jewelled anklet;
from its fragrance prema swells abundantly.
378. He picked it up, [placed it] on his head, and walks slowly;
he cannot walk — prema has filled his heart.
379. He came to the place where the Gosani was;
the Gosani saw the wondrous anklet with his own eyes.
380. He knew in his mind whose anklet this was;⁴⁵
taking it in his hands, he prostrates himself before it.
381. He pressed it to his breast and his face, to his eyes, placed it on his head;
the Gosani's throat choked, and he fell to the ground.
382. Krishnadasa raised the Gosani and seated him;
holding the anklet to his breast, [Jiva] began to weep:
383. "How much sadhana you have done, for how long!
The limit of your good fortune I cannot tell."
384. He kissed Krishnadasa and held him to his breast:
"The kunkuma from [her] feet has touched your head."
385. Again and again he smells the crown of his head⁴⁶
and deems his own life fortunate.
386. On both sides, in the middle of the breast,⁴⁷ a dot of kunkuma —
the place shone like the full moon.
387. A tilaka in the shape of Krishna's foot, with Radhika's dot,
he made for him, rejoicing in his own heart.⁴⁸
388. "All the mahashayas will rejoice at this;
from today your name is Shyamananda."⁴⁹
389. A tilaka in the shape of Hari's foot is attested everywhere [in scripture];
knowing this, accept it — and let no one find fault with it."
390. He showed great mercy to that Shyamananda;
the other, full of joy, bows down without end.
391. That Shyamananda the Gosani then sent off,
placing his hand in the hand of Thakura Mahashaya.
392. However many his branches will be, wherever they may be —
how many sinners, sufferers, people of low birth they will deliver!
393. All this I cannot write, though I perceive it;
all this I heard from the holy mouth of my Prabhu.
394. I merely write, making that command my strength;
whoever reviles this is ignorant.
395. He is a devotee of Krishna, so in this there is nothing to wonder at;
all the shastras proclaim it again and again.

396. In the morning [Jiva] sent a man to Mathura:
"Quickly bring the men here with the cart."
397. Then Jiva Gosani thought in his mind:
"Call Thakura Mahashaya and bring him to me;
398. call Srinivasa Acharya and bring him here;
bring both quickly — there is a reason."
399. Acharya Thakura and Thakura Mahashaya [came];
seeing them, the Gosani rejoiced at heart:
400. "Take leave, each of you, of your own Prabhu,
and come to me with joy in your hearts."
401. The two went to Lokanatha Gosani
and, arriving, told him of the Gosani's [command].
402. Hearing it, he was deeply grieved;
Narottama, weeping, says:
403. "The Gosani's command is my task;
if the command is broken, great harm results."
404. [Lokanatha says:] "All instruction and initiation I gave you before;
you are worthy, and I know you will carry this out.
405. But one thing I doubt — this is my fear:
I know well that [for you] the time of marriage [has come].⁵⁰
406. Living amid worldly affairs, keep complete renunciation;
give up oil, always keep to havishya.⁵¹
407. First of all perform the service of Gauranga,
and after that the service of Radha and Krishna.
408. As service to Krishna, so service to the Vaishnavas:
carry them out as one.
409. Sankirtana, great festivals, processions and the like —
hold them, carefully keeping my command."
410. Calling the Acharya, he entrusted [Narottama] into his hands:
"Take Narottama carefully on the road,
411. so that the dharma I have spoken of may be preserved;
never be careless, always help him."
412. Saying "As you command," the two bowed down;
again and again they weep, gazing at his face.
413. Calling them, he embraced them and [placed] his feet on their heads:
"You alone I know as my very life.
414. This decrepit body of mine has no strength left;
come again, so that you may see [me] once more."
415. Calling Acharya Thakura, the Gosani embraced him
and, holding him with both hands, speaks, shedding tears:
416. "The life in my body departs along with [you];
I have told you this — the charge is no longer mine."

417. Acharya Thakura took the dust of his feet:
"As Narottama is to you, so let Srinivasa be.
418. Show such mercy that in the minds of us both it may be:
birth after birth may we never forget your feet."
419. Weeping and weeping, the two came out;
their hearts were distraught, they could not compose themselves.
420. That very moment they went to Sri Bhatta Gosvami;
seeing them, the Gosani understood the whole reason.
421. Arriving, they bowed down, prostrated themselves and offered praise.
"Sit, sit, children, hear my words.
422. Sri Rupa's books are to be preached in Gauda;
who will do it? I see no one like [you] in the world.
423. You will preach all dharma according to the books
and keep your own dharma.
424. As I told you before what each must do,
so teach everyone.
425. This is my own work; go with care,
and do as the Gosani commands.
426. Do this work, children, with undivided minds;
and come once more to Vrindavana.
427. I shall look at you once more to my eyes' content —
then my desire will be fulfilled.
428. Srinivasa and Narottama, you two —
from today the life has left my body."⁵²
429. What state came over him then, only he knows;
for a whole prahara he lay on the ground, weeping.
430. Srinivasa says: "Prabhu, what more can I say?
I was not able to serve you for long.
431. I had many desires — fate has thwarted them;
[when] shall I see your feet with my eyes again?"
432. Embracing Narottama, Srinivasa weeps:
"The fault of my own karma has come to light."
433. At Narottama's weeping a stone would split:
"Leaving the Prabhu's feet, where am I going?
434. In his mercy he himself gave me his two feet;
has the fruit of some offence now ripened?"
435. Both roll on the ground, crying "Lord of my life!"
"What happiness do you seek, O heart, going off on the road?"
436. The state that came then cannot be written;
not a drop of it touched the body of this sinner."⁵³
437. Who has such love for the guru?
Hearing it and writing it, my heart is amazed.

438. What virtues, what prema, what a state the two were in!
Only by the power of fortune do I hold even the slightest hope of it.
439. Whoever, setting argument aside, listens to this,
at the end attains the feet of Radha and Krishna.
440. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the twelfth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "For some days he stayed with his own Prabhu." The Prabhu is Lokanatha Gosvami.
2. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "his body thrilled, and he wept in great prema".
3. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "This is nothing."
4. According to Gaudiya tradition, the siddha form of Jiva Gosvami himself is Vilasa Manjari. Cf. ch. 11, where Lokanatha gives Narottama the form of Vilasa Manjari.
5. The 1913 edition has the past tense: "the whole world was flooded".
6. Radha-kunda, where Raghunatha Dasa Gosvami (Sri Dasa Gosvami) lived.
7. The sense seems to be that in Bengali payar the narrative inevitably grows long, unlike concise Sanskrit.
8. Literally "three months over and above — I report". Initiation in Vaishakha plus three months brings us to Shravana, the date of this meeting (59).
9. The Lalita-madhava, a drama by Rupa Gosvami; it describes Krishna's departure for Mathura and the gopis' separation from him.
10. Literally "your planted body", i.e. Srinivasa himself, nurtured by Jiva's teaching.
11. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "for Krishna's play (vilasa)".
12. That is, Krishna's departure for Mathura described in the Lalita-madhava.
13. The line apparently introduces the question about the kadamba, which is not given directly.
14. A play on words: "acharya" and "arya" (noble, honourable).
15. Dashami and ekadashi, the tenth and eleventh lunar days (here of the bright fortnight of Kartika).
16. Literally "they performed the bathing, doing all the samskaras"; who was bathed is not stated — apparently the Deities before the offering.
17. That is, having offered the food to the Deities and the eternal associates, they came out of the shrine, leaving them to "eat".
18. Both editions have "candrākṣa" (?); perhaps "candrātapa", canopies. The translation is conjectural.
19. Literally "a lakh (a hundred thousand) of books"; the 1999 edition below has "my Prabhu described a lakh of books". Tradition speaks of the "lakh of shlokas" written by Rupa and Sanatana.
20. The address "Prabhu" here seems to come from the elders to the Acharya, or else the line is Jiva's own reply; neither edition marks the speaker.
21. See note 19.
22. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "...at whose feet he took shelter and renounced the world".
23. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "...why he was born in Madhyadesha".
24. So the 1999 edition (sadgopa, a farming caste); the 1913 edition has "in the family of the gopijanas" (?).
25. So the 1999 edition; the 1913 edition has "Naradeu" (?).
26. Khanakul, the seat of Abhirama; Gopinatha, the Deity worshipped there.
27. Ambika (Kalna), the seat of Gauridasa Pandita; the Thakura here is his disciple Hridaya Chaitanya, keeper of the images of Chaitanya and Nityananda. Below (220) he is called Thakura Mahashaya — not to be confused with Narottama.
28. Both editions have "called me" — apparently a corruption or a trace of a first-person account.
29. The natamandira, the open hall in front of a temple's shrine.
30. The 1913 edition here and below often has "Duhkhini Krishnadasa"; so too in places the 1999 edition.
31. The sense of the line is unclear; perhaps it means that Hridaya Chaitanya understood his disciple's wish.
32. "cakrabeḍa", apparently the chakra (wheel finial) on the spire of Govinda's temple, visible from afar.
33. Amli-tala, the spot under a tamarind tree (imli) by the Yamuna associated with Mahaprabhu.

34. Kundeshvara, Shiva as guardian of Radha-kunda.
35. Literally "of the adhikari", i.e. of his guru, Hridaya Chaitanya.
36. So the 1999 edition (); the 1913 edition has "Anuyavali". The reading is uncertain.
37. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "for a prahara or two you will study with me".
38. "pūrvapakṣa", putting forward an opponent's objection so that the pupil may refute it.
39. Rupa Gosvami's Ujjvala-nīlamanī (here apparently with Jiva's commentary).
40. "lobha", "greed, longing": in Rupa's teaching, that which awakens rāgānuga-bhakti.
41. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he took on the mood of a sakhi, following the sakhis".
42. A variant of the second line given in the 1913 edition: "were singing and dancing there in great delight".
43. So in the variant given in the 1913 edition; the main text of both editions is unclear ("Radha — the sakhis with her own arm, with the other arm").
44. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "the sakhis dance with arms linked".
45. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he knew in his heart whose anklet this was".
46. Smelling the crown of the head is a sign of tender, parental love.
47. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "between the brows". The main text apparently describes the application of tilaka.
48. That is, the special tilaka worn by Shyāmananda's followers. The line is somewhat unclear in both editions.
49. "Shyāmananda", "the joy of Shyama (Krishna)".
50. That is, his family will press Narottama to marry. The reading of the line is conjectural.
51. Havishya, plain ascetic food (rice with ghee, without spices) prescribed during vows.
52. The 1913 edition has "from the very beginning".
53. That is, the author laments that he himself has no share in such a state.
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Vilasa 13. The Theft of the Books and the Conversion of Vira Hambira

Farewell to Gopala Bhatta and Lokanatha; Jiva sends the books in a chest on a cart; the journey through Agra and Jharikhanda; Vira Hambira's men rob the cart near Gopalpur; the passing of Krishnadasa Kaviraja; Narottama returns to Kheturi and instructs Shyamananda; Srinivasa in Vishnupura: his exposition of the Bhagavata at court, the recovery of the books, the initiation of the king and of the pandita Vyasa; news sent to Narottama; Srinivasa with his mother at Yajigrama; Ramachandra of Teliya Budhari seeks to meet him

1. Glory, glory to Chaitanya, the purifier of the fallen!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, the wealth of those who have nothing!
2. Glory to Advaitachandra, the utmost limit of virtue!
Glory, glory to the devotees, the fulfilment of desires!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, glory to Virachandra!
When I took shelter at such holy feet,
4. by the strength of that command I write of the power of those feet;
hear what gain came to me from hearing and writing.
5. The words I hear from the Prabhu's mouth I write down;¹
what has come of writing them I see with my own eyes.
6. Seating me close by, he tells it in order;
to whom shall I tell how my heart rejoices as I listen?
7. Whatever I hear I write down on paper,
and some four dandas later I read it aloud in his presence.
8. His heart was gladdened, and he showed great mercy;
the words of his holy mouth are perfection, those feet my refuge.
9. "Go, Srinivasa, my son — why do you weep?
Write [to me] of good and ill on your journey.
10. Narottama will be with you in all things;
two bodies, one life — so all people sing.
11. Your going has brought me so much pain;
when I have news, good or ill, I shall live again.²
12. Go carefully on the road, so that no harm befalls."
Weeping and weeping, the Gosani says this.³
13. He embraced them both with the greatest mercy:
"Carry out that work so that no loss befalls."
14. Saying "As you command," the Acharya went out;
he cannot walk, his body has grown weak.
15. Remaining before the Gosani,⁴ Thakura Mahashaya
bows down and says to him:
16. "This Narottama is but a semblance of your servant;
to attain these two feet — I have no other hope."

17. "Go, Narottama, my son, what more can I say?
In Vrindavana you have attained every perfection.
18. You will live together with Srinivasa."
Hearing this, his heart was gladdened.
19. Saying "As you command," he went out of the kunja;
however much he tries to calm his heart, it will not be calm.
20. Then they went to Sri Jiva Gosani;
having made ready a chest, he is packing books into it in seclusion.
21. All the books of Sri Rupa and his own books
he laid inside it layer upon layer.
22. With the help of many people the chest was carried out
and all of it loaded onto the cart.
23. In the presence of all he put a lock on it
and wrapped it in waxcloth, tightly on every side.
24. All the money for the road he gave to the three:
"Wherever you go, be careful."
25. With joyful hearts they yoked the bullocks,
meditating on the feet of Rupa and Sanatana,
26. remembering Chaitanya, Nityananda, Advaita and the devotees —
for every blessing.
27. The cart came to the door of Govinda's [temple];
together with Sri Jiva they go to behold [Him].
28. They saw Govinda seated on the throne,
and, bowing down many times, they addressed Him:
29. "For the welfare of Srinivasa and Narottama
be merciful — we pray at Your feet."
30. The pujari placed prasada garlands round the necks of both;
bowing down, the two set off towards Mathura.
31. Together with Sri Jiva Gosvami in the town of Mathura
they all gathered and spent the night.
32. Sending the merchant, he obtained a royal pass;
in it [an order] was written to let them through the toll-posts as far as Jajpur.⁵
33. Morning came; all, joyful at heart,
go along the road, slowing their pace at times.
34. Outside the town, at the hour of parting,
Sri Jiva embraced them and says:
35. "Gaurangasundara is the crown jewel of all rasas;
his shakti is the bodies of Sanatana and Rupa.
36. The form of Sri Gauranga's prema is in the bodies of these two;
know in your hearts that Rupa and Sanatana are [his] shakti.⁶
37. By the command of that Chaitanya, to make prema manifest,
Rupa and Sanatana described it [in their books].

38. The dharma that is in those books is manifest in you;
you two are able to make it manifest everywhere.⁷
39. This is not my command — it is the Prabhu's order:
go quickly, both of you, to Gauranga's own land.
40. May your journey be easy and auspicious.
I carry out the command — even at the cost of my life.⁸
41. Srinivasa and Narottama, you are my life;
stay together, do not go separate ways."
42. Clasp them round the neck, he weeps, losing consciousness:
"My heart is enchanted by the virtues of you two.
43. In life and in death you will remain in my heart;
you and I know this — it is no concern of anyone else."
44. Sri Jiva Gosvami, taking Shyamananda by the hand,
showed him great mercy, joyful at heart:
45. "When you reach your country, serve Krishna, serve the Vaishnavas,
preach dharma, set prema in motion.
46. Go to your country without anxiety — everywhere there will be blessing;
through your branches all will be flooded [with prema].
47. Achyutananda's son, named Murari Dasa,
has set his heart on your shelter."⁹
48. "I told you of this before — pay heed to it,"
and, taking [Shyamananda] by the hand, he entrusted him to Narottama:
49. "You will explain the subjects to him according to the Ganoddasha;¹⁰
let him know in his heart what must and must not be done in sadhana."¹¹
50. In accordance with the book Bhakti-rasamrita
explain everything to him freely and clearly.
51. Through the Ujjvala, the best book on the lilas of rasa,
instruct him, and send him quickly to his own country.
52. Give him two men as companions and money for the road,
so that he suffers no hardship and goes with joy in his heart."
53. They began to weep, clasping his two feet;
embracing them, he sent them off.
54. With them go ten armed Hindus¹²
and two cart-drivers, so that they suffer no hardship.
55. "On the road, ward off every [danger];
let no one's mind waver in any way."
56. So the three go, weeping and weeping,
remembering Rupa, Sanatana and Jiva.
57. The Gosani went back to Sri Vrindavana,
always thinking of the road and wishing them well.
58. Showing the royal pass, they go from place to place;
they spent one night at Agra.

59. Rising at dawn, they then go on quickly;
chanting Krishna's name, they go along the road with silent minds.
60. At night they sit talking of Krishna;
how the day passes they do not notice.
61. Showing the royal pass everywhere,
they went as far as the town of Tarikta.¹³
62. For some days they went easily along the royal road;
then they resolved to go by the Jharikhanda road.¹⁴
63. Keeping the country of Magadha on their left, they go along the road;
going by the forest road, they feel great joy.
64. The three go along merrily, talking of Krishna;
a good distance they cover in accounts of Krishna's lilas.
65. Leaving the Jhari country behind, they came on,
and go towards Tamluk, joyful in mind.¹⁵
66. At night they sit in talk about the object of worship, speaking of Krishna;
so they go on happily, not noticing the forest.
67. Cuckoos and peacocks call, [the peacocks] dance;
seeing this, they feel bhava as if in Vrindavana.
68. Mahaprabhu felt great joy in Jharikhanda;¹⁶
seeing [these places], they weep, tremble, their hair stands on end.
69. In supreme bliss they know no sorrow;
it does not even cross their minds that good or ill might befall.
70. The king of Vishnupura, named Vira Hambira,
lives by banditry; he is utterly wicked.¹⁷
71. In his service were many men called "reckoners",¹⁸
and hundreds of phansiyara stranglers, killers of men.¹⁹
72. These people go to every country and kill;
they went along following the cart.
73. Reckoning, they go along the road through other men's kingdoms;
since it is another's country, they do not kill, but go alongside.
74. [The travellers,] keeping Panchavati on the left, [passed] Raghunathpur;
saying, "This is our own country!" they were filled with great joy.
75. In a village called Maliyara there is a bhaumik;²⁰
they stayed there at ease, without fear.
76. [The bandits,] reckoning, see that the cart is full of great wealth —
diamonds, gems, rubies, so many priceless jewels!
77. Two of them went ahead and tell the king;
"Gold, diamonds, rubies," said the evil-minded ones.
78. The king asked: "How many people are with it?"
"Fifteen people," they said for certain.
79. "Take two hundred men and go;
do not take their lives, but bring all the wealth."

80. Many musketeers and archers
go to rob the cart, having laid their plans.
81. There is a village, Gopalpur, most charming;
there the travellers stopped for the night, joyful at heart.
82. Two praharas of the night passed in the sweetness of talk about Krishna;
some lay down, some are sitting.
83. All of them, like Death itself, fell upon them;
"Kill, kill! Cut, cut!" they cry as they loot.
84. All stood frozen with fear;
[the bandits] plundered the cart — no one took up arms.
85. By the forest road they took [the cart] to the king;
morning came — and all [the travellers] were in distress.
86. The king himself came out to take the cart;
seeing the cart's bullocks, he rejoices at heart.
87. He has the cart placed inside his palace;
sending the people away, he opens the cart and looks.
88. He saw a large chest inside;
seeing its beauty, the king rejoices.
89. In it he saw a great many books;
great sorrow came over his heart, and he fell to thinking.
90. Coming out, the king summoned the men;
all who had gone [on the raid] came.
91. "By what road did the cart come? Tell me, brothers;
from how far away did you bring it?"²¹
92. [...] with you, king, we came with it;²²
when we reckon, we see all kinds of wealth [in it]."
93. "A cart of goods, king," so all report;
[the king] grew thoughtful, but says nothing to anyone.
94. He had the chest, just as it was, placed in the treasury
and told the people to keep it carefully.
95. Meanwhile Acharya Thakura and Thakura Mahashaya
wander about, saying nothing to anyone.
96. Shyamananda was stunned;
on all of them fell a heavy burden of great sorrow.
97. To the cart-drivers and [escort] he says:
"Listen, brothers, to what more I have to say.
98. Of [the ways of] this country one cannot even speak;
coming to our own country, we have found sorrow in our hearts.
99. All that was with us has been taken;
do not grieve — go to your homes.
100. What has happened I shall write to the Gosvami
and set out all our sorrow in a letter."

101. "Good, good," the people said to him;
[he] took them all into the village.
102. There he asked for paper and pen
and wrote in everyone's presence what had happened.
103. They went off on their way;
and [the Acharya and his companions] go from village to village asking, weeping without cease.
104. Nowhere do they find a trace, people say nothing;
who can bear the sorrow that has settled in their hearts?
105. "Sri Krishna Chaitanya Prabhu, Nityananda Raya!
To bring [the books] home — and such sorrow was our lot!
106. Rupa, Sanatana, Jiva, Prabhu, lord of my life!
With what joy shall I pass my days, orphaned?
107. So much labour spent to come so far!
I have committed an offence — I left the Prabhu's service."
108. So he thinks to himself, sitting in the forest;
his life is ebbing away, a great thorn has lodged in his heart.
109. "All the commands that were given have come to nothing;
who knows this sorrow, to whom shall I tell it?"
110. As if mad, he wanders from village to village,²³
weeping without cease and pondering within himself.
111. There is a reason for this — it can be perceived;
know for certain that this is Chaitanya's will.
112. Rupa, Sanatana and Jiva set this play in motion:
[the bandits] stole all the books, taking them for wealth.
113. And this is not without ground — for that alone is true wealth;
the "reckoner" reckoned [rightly] — what fault is there in him?
114. All the questions and answers with Ramananda²⁴
the Kaviraja wrote down with joy in his heart.
115. Rasa, bhakti, the truth of Krishna, the account of prema —
how many proofs of it shall I set down?
116. One who knows that truth understands it in his heart;
he will understand the reason for what I write.
117. "Tell me, Raya, which wealth counts as wealth among all riches?"
"He who has prema for Radha and Krishna is the richest of men."²⁵
118. In all of Sri Rupa's books, in the accounts of the lilas —
how much wealth of prema there is in their waves!
119. The wealth of prema is strung in them letter by letter;
[the "reckoner"] counted them in his heart as a touchstone.
120. The word of the one who reckoned is not false;
and there is a reason why [the books] were stolen.
121. In whatever way the books came into his house,²⁶
there is an inconceivable power in them: it makes prema arise in the heart.

122. If [prema] arises in a few people, who takes note?
But if it arises in a king, all people come to know.
123. Whoever grasps the sense of my writing
will later grasp its further purpose as well.
124. Meanwhile Acharya Thakura laments in his grief.
After some days the messenger reached the town of Mathura.
125. The next day, bringing the letter to the Gosani,
he handed over the letter and gave the whole message by word of mouth.
126. Sri Jiva read the letter and understood the matter;
he told everything to Lokanatha Gosani.
127. Sri Bhatta Gosani heard it all
and, weeping, says: "I have felt great pain."
128. Raghunatha and the Kaviraja, both hearing this,
weeping and weeping, fall and roll on the ground.
129. The Kaviraja says: "Prabhu, I do not understand the reason:
what was done, what has happened?" — and he ponders within.
130. In his old age the Kaviraja could no longer walk;
with that grief he departed from the world.
131. Sitting on the bank of the Kunda, he lamented without cease —
and then the Gosani, overwhelmed, rushed forward and fell headlong.²⁷
132. "How much pain of separation can my life bear?
All the sorrow of my heart — who knows it?
133. Sri Krishna Chaitanya, Nityananda, full of mercy!
Besides you, whom else do I have?
134. Advaita and all the devotees, compassionate of heart,
be kind, all of you, to Krishnadasa.
135. Prabhu Rupa, Sanatana, Bhatta Raghunatha,
where have you gone, Prabhus? Make me your own.
136. Lokanatha, Gopala Bhatta, Sri Jiva Gosani,
show me mercy — I have no one.
137. Sri Dasa Gosani, grant me your feet,
on which I meditated — to attain them in life and in death."
138. Hand on his breast, Raghunatha Dasa weeps:
"A thorn has lodged in my heart, my hope is unfulfilled.
139. If you go, where else, who else is there for me?"
Sobbing aloud, he weeps, holding his hand.
140. "You are going and leaving me an orphan;
how shall I pass my days, bearing this sorrow?"
141. Fixing his eyes on Raghunatha's face,
Krishnadasa took his feet and pressed them to his own breast:
142. "O, grant me a place to dwell on the bank of Radha-kunda;
Raghunatha, dear to Radha, be merciful."

143. Contemplating [his place] in that company where he abides,²⁸
with his eyes closed he gave up his life.
144. Raghunatha Dasa weeps, hand on his breast:
"You have gone, leaving me an orphan."
145. How much shall I write of the grief — it cannot be told;
crying "Kaviraja, Kaviraja!" all sing his virtues.
146. All the accounts of the perfected cannot be told;
only one who has received mercy understands them in his heart.
147. At this time such an event took place;
if I do not write of it, my Prabhu's command is broken.
148. If an offence lies in that, words will not come to my lips;
now I write it — hear the account.
149. The two mahashayas wander about searching,
and in that grief they take Shyamananda with them.
150. One night the two take counsel;
Acharya Thakura says: "This is what I think:
151. go to your own country, to your home;
my heart grieves with this grief."²⁹
152. If this is not accomplished, no other aim is needed:
all will be in vain, the command will not be kept.
153. Who took them — this I must certainly find out;
then I will do whatever can be done.
154. I will write a letter and send it to you by a messenger;
obtaining a royal letter, I will act accordingly.
155. Or else, having found out, I will come to you
and go [there], taking horsemen with me.
156. Follow this plan — then all will be accomplished;
rise in the morning and set out."
157. In the morning the two took leave of each other;
how much grief rose in their hearts then!
158. Taking his hand, [Srinivasa] says: "Listen, Narottama:
if I do not find the books, I shall give up my life."
159. Weeping and weeping, the two parted;
the one goes home, the other wanders about.
160. Thakura Mahashaya is sorrowful within and without;
he does not know where he goes or where he stays.
161. Shyamananda goes with him, saying nothing;
he walks along the road, fallen into a stupor of grief.
162. After some days [Narottama] came to his own country;
he goes home without clothes, in the guise of a beggar.
163. Hearing of it, his mother and father came running;
gazing at his face, they fall and roll on the ground.

164. All his kin, as many as there were, came;
coming, they bowed down and clasped his feet.
165. Gazing at his form, they fall down weeping;
they cry "Hari!" and, rejoicing, look at his face.
166. Subjects, ministers and friends came from all over the country;
one by one they speak to him, weeping.
167. Falling at his feet, they weep — and grief and sorrow passed;
brahmanas, good people and many others came.
168. He entered his house, absorbed in joy;
all the people sit, surrounding his dwelling.
169. All rejoiced and sank into prema;
crying "Ha, ha, Radha-Krishna!" he rolls on the ground.
170. His mother, father and kin count themselves fortunate:
once again they have seen the form of prema with their eyes.
171. Three times [a day] he bathes, practises remembrance and kirtana;
seeing this, all the people rejoice at heart.
172. Day and night vanish, who knows where, in his absorption in prema;
he chants Hari-nama until the day is done.
173. "The good fortune of many births has dawned for me,"
someone says; "give me some command."
174. Someone says: "Taking shelter at such feet,
worshipping Radha and Krishna, one's sins are destroyed."
175. He says nothing to anyone, remains silent,
at times remembering Sanatana and Rupa:
176. "Prabhu Lokanatha, where are you, lord of my life?
When shall I see those feet before my eyes?"
177. In seclusion, in a grove, he sits alone,
softly, softly uttering Hari-nama.
178. Such sadhana he performs that people do not know of it;
at the sight of him everyone's grief and sorrow depart.
179. If he shows his kindness — what virtues one gains,
what prema one attains, within and without!
180. Later I will write of all these wondrous things:
in what persons, here and there, he made prema manifest.
181. Now I write of him — hear the account
of why Shyamananda had come with him.
182. "I wish to ask something — hear me, mahashaya:
whatever the command of Gosvami-ji may be..."
183. Saying "Good, good," he began to tell him
the subjects [set out] in the Ganoddasha-dipika:
184. the way of remembering one's own siddha body —
at what time what service, with whom one abides;

185. he speaks of the abode of rati, of the determination of the yutha,³⁰
of constant service in the form of special longing;³¹
186. dress according to colour and rasa — all this according to the shastras;
to abide together with the sakhi who is the form of the guru;³²
187. the bank of the Kunda, Varshana, Nandishvara,
dwelling at Javata — [there] one will be intent on service.
188. He explained the limbs of sadhana through the Rasamrita-sindhu —
raga and vaidhi, as they are practised.
189. "Join all sadhana with raga" —
this is Sri Rupa's firm word.
190. And what he said on the subject of sadhya and sadhana —
by this such limbs of sadhana are protected.
191. Being careful towards Krishna's devotees and towards Krishna,
[the practitioner] is protected from offences against the name and offences in service.
192. He told in detail all that must be considered,
and what, accordingly, the conduct of a Vaishnava is.
193. Keeping him for ten days, he gave him leave,
giving him money and two men as help on the road.
194. At parting, the grief of separation of both:
"Now fate has shattered all our happiness."
195. Shyamananda went off to his own country;
who can describe what happened then?
196. Then Thakura Mahashaya came outside
and, weeping and weeping, sent him off.
197. [Shyamananda] bowed down, the Thakura embraced him;
and Shyamananda, stricken with grief, departed.
198. Going a little way, he bows down;
going a little further, he looks back at his face.
199. He walks along the road with his hand on his head;
the sorrow that came then — to whom shall I tell it?
200. Meanwhile Acharya Thakura, wandering in the forest,
one day came into Vishnupura.
201. He knows no one, and no one knows him;
some take him for a Baul.³³
202. One outer cloth and one kaupina,
[and] a cloth a cubit and a half long with which he wipes his body —
203. and that an old, very dirty garment;
he wanders about the town like a wayfaring guest.³⁴
204. Sometimes he begs alms and eats, sometimes he drinks only water;
where he stays, where he goes — he has neither place nor shelter.
205. Having wandered about the town for ten days,
one day he was sitting under a tree.

206. At that moment a young brahmana came by;
seeing him, [Srinivasa] asked: "What is your name?"
207. He said: "My name is Krishnavallabha;
I live in the king's realm, under the king's patronage."
208. Seeing the beauty of the brahmana's son, he was pleased,
and humbly asked him something:
209. "Tell me, who is the king here, what is his name?
Is he righteous, or of another disposition?"
210. He says: "The king is very wicked;
he lives by banditry all the time, and there is no restraining him.
211. He kills, he cuts, he loots wealth — neither ghat nor road is passable;
his name is Vira Hambira, the king of the Malla throne.³⁵
212. So time went by, some days passed —
[and now] he has robbed two carts and brought back the wealth.
213. A brahmana pandita comes and recites the Purana;
the king sits and listens, the brahmana sits and recites.
214. We sit and listen for two or four dandas;
he has no faith in it — a villain, a pashandi."
215. [Srinivasa] asked him: "Have you studied anything?"
"I have done grammar," I replied.³⁶
216. "Do you understand the drift of a shloka, what its meaning is?"
"If I study literature and poetics, then I will understand."
217. Then he talked with him about the sutras of sandhi;
the two discuss with great delight.
218. The brahmana's son was filled with great affection:
"Thakura, you yourself could teach me.
219. I am looking for much learning — someone to teach me."
"I can teach you," [Srinivasa] agreed.
220. "There is a village called Deuli, not very far:
across the river, half a krosha away, is my home.
221. If you will be kind to me, come to my house."
Hearing his words, [Srinivasa] rejoiced at heart
222. and, saying "Let us go," [went] with a joyful mind;
the brahmana walks with him, gazing at his feet.
223. The two went to the house; seating him in the house,
the youth ran and brought water to wash his feet.
224. Coming and sitting down, he asks him to cook,
and joyfully brought everything needed for cooking.
225. The Thakura says: "Son, listen to me:
I cook only boiled and roasted vegetables.
226. I am a brahmana from foreign parts, unknown here;
if you permit, I will fetch the water myself and eat."

227. The youth brought him a pot for water;
he rose, went and fetched the water himself.
228. Having cooked, they all ate;
he teaches the youth well and is happy at heart.
229. Having studied with him, [the youth] goes to the royal court
and in the evening comes back home.
230. After sitting a while, the Thakura asks him:
"What did you read, what did you hear? Tell me."
231. He says: "The pandita read the Bhagavata;
having listened, the king rose and went into his inner rooms."
232. "Hearing this, I wish to get in there;
all my hope rests on you.
233. Take me to the royal court:
I have a wish to see him."
234. The young brahmana says: "As you command;
I will certainly go with you."
235. The next day, having eaten, the two go
and came to where the king was present.
236. The pandita reads the Bhagavata, the king listens;
[the pandita] explains the meaning, knowing neither good nor bad.
237. That day he came back to his lodging, the brahmana's house;
the next day he goes again to the king.
238. [The pandita] reads the Rasa-panchadhyayi³⁷ without knowing its true meaning;
the Thakura, sitting, says:
239. "This book, the Bhagavata, was spoken by Vyasa;
the commentary of Sridhara Svami is accepted.
240. What is this you are expounding? It cannot be understood;
such a meaning does not come from a pandita's insight."
241. The pandita does not listen; the king glances at him;
that day they came home, and the next day they go again.
242. That day the pandita expounds the Panchadhyayi;
"The meaning has come out wrong," [Srinivasa] says.
243. The king, having heard the pandita's exposition, sits [and says]:
"Why do you not set forth the explanation from the Svami's commentary?"
244. The pandita grew angry; the king says to him:
"What meaning are you giving? Why does the brahmana find fault with it?"
245. The pandita says: "Maharaja, the meaning of the Bhagavata —
who besides me has the ability to expound it?
246. Where has this petty brahmana come from, who puts in his word?
What can you expound? Come, sit here."
247. The king says: "Expound it, young brahmana."
The Thakura, rising, says: "As you command."

248. Sitting down, he expounds, and joyfully reads it again;
a single shloka he explains in so many ways.
249. Hearing it, the king was filled with supreme delight;
and the brahmana [pandita] was greatly afraid before the king.
250. Tears flow from [Srinivasa's] eyes in many streams;
the pandita was struck dumb and stands like a heron.
251. Again he reads the shloka in blissful absorption
and explains the meaning in endless detail.
252. Hearing it, the king's heart rejoices;
all the people in the assembly are amazed.
253. "Where has this brahmana come from, where is his home?"
Evening came, and then he tied the cord round the book.
254. The pandita falls at his feet with joy in his heart:
"You are most discerning, be merciful to me.
255. You are a pandita who appreciates merit, you have grasped the [book's] intent;
by letting me hear its meaning, Thakura, you have bought me."
256. Bowing down, the king asks:
"Where have you come from, mahashaya?"
257. "My name is Srinivasa, I live in this country;
I had a wish to see the royal assembly.
258. As is the maharaja, so is the pandita of his assembly;
hearing and seeing it, my heart rejoices."
259. Through his royal servants [the king] gave him lodging on his own premises;
rising from his seat himself, he showed him great honour.
260. With an escort he went to his lodging,
washed his feet and sat down on his seat.
261. The pandita came [to him] with the brahmana's son;
after they had stayed a little while, [Srinivasa] sent them off.
262. At night the king came to the Thakura
and begs him to eat.
263. The Thakura says: "Maharaja, I eat once a day;
wherever I stay, I do not eat a second time."
264. The king says: "If only you would permit yourself to eat a little..."
"If it is something uncooked — a little; nothing else."³⁸
265. The king had milk, sugar and ukhra³⁹ brought,
and the Thakura, sitting at night, took a light refreshment.
266. The king went to his palace to sleep;
and the Thakura's heart was filled with great joy.
267. The Thakura sits on his seat with a joyful heart,
remembering and calling out: "Rupa, Sanatana!
268. My Prabhu, Sri Gopala Bhatta, lord of my life!
To whom has Srinivasa told such sorrow?

269. Sri Jiva Gosani was merciful to me —
on that hope alone have I kept my life."
270. The night was drawing to its end, a little remained;
again and again he recites hymns in blissful absorption.
271. The king cannot sleep; he listens with his own ears
and, listening, reflects within himself:
272. "Can there be a man on earth with so many virtues?
In seeing him, my good fortune has dawned."
273. In the morning he rose and went to the Thakura;
standing, he looks at him and bows down.
274. The Thakura says: "Sit down; it is good that you have come;
it is great good fortune to see a king in the morning."
275. The king says: "What you say is true;
[but] at the sight of you so many sins are destroyed."
276. The Thakura says: "I bathe every morning."
Saying "As you command," the king made the arrangements.
277. He had two new water-pots brought,
and, taking them himself, set them before the Thakura:
278. "Water-pots — accept these, Thakura, you have no [others];
your descent is for the saving of the fallen."
279. The Prabhu says: "I am a brahmana under your protection;
whatever you wish, that is my wish too."
280. Summoning the pandita, the king asked him:
"What did you hear yesterday? Tell me."
281. "Maharaja, looking at him I am amazed;
I have not the power to understand that meaning."
282. Taking him along, the king went to the Thakura
and gave him over to his service.
283. They brought and gave [the Thakura] everything needed for his worship;
he does everything with his own hands.
284. Having eaten, the king went and sat down
and had the book brought and placed before the Thakura.
285. The Thakura sat down and untied the book's cord;
as he began, there was no end to his joy.
286. Hearing the exposition from his holy mouth, even a stone would melt;
the king weeps, clutching his head with his hand.
287. The king gazes at his form and looks at his face:
"Who would show mercy to such a sinner?"
288. At night I did not sleep, [listening to] this mahashaya;
I shall go and take shelter at the feet of Srinivasa."
289. "Srinivasa — who is he? Who knows him?
He has only just come, and he is living in your palace."⁴⁰

290. "Such a thing I have never heard nor seen even in a dream;
whom shall I tell? Who will explain the reason?"
291. Such an exposition the Thakura gives as no one has ever heard;
[the king] beats his breast and looks at his face.
292. [The Thakura] read no further, and tied the cord round the book;
the king sits weeping, crying, "Alas, alas!"
293. The pandita heard all the meanings he gave:
"Such I have never heard in all the world."
294. Gazing at the beauty of his form, the pandita weeps;
tears flow from his eyes, he falls to the ground.
295. Seeing this, the Thakura is silent and says nothing;
the king, rising and bowing down, addresses him:
296. "Tell me, Thakura, where have you come from,
what is your name? Tell me, so that my mind may be at rest."
297. "My name is Srinivasa; I have come from Vrindavana
to make known the hundreds of thousands [of lines] of Sri Rupa's books.
298. I was to take them to Gauda and spread them there;
but someone has stolen my life.
299. For their sake I wander through so many lands and forests;
sleep and food are gone, nothing else is in my mind.
300. My Prabhu — his name is Sri Gopala Bhatta;
Sri Jiva Gosani gave me the command.
301. The Gosani [gave us] ten armed men and two cart-drivers;
on the road there was no trouble, good or bad.
302. I, Shyamananda and Thakura Mahashaya
came all that way without fear.
303. At night we came to Gopalpur and stopped;
many armed men came in the night and robbed us.
304. There was a cart full of books and other goods;
they looted it and went off to their own country — such is my plight."
305. The king says: "Great is the good fortune of my lineage
that you have come to this country.
306. Had there been no theft, you would not have come;
who else is there so merciful to the fallen?
307. The cart with all that is in it is intact, just as it was;
impose on me whatever punishment is fitting, mahashaya.
308. You have come for my deliverance;
there is no other sinner as great as I."
309. Saying this, the king weeps and falls to the ground;
his golden body rolls in the dust.⁴¹
310. Tears stream from both his eyes, he dances as if mad.
"Where have you kept the books? Let us go and see."

311. Saying "As you command," the king goes along with him;
the Thakura came and saw that everything was there.
312. The Thakura prostrates himself, joyful at heart;
the king, falling at his feet, weeps bitterly.
313. The Thakura goes to his lodging to bathe:
"Bring sandalwood, tulasi and garlands here —
314. I will worship the books, for every blessing."
The king himself brought everything and set it before him.
315. Sitting on a new seat, he performs the worship;
the Thakura says: "King, go and bathe."
316. Going into his inner rooms, the king bathed;
coming to the Thakura, he bowed down.
317. The Thakura says: "Sit down, hear Krishna's name."
Saying "As you command," the king lent his ear.
318. Seating the king close by, he utters the Hari-nama —
he bestowed on him the great mantra, the Hari-nama.
319. He had him touch the books and put a garland round his neck;⁴²
then the Thakura rose and went to his lodging.
320. The king went, called the pandita,
and appointed him to [the Thakura's] service.
321. The pandita came, prostrated himself and bowed down;
the Thakura asks him: "What is your name?"
322. "I am a worthless wretch," he answered the Thakura;
and he himself said that his teacher had named him Vyasa.
323. "Since then everyone calls me Vyasa.
If you permit, I give myself over to your feet."
324. The Thakura let him hear Krishna's name in his ear;
together with the name he gave him the names of Radha and Krishna.
325. He weeps at his feet and bows down;
and at once [the Thakura] drank water from his hand.
326. The Prabhu with his own hand put tilaka on his forehead,
made him his own and placed his feet on his head.
327. The king came and saw it all for himself;
tears flow from his eyes, he is overwhelmed with joy.
328. "The third day of the dark fortnight of Ashadha —
there will be no better day after that," he judged in particular.
329. On that day the king was to receive initiation into the mantra;
in the Thakura's presence [the king] prepared a great many things.
330. [The Thakura] gave him the mantra of Radha and Krishna, all the meditations and the rest,
and instructed him according to Sri Rupa's books.
331. [The king] with joy in his heart offered many gifts
and addresses [the Thakura's] lotus feet:

332. "If you permit, Prabhu, live in this town;
to see you and hear you — that is my desire."
333. The Thakura accepted his words
and stayed with the king with a joyful heart.
334. The Thakura's disciple Vyasa, the learned pandita —
[the Thakura] teaches him the Bhagavata with all his heart.
335. He teaches him Sri Rupa's books in blissful absorption;
such a spiritual turn in the king is proclaimed in every land.
336. To the king he gave the name Haricharana Dasa;
with body, mind and speech [the king] hopes in the Thakura's feet.
337. One day the king sits before the Prabhu;
and then the Thakura began to speak:
338. "This Vyasa is your brother through his connection with me;
he has freely studied many books and shastras.
339. You are the maharaja, and he is the pandita of your assembly;
he will recite everything, and you, listen with joy.
340. Listen and practise bhajana — this is the great thing.
From today I give him the name Sri Vyasa Acharya."
341. Saying "As you command," the king bowed down.
"As is the king, so is the pandita of your assembly!"⁴³
342. Listen, king, to a word from my heart;
you and I know it — no one else has a part in it.
343. Quickly find two men, with money for the road,
to go to the country of Garerhat, to the village of Kheturi.
344. Thakura Narottama is grieving at heart;
the men will take a letter and deliver it to him in his inner rooms."
345. Saying "As you command," the king summoned the men;
that very moment the Thakura wrote the good news.
346. The men took the letter and set off quickly;
with joined palms the king says [to the Thakura]:
347. "Who is Narottama, Prabhu, where is his home?
When I hear of him, there is joy in my heart."
348. The Thakura says: "King, you will be very glad [to hear]:
he and I were together in Vrindavana.
349. The two of us came with the books;
thieves took the books, and we wandered about in grief.
350. With great sorrow I sent him home;
grieved by this sorrow, he is anxious at heart.
351. There is a country called Garerhat; its zamindar
is Krishnananda Raya, a man of the greatest generosity.
352. His son from an early age was indifferent to home;
Mahaprabhu gave him the name Narottama Dasa."⁴⁴

353. Then he went to Vrindavana
and took shelter at Lokanatha's feet.
354. How much shall I tell of his way of bhajana?
We lived in one place, and our minds were one.
355. In Vrindavana he received the name Thakura Mahashaya;
the power of Krishna-bhajana is in him beyond doubt."
356. Hearing this, the king rejoiced at heart:
"How might I see such a mahashaya?"
357. The Thakura says: "To see him is had only with great difficulty;⁴⁵
what devotee of Krishna is his equal?
358. One life in two bodies — his and mine:
he knows my mind, and I know his."
359. The two men who had gone with the letter
after some days arrived at the village of Kheturi.
360. The Thakura [Narottama] was sitting absorbed in the sweetness of Krishna's lilas;
and at that moment the two men came in.
361. He asked: "Where have you come here from?"
"Our home is Vishnupura; [here is] a letter from Acharya Thakura."
362. Rising, he took the letter in his own hand
and asked them whether the Thakura was well.
363. The men say: "He is well; he has written of it in the letter."
Opening the envelope, he read the letter himself.
364. As he read, his heart filled with joy;
tears from his eyes fall upon his breast.
365. "Call the musicians, let the music play!"
In every land, in every village the news was proclaimed.
366. After five days, writing a letter,
he sent the men off with it, giving them money for the road.
367. He wrote: "Your well-being is a great joy to me;
only when I see you will my sorrow go."
368. The men brought that letter and gave it to the Thakura [Srinivasa];
he asks them: "Tell me all the good news."
369. The king is sitting [there]; the men began to tell:
"The moment he heard, musical instruments resounded, splitting the sky.
370. Tears flowed from his eyes, running down his chin;
how should we know why he weeps?"
371. The Thakura reads the letter and lets the king hear it all;
so many streams flow from his eyes — he cries, "Alas, alas!
372. When will such a day come that I see Narottama
and tell him everything — joy and sorrow, just as it was?"
373. A young brahmana named Krishnavallabha,
in whose house the Thakura first lodged,

374. later took shelter at his feet;
he is endowed with many virtues and many wondrous aspirations.
375. The king receives wondrous intimations at every moment;
saying "Thakura!" he finds joy day by day.
376. One day the Thakura said to the king:
"I will go to Rarh: I have need to.
377. My mother is living in Yajigrama all alone;
I wish to see her two feet."
378. The king gave many provisions — two or four heavy loads —
and gave many people as escort: it became a great company.
379. Vyasa Acharya goes along, and Krishnavallabha;
thus they all set off for Rarh.
380. They took many books with them — Puranas, the Bhagavata;
the king was in great sorrow, pining constantly.
381. After four days they came to Yajigrama;
going to his mother's feet, he bowed down.
382. His mother does not ask [who he is]; her heart trembles with fear;⁴⁶
the Thakura said: "My name is Srinivasa."
383. The life that had left her returned to her body;⁴⁷
holding his hand, his mother weeps and gazes at his face.
384. His mother questioned him, and he told everything at her feet:
"By your mercy I have come back from Vrindavana."
385. The Thakura's glory spread through the world;
for some days he stays there with his mother.
386. There a wondrous story took place.
There is a large village, Teliya Budhari,⁴⁸
387. on the bank of the Padmavati; across the river is the country of Garerhat;
[the village is] some distance off on this bank; I write in detail.
388. [There lived a man] born in the Ambashtha community,⁴⁹ respected by the people;
of his virtues I shall write much, both before and after.
389. Two brothers from one womb, most excellent:
the great scholar Ramachandra and the younger, Govinda.
390. All people know that Ramachandra is childless;⁵⁰
he heard with his own ears of all the Thakura's virtues.
391. A longing to see [the Thakura] seized him, and he sets off for Vishnupura;
he walks along the road — and abundant joy rises in his heart.
392. With one servant he came to Katwa,
and heard of the most excellent worship of Gauranga [there].⁵¹
393. Going there, he beholds [Gauranga], absorbed in bliss;
all those sitting there are praising the Thakura's virtues.
394. Some say: "He has come from Vrindavana";
some say: "His home is in Vishnupura."

395. Some say: "Of such power we have never heard";
some say: "A great pandita, a young brahmana."
396. Some say: "I saw him just now in Yajigrama:
he is of the same complexion as Gauranga."
397. Some say: "His mother has been here;
coming from Vrindavana, he has seen her."
398. Ramachandra listens attentively to these words
and at once set out, gladdened.
399. Going out of the village, he asked the people:
"Tell me, brothers, how far is Yajigrama?"
400. The people say: "One krosha from here."
Hearing this, he goes quickly along the road to see him.
401. Arriving in Yajigrama, he asks the people;
[they tell him:] "Acharya Thakura has gone off to another village."
402. Someone says: "His mother's house is here;
he himself went to Khanda this morning."
403. He took lodging; not seeing [the Thakura], he was anxious;
the next day the Thakura came back to the village.
404. When the Thakura went to Srikhanda,
whatever happened there, and how it came about —
405. that I will tell later, as the narrative goes;
arriving there, he was, as it were, plunged into waves of separation.
406. Some write merely on hearsay, writing anything at all;
but I write this account by my own Prabhu's command.
407. Whoever finds fault with it will answer for it himself —
gain or loss, with reason or without.⁵²
408. Even an evil-minded person caught in maya who hears this but once
will turn his mind to Krishna — this I say for certain.
409. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the thirteenth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "The words I see in the Prabhu's mouth I write down." The Prabhu is apparently the author's guru; cf. 12, 204, 393.
2. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "when I have good news, I shall stay alive".
3. The speaker is Gopala Bhatta Gosvami, Srinivasa's guru (cf. ch. 12, 420–428).
4. Here Lokanatha Gosvami, Narottama's guru.
5. Literally "with the chaukis (toll-posts) of Jajpur". The 1913 edition seems to have "Jaipur" (?); translated according to the 1999 edition.
6. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "The two bear the form of Sri Gauranga's prema; that Rupa and Sanatana are [his] shakti I know for certain."
7. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "Those books and that dharma are your revelation; it falls to you two to preach them."
8. Literally "carrying out the command, shall I part with my life?" The sense is unclear: Jiva seems to say that he sends them off although it is like death to him.

9. Apparently Murari is the future Rasikananda, son of Achyuta (Achyutananda) of Rohini, Shyamananda's chief disciple; Jiva's words sound like a prophecy.
10. The Gaura-ganoddesha-dipika / Radha-krishna-ganoddesha-dipika, works on the associates of Krishna and Chaitanya (the latter by Rupa Gosvami).
11. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "You will hold discourses according to the Ganoddesha; explain to him what must and must not be done in sadhana."
12. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "Ten armed men go along with the chest."
13. So the 1999 edition ("tarikṭā"); in the 1913 edition the name is illegible. The place is unidentified.
14. Jharikhanda, the forested region between Bihar and Orissa through which Mahaprabhu once passed.
15. Tamruk (Tamralipta) lies far to the south of the route to Vishnupura; perhaps a corruption.
16. Cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Madhya 17: in the forests of Jharikhanda Mahaprabhu made tigers, deer and peacocks sing and dance.
17. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he is utterly unstable". Vira Hambira is the same king who will later become Srinivasa's disciple.
18. "gaṇitā", diviners or astrologers who supposedly determined by calculation where wealth was being carried (cf. 76, 113).
19. Phansiyaras, robbers who strangled their victims with a noose. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "hundreds of hansiyaras and mansuriyas" (?).
20. A bhaumik, a landholder or local chief.
21. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "from how far did you come to overtake it?"
22. The first line is corrupt in the 1913 edition ("tomāra sahita rājā āsi tāra sane") and missing in the 1999 edition.
23. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he wanders from door to door".
24. Mahaprabhu's conversation with Ramananda Raya, recorded by Krishnadasa Kaviraja (Chaitanya-charitamrita, Madhya 8). The first line is found only in the 1913 edition.
25. Cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Madhya 8.248.
26. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "In whatever way the books of the lilas came into the royal house".
27. Literally "the Gosani, surging up, fell, taking a leap"; perhaps it means that he threw himself into the Kunda. The reading is conjectural.
28. That is, on his place in Radha's company (gana) in the spiritual world.
29. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "grieving with this grief, I shall [search] without cease".
30. The yutha, a group of sakhis under one of Radha's principal friends.
31. "lālasā", ardent longing, one of the stages of raganuga-sadhana.
32. In raganuga-sadhana the guru is conceived in the form of a sakhi (manjari) under whom the disciple serves.
33. The Bauls, Bengali wandering ascetic singers.
34. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "with a very emaciated body he wanders about the town".
35. "mallapāṭa", the throne of the kings of the Malla dynasty (Mallabhum), whose capital was Vishnupura.
36. So in both editions: here the account is given in Krishnavallabha's own words (cf. ch. 12, note 28).
37. The Rasa-panchadhyayi, the five chapters of the Bhagavata Purana (10.29–33) on the rasa-lila.
38. "ātapa", literally "sun-dried" (uncooked rice and the like); the line is apparently Srinivasa's reply.
39. Ukhra, a sweet made of puffed rice with molasses.
40. The speaker is not marked; apparently the bewilderment of those present, or of the pandita, addressed to the king.
41. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "Rising, the Prabhu placed his feet on his head."
42. So the 1913 edition ("grantha-sparśa"); the 1999 edition has "brahma-sparśa" (?).
43. An echo of Srinivasa's words in 258 — now without irony. The speaker is not marked.
44. According to tradition, Narottama's name had been foreseen by Mahaprabhu himself (cf. the earlier chapters).
45. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "only by great fortune does one get to see him".
46. That is, his mother apparently does not recognize her emaciated ascetic son.
47. So the 1999 edition ("the prana that had gone came back inside"); a variant given in the 1913 edition: "my life had all but left me — I tell you".

48. Teliya Budhari, the home village of Ramachandra Kaviraja and Govinda Kaviraja on the bank of the Padma (Padmavati).
49. The Ambashthas, the physicians' caste (vaidya).
50. So the 1999 edition (aputraka); the 1913 edition has "apūrva", "extraordinary".
51. Katwa, where Mahaprabhu took sannyasa; an image of Gauranga is worshipped there.
52. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "good or bad, with reason or without".
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Vilasa 14. Ramachandra and Govinda Kaviraja; the Festival at Kheturi

Srinivasa at Srikhanda with Raghunandana; Ramachandra Kaviraja comes to Yajigrama, debates with Vyasa and Srinivasa and receives initiation; the healing and initiation of Govinda Kaviraja at Budhari, a song of Govindadasa; Narottama comes to Budhari; the installation of Gauranga and Vallavikanta and the great festival at Kheturi; Narottama's ecstasy; Ramachandra stays with Narottama; the conversion of the brahmins Harirama and Ramakrishna

1. Glory, glory to Sri Krishna Chaitanya, the abode of virtues!
Glory, glory to Nityananda, the life of the Vaishnavas!
2. Glory, glory to Advaita Acharya and [all] the beloved [of the Lord],
whose appearance is for the deliverance of living beings!
3. Glory, glory to Sri Jahnava, the life of Virachandra,
whose manifestation of prema is renowned in story!
4. Now I shall write how [Srinivasa] went to Khanda;
I saw what love arose in whom.
5. Leaving his conveyance at the gate of the Thakura's house,
he came on foot, bringing his people with him.
6. Arriving, he bowed down to Gauranga, [keeping him] on his right;¹
at that very time Raghunandana came.
7. "Come, come, my brother, my life, Srinivasa!
No one could in any way comprehend your appearance."
8. They embraced in love and sat down on their seats,
and Raghunandana, smiling, asks:
9. "I have heard everything through people coming and going;
it gives me joy to hear it — so tell me:
10. how you went to Vrindavana and what happened there,
how, on arriving, you took shelter at the Prabhu's feet,
11. how you studied the books with Sri Jiva,
how the command came: "Take the books and go.""
12. How he had brought the books by the road through Jharikhanda,
he told him all of it, [and] how many people were with him;
13. in what way the theft took place, how it happened,
in what way [the books] were recovered in the king's house.
14. I sit listening at Raghunandana's left;
[he told] how he showed mercy to the king, settling in his town,²
15. how for that reason the king came to love him greatly,
and how he had recently come to see his mother.
16. "For our happiness, stay at Yajigrama;
it is a great joy to me that you live in this place."
17. [Raghunandana] spoke of all the household matters:
how he spends his time and on what he relies.

18. Sri Sarakara Thakura has passed from sight;³
in that grief Raghunandana is always weeping:
19. "This is my great sorrow, this is what lies on my heart:
the Thakura has gone away, leaving his servant behind."
20. A spear stayed lodged in the depths of his heart and did not come out;
with arms around each other's necks the two began to weep.
21. Weeping, Srinivasa says: "By his mercy
the command came from his holy lips that I should go to Vrindavana;
22. and when I came back he was no longer to be seen — such is my lot!"
In separation the hearts of both were overwhelmed.
23. That night he stayed there, absorbed in the joy of talk of Krishna;
he stayed there that day, and [another] night came to its end.⁴
24. In the morning they sat in the Sri Nata-mandira;⁵
Sri Raghunandana says: "What shall I say to you?"
25. You are my life, brother! The whole burden is yours;
to spend my time with you — that is my wish."
26. At the parting they embraced each other;
holding hands, the two set out.
27. One day they spent sitting together, the two of them;
[each] thinks within himself that he is still in that place.⁶
28. Raghunandana's form enchants the worlds,
and Srinivasa's form beside it is most beautiful;
29. seeing them, my heart was enchanted;
he knows whose eyes the form of the two has caught.
30. In this way he came to his own home
and, arriving, bowed down at his mother's feet.
31. At this time Ramachandra was in that village;
hearing it from people's lips, he goes quickly to see [the Thakura].
32. He goes along the road, thinking in his mind:
"When I see him, how shall I address him?"
33. Arriving, he saw the Thakura sitting on his seat;
he is alone, no one else is in that place.
34. Arriving, he stands before him and says nothing;
he bows down and gazes at his form with his eyes.
35. Placing five coins before him, he bowed down again;
[the Thakura] blessed him and asked him once:
36. "Where have you come from?
What is your name, in what village do you live?"
37. "My name is Ramachandra, I was born in the Ambashtha clan;
my one desire is to see the Prabhu's feet.
38. My birthplace is the village of Teliya Budhari."
There was a seat, and [the Thakura] tells him to sit on it.

39. He showed him great honour: "Bathe and eat,"
and gave him a lodging so that he could stay nearby.⁷
40. The next day the Thakura says to him:
"How far from Kheturi is your home?"
41. He says: "Four kroshas, I humbly submit."
"How many days ago did you leave home and come?"
42. He says: "Four days I was on the road;
on the fifth day I beheld [your] feet."
43. "Tell me, have you studied any learning?"
"I have looked into many books and shastras."
44. Little by little he questioned him, and he told everything;
hearing him, the Thakura [noted] the skill of his speech.
45. Seeing this he is pleased, but does not enter into discussion [of learning];
one day the Thakura bids the Acharya:⁸
46. "Hold a discussion with Ramachandra,
and I shall sit and listen to the waves of your debate."
47. Vyasa and Ramachandra, coming together,
joyfully discuss learning.
48. First the talk was of grammar and the commentaries,
then the two raised the waves of poetics.
49. Long goes the debate, the Thakura sits and listens;
after that a quarrel broke out between the two.
50. Seeing that Ramachandra is very strong in logic,
the Thakura himself says to Vyasacharya...⁹
51. The Acharya was struck dumb; the Thakura sits and listens;
calling Ramachandra, he himself embraced him.
52. In Ramachandra's heart there is pride:
"Who [can] debate with me in the science of logic?"
53. The Thakura himself understood his thought;
stopping the Acharya, the Thakura says something [himself].
54. A great debate takes place with the Thakura;
hearing that debate, the Acharya was spellbound.
55. The Thakura recognized Ramachandra's ability
and says wondrous words to Vyasa:
56. "What sort of pandita he is cannot be grasped;
some divine learning — Sarasvati herself is his helper.
57. Such practice, such reasoning, such quickness of mind —
I have not seen anyone who has the like."
58. The next day the Thakura holds a debate with Ramachandra;
all that they say, Vyasa listens to.
59. Their debate went on until evening;
neither was aware of the outer world, so that not even the bath was taken.

60. Then the Thakura broke off and rose:
"Go, Ramachandra, take your bath now."
61. From that day he shows him great regard;
one who prizes virtues knows virtues — others do not know them.
62. From that day the Thakura loves him dearly;
seeing the radiance of his body, the Thakura is greatly pleased.
63. He seats him close by and himself eats [with him];
he knew that Ramachandra was a jewel among men.
64. On another day the Thakura sat with him:
"Today you yourself debate with me."
65. "As you command," he said, with pride in his heart:
"To converse with the Thakura — that is [a joy] for me."¹⁰
66. For a whole prahara there was much debate;
[then] the Thakura again says to Ramachandra:
67. "Bearing a human body, [a person] acquires a host of qualities;
whatever goal he pursues, that arises in his mind.
68. Ignorance and knowledge — whatever he cultivates within —
good qualities and bad all show themselves in the body.
69. High and low — all that is achieved through the body,
what ought and ought not to be done, all that has a cause and has none —
70. he who, bearing a body, expounds the eternal and the non-eternal
is blessed on earth; but who knows this?
71. The shastra by studying which the disease of worldly existence is destroyed —
giving up everything, that is what I long for.
72. Otherwise all is in vain — the shastras forbid it;
there are such words in all the shastras, there is no doubt of it.
73. Merely studying logic and nyaya, time wastes away;
what gain is there at the end, what do the shastras say [of it]?
74. First of all one should ponder the Bhagavata in one's heart;
listen, my son, to what came of that.
75. The Bhagavata sets forth the doctrine in every detail;
in it are the words that are the command of Ishvara."
76. "That is what I shall do, that is what I shall study, from which there is gain;¹¹
why do other work while time wastes away?
77. For this, Thakura, I have come to you:
become the lord of Ramachandra — let all people know it.
78. For all my reading and hearing, the doubt in my mind has not gone;
what then am I to do — that is what rises in my mind, mahashaya.
79. My life has gone in vain eating lye and oil-cake;¹²
I gave no thought to my own good and ill.
80. In Gauda and in Vrindavana your name is Acharya Srinivasa;
accept Ramachandra, make him your own servant.

81. Having become a servant, I hope for these two feet;
only then will the fulfilment of my desire bear fruit.
82. Seeing that I am low and fallen, do not spurn me with contempt:
for my deliverance there are your feet.
83. If there is delay, time wastes away;
place on my head, Prabhu, your feet that grant fearlessness."
84. Weeping, he gazes at his face and rolls on the ground:
"Be my Prabhu birth after birth, without fail!
85. I am sold to your feet — take me [as one bought] for a price;
bear in the world the name 'the lord of Ramachandra.'"
86. Then the Thakura showed mercy and placed his hand on his head:
"Birth after birth you are mine" — by this he showed mercy.
87. Bowing down, he drank the charanamrita;¹³
mercifully [the Thakura] let him hear the Hari-nama.
88. The next day he mercifully gave him the Radha-Krishna mantra
and told him all about the goal, the means and the substance;
89. he gave him the method of remembrance¹⁴ — the essence of the limbs of sadhana;
he taught him everything and explained its meaning.
90. By [the Thakura's] mercy he reads the books of Sri Rupa;
he reads the plays and the Sandarbhas, the commentaries and lexicons.
91. Reading, at the merest hint he works out the construction;
how many objections he raises, how much he expounds!
92. Such meanings does the Thakura reveal that [Ramachandra] weeps profusely;
embracing him, [the Thakura] calls him the companion of his life.
93. Within one month he sat and read through everything;
the Thakura listens while he swiftly sets out the meaning.
94. There is no doubt of this, listen, mahashaya:
when the heart is free of offence, everything reveals itself.
95. One whose person has such learning and such virtues —
what man would call him ordinary?
96. The mood of a former perfection stays attached to him;
at the mere taking of shelter all virtues come and arise.¹⁵
97. Such are all the doings of the mahantas of old;
he alone understands it who has reached the summit of bhajana.
98. Born in the house of a worldly man, [one] seeks another shelter;
shelter with a great soul confers all virtues.
99. So too a devotee of Krishna: one on whom is Krishna's mercy,
in his heart there arises [the longing for] shelter at the feet [of the guru].¹⁶
100. There are words about this in earlier books, and so I write;
if I did not write, the mind would not be attentive.
101. Such is Ramachandra Kaviraja, full of virtues:
as the guru, so the disciple — the foremost.

102. One day the Thakura is sitting in his own house,
Ramachandra [standing] humbly some way off.
103. At that time a letter came from home,
written by Govinda Kaviraja in his own hand:
104. "My health is poor — come quickly;
you can stay two or four days and go back again."
105. Ramachandra paid no heed and stays with the Prabhu:
he has no leisure, he is ever expounding the books.
106. He has no [thought of] food, he is always in sadhana and bhajana;
what he does, where he is, he does not know.
107. For another month and a half he stays with the Prabhu;
the time passes ceaselessly in waves of prema.
108. Meanwhile Govinda's illness grew worse;
he writes to his elder brother: "Help me!
109. My body will not last, the disease is strong —
unless the Prabhu mercifully grants me [his] feet."
110. He wrote to him to bring the Thakura:
"I will tell him everything when I see him before my eyes.
111. My hands and feet have swollen, grahani has set in."¹⁷
He set out everything — what more should he write?
112. Having read the letter, the Kaviraja did not tell the Prabhu;
when the Thakura asked, he spoke of something else.
113. Now I shall write of the cause of Govinda's illness:
from the grahani disease he is about to give up his life.
114. He was a worshipper of the Devi, the shakti Mahamaya;¹⁸
by that service, that remembrance, he longs for her mercy.
115. He had perfected the mantra, and his deity had appeared to him in person;
at the hour of death he falls prostrate at her feet:
116. "In life and in death, Mother, I know no one else;
give me a boat to cross [the ocean of] existence.
117. So the time has passed — at the end give me liberation;
who but you will show mercy to Govinda?"
118. In anguish he cries out: "Save me!
In life and in death I have no one but you."
119. Many people stand around, but there was no vision;
a divine voice spoke — he hears it with his own ears:
120. "For deliverance remember Govinda, my son!
You have seen it in the shastras, you have read it, great ascetic.
121. Remember Govinda, the giver of deliverance:
He is the maker of heaven, earth and the netherworld.
122. Can I bestow the abode of liberation?
I myself meditate on His reddish feet.

123. Can I tell His glory?
Maidservants like me He has in such numbers!
124. The complete Brahman, the Eternal, the son of Nanda —
hundreds of Durgas like me pray to Him.
125. Aja, Bhava¹⁹ and the rest find no limit to Him;
hundreds of thousands such serve His feet.
126. The Radha-Krishna mantra is the essence of all mantras;
take shelter at those lotus feet.
127. The giver of liberation to all is the supreme Govinda;
he who does not worship such a Lord is dull-witted and wicked.
128. Remember Govinda, the giver of deliverance:
He is the maker of heaven, earth and the netherworld."
129. Hearing her words, his life [all but] fled:
"Where has Ramachandra gone? I do not see him with my eyes!"
130. Sending someone who was nearby,
telling of the illness, they called and brought [his guru].
131. The guru came; he was given a fine seat;
seating him close by, [Govinda] makes his plea to him:
132. "Have mercy, master, let me be delivered!
My ears are stopped, I no longer see with my eyes."
133. The guru says: "Remember Govinda in your heart;
who else is there in the world to deliver you?"
134. He lies with head bowed, saying nothing to anyone;
[then] he called his own son Divyasimha:²⁰
135. "I have spent my life sunk in false delights;
who is there who could deliver me?"
136. To where Acharya Thakura is staying
quickly send five men, writing a petition.
137. Write: my life is in danger, [I beg] the Prabhu to come;
I live only to see him once with my eyes."
138. He wrote a letter to Ramachandra Kaviraja
and sent five men with money for expenses.
139. They travelled night and day; [with] two dandas of daylight [left],²¹
within four dandas they reached Yajigrama.
140. They asked people: "Where is the Thakura's house?"
"Where there is a big tree to the right of the gate."
141. Coming up and seeing the tree at the gate, they halted;²²
a man went and gave word to the Kaviraja.
142. Hearing, he came out and sees five men;
all of them, handing over the letter, are grieving.
143. Having read the letter, he went to the Thakura;
reading the letter to him, he makes a plea:

144. "Accept my family, Prabhu;
what should I, a worthless wretch, say in your presence?"
145. At his words compassion arose in the Prabhu;
that very day, after eating, he set out.
146. The next day they travelled on but could not arrive;
stopping at one place, they spent that night there.
147. In the morning they all set out; a man went ahead
and, arriving, said: "The Thakura is coming."
148. Govinda Kaviraja Thakura lies [ill];
calling his son, he speaks in great joy;
149. in the middle of the village he had banana trees planted
and mango leaves hung all around.²³
150. Divyasimha went out to meet the Prabhu and brought him;
he bowed down, and then [the Prabhu] asked about him.
151. The Prabhu asked, and Ramachandra submits:
"This is Govinda's son — he is your servant."
152. He leads the Prabhu to his own house;
with joy in their hearts they cry out "Hari, Hari!"
153. Arriving, they stopped at the Kaviraja's dwelling;
the Prabhu says: "What shall I do, Ramachandra Dasa?"
154. Ramachandra says: "What shall I say, Prabhu?
Do as you wish — you are independent."
155. The Prabhu says: "Your people are my servants,"
and with these words he entered Govinda's house.
156. Kettledrums sound, auspicious cries of ulu-ulu ring out;
he went to the room where Govinda lies.
157. Two or four men, holding him up, sat him up;
there are no words in his mouth; with his eyes he gazes at [the Prabhu's] face.
158. He joins his palms before his face, but words will not come;
the Thakura placed his feet on his head.
159. In the house they seated the Prabhu on a fine seat,
anointed him with sandal and other oils, and bathed him.
160. He ate some fried dishes and sweets;
Ramachandra took the charanamrita and the remnants from his lips²⁴
161. and had Govinda eat them;
the moment he ate, all his illness went away.
162. Many provisions came, the cooking was set going;
when the cooking was done, [the Thakura] bathed and cleansed himself.
163. The offering is ready and was offered to Krishna;
the Thakura himself sat down and ate.
164. Govinda ate the remnants from the Prabhu's plate;
such joy arose in him that he no longer thinks of his illness.

165. That night passed, and morning came;
smiling, the Prabhu says to Ramachandra:
166. "Bathe Govinda — you have my consent;
I shall bathe and then perform his initiation."²⁵
167. Ramachandra bathed him with his own hands,
took off his wet cloth and dressed him in a dry one.
168. Having bathed, the Prabhu goes to show him mercy;
who can tell what joy there was?
169. Ramachandra sits holding him on his own lap;
the Prabhu gave the "Hare Krishna" mantra into his ear.
170. All around, the Vaishnavas sing the sankirtana of the Name;
at this time he has him hear the Krishna mantra.
171. Then he mercifully gave the mantra of Radhika-jiu
and explained the meditations on the two separately.
172. [Govinda] bowed down, [the Prabhu] placed his feet on his head;
he felt within himself strength like a lion's.
173. He offered many gifts — gold, so many cloths,
bronze vessels, brass vessels and more, by the hundreds.
174. By the Prabhu's mercy the disorder of the belly²⁶ went away;
he walks about slowly, and his joy is boundless.
175. What I write is just as it was, not otherwise;
let no one feel grief on hearing this account.
176. Hear the Kaviraja's former words;
what will come later, all shall see:²⁷
177. *"The god is not lustful, the goddess is not wanton —
it is only the manifestation of prema.
A servant at the feet of Gauri and Shankara,
says Govindadasa."^{28*}
178. By the Prabhu's mercy all [his] virtues came to light;
he who savours [his verses] knows their essence.
179. From that day Govinda was well
and comes to the Prabhu in perfect contentment.
180. He tells the Prabhu of his former ways;
weeping and weeping, Govinda Dasa begs for shelter:
181. "The lamp of our family is my brother Ramachandra;
through my tie with him the Prabhu has shown me mercy.
182. How much shall I tell of my own faults?
I am an untouchable wretch, wicked by nature."
183. Weeping and weeping, he falls at Ramachandra's feet:
"One whose Prabhu is Srinivasa — what has he to fear?"²⁹
184. Now I make my plea — hear, best of masters;
I am afraid to speak it — my heart trembles."

185. Pada:³⁰

*Worship, O mind, the son of Sri Nanda,
His lotus feet that grant fearlessness.
A rare human birth, the company of sadhus —
cross over this ocean of existence.*

*Cold and heat, wind and rain,
days and nights without sleep —
in vain I served the miserly and the wicked
for a fleeting crumb of happiness.*

*This wealth, this youth, sons and household —
is there anything in them to trust?
Like water on a lotus leaf life trembles —
worship the feet of Hari always.*

*Hearing, chanting, remembering, praising,
serving the feet, the service of a servant,
worship, [friendship,] self-surrender —
this is the longing of Govindadasa.*

186. "Now I know: [your] feet are my life;
give the command to describe the lila of Krishna.

187. In my mind is the desire to describe the lila of Gauranga,
the describing of which is the highest of all perfections."

188. The Prabhu says: "Listen to what I say about what you ask:
describe the lila of Krishna with joy in your heart.

189. Vasudeva Ghosha Mahashaya, dear to Gaura,³¹
has described the very essence of all his virtues;

190. you describe freely the lila of Radha and Krishna" —
immersed in bliss, he gave this command.

191. "Read, Govinda Dasa, the Rasamrita-sindhu,
by touching a single drop of which one gains blessing everywhere;

192. read the Ujjvala,³² where the lila of Radha and Krishna is:
in it is given the whole range of lilas with every rasa."

193. At an auspicious moment he began to read the book;
[the Thakura] explained the whole division of its subject-matter.

194. As soon as he heard the outline of the book,
he grasped it inwardly and brought out many meanings:

195. "I have understood it all — rasa, doctrine, bhava and states;
fulfil this plea of mine.

196. I have understood in my mind that this is your mercy;
without Gaura's mercy the lila has no end to be found."

197. Smiling, the Prabhu said "Good, good!" and embraced him;
everyone knew that he had realized Gauranga.

198. From the time he took shelter at the Prabhu's feet
until his death — what was there not!
199. How much sadhana he performed, how much he described!
In this way he spent thirty-six years.³³
200. From that day he began composing [songs on] the lilas;
he described the lila of Gaura and the lila of Krishna.
201. Thus I have told of the virtues of Govinda Kaviraja,
by hearing of which unbelief and ignorance are dispelled.
202. I am quite blind, I have not a particle [of understanding];
whatever I write, [I write] by the command of mercy.
203. I write by the mercy of these two Prabhus —
by the command of Sri Jahnava and Prabhu Virachandra.
204. Listen, listen, hearers, with minds intent;
holding a straw between my teeth,³⁴ I make this plea.
205. I write the account of the virtues of Sri Thakura Mahashaya:³⁵
first of all he arranged the service of Gauranga.
206. Hearing that the Thakura had come to the Kaviraja's house,
he was plunged at heart into an ocean of bliss.
207. He prepared a new temple and all the provisions;
the wish [to hold] a great festival grew strong.
208. All his kin, the landholders of the village,
all who carried out his orders — all were enchanted.
209. Whatever provisions were wanted, all were ready:
was it [the power of] the guru's command, or the strength of sadhana?
210. With two or four men he came to Budhari;
people who went ahead told the Thakura.
211. The Thakura rejoiced at his coming —
it seemed in his mind as if he had found life.
212. Telling of his virtues, he instructed everyone
to show him honour as before and to greet him [fittingly].
213. To Ramachandra Kaviraja and Vyasa Acharya [he says]:
"Quickly, quickly go out to meet him and bring him."
214. "As you command," said the two and went out;
not far off, quite near, they saw him.
215. Meeting him, the two prostrate themselves;
[he asks:] "Who are you, mahashayas? Tell me."
216. Greeting them, he raised them and embraced them,
and came to where the Thakura is sitting.
217. On the left Ramachandra, on the right Vyasa;
his body blossomed with delight.
218. Seeing him from afar, the Thakura rises to meet him:
"Come, come! [My] life has come and entered my heart!"

219. He prostrated himself, [the Thakura] embraced him;
sitting on their seats, they converse.
220. He asked after his welfare; [he replied:] "By your command [all is] well;
sorrow has gone because you have come."³⁶
221. Govinda Kaviraja came and fell at his feet;
[Narottama] raised him and embraced him tightly.
222. "Who is this?" he asked, delighted;
the Thakura says: "This is Ramachandra's younger brother, Govinda."
223. There was great happiness at meeting after many days;
Ramachandra invited [them] to bathe.
224. Having bathed and drunk water, rapt in talk of Krishna,
they sit on their seats and tell everything in order:
225. Acharya Thakura and Thakura Mahashaya —
what their happiness was in Vrindavana, how they came to know each other,
226. how on the road the books were stolen;
everyone sits and listens to the sweetness of their words.
227. Rapt in talk of Krishna they all spend day and night;
so the night passed, and morning came.
228. [Narottama] raised the matter: "Come to Kheturi;
if you do not come yourself, all the joy will be spoiled.
229. I know of the command the Prabhu has given:
there is a command to inform you."³⁷
230. [Srinivasa:] "You yourself do what you are engaged in;
within five days I shall come without fail."
231. [Narottama:] "I cannot stay; I shall go quickly to my village;
only let there be no offence — my life remains [with you].
232. Let Vyasacharya come with me — that is my request:
he will surely arrange everything."
233. Saying this, he took his leave and went to his own village;
Vyasa had the command: "Go and arrange everything."
234. He arrived in the village; his heart was full of bustle;
sending men out, he brings goods from the farthest places.
235. Bringing stone, he has an image made manifest in the house:
he summons craftsmen to make Gauranga manifest.
236. Many new dwellings were built;
at that time Acharya Thakura set out.
237. The Prabhu with Ramachandra came quite near;
Thakura Mahashaya and Vyasa go to bring him in.
238. Thakura [Mahashaya] brought him into the house in great joy;
he alone knows [that joy] — who [else] can know?
239. How much shall I write of how he was attended?
His house, his goods — what more shall I say?

240. The manifestation of the image of Gaura-raya and, with it, one more:
the Acharya took the vow [for the installation], and many with him.
241. Men were sent with letters inviting
the mahanta-adhikaris in every village.
242. Everywhere invitations were sent to the Vaishnavas:
all were to come on the day of Phalguna Purnima.³⁸
243. Thousands upon thousands of people make the arrangements;
thus all are staying with joy in their hearts.
244. The Thakura is absorbed in remembrance, sankirtana goes on;
at that time the splendid manifestation of Gaura-raya took place.
245. In joy all cry out "Hari, Hari!"
What shall I say of that matchless beauty of form?
246. Then came the manifestation of Vallavikanta;³⁹
in everyone's heart there was supreme delight.
247. Little by little everyone came and gathered;
in this way the mahanta-adhikaris arrived.
248. How many lodgings were set up within the village,
how many near the house, how many in other villages!
249. How many new houses, how many awnings —
he knows who saw it; who else knows?
250. How many provisions — curd, flattened rice, bananas,
sweets, ukhra⁴⁰ and sugar!
251. Whatever goods were needed were all brought in;⁴¹
they brought a hundred jars filled with panchamrita.⁴²
252. The Acharya himself performs the bathing abhisheka;
he carried out many rites according to the rules.
253. All the mahantas together touched the bodies [of the images]
and put sandal paste and tulasi garlands on them.
254. Kirtanas began everywhere, in many places;
who is dancing, singing, rolling on the ground, where!
255. When the kirtana began before Gauranga,
no one stayed seated — everyone went there.
256. Householders and ascetics, the low and those of low conduct —
all came, no one stayed at home.
257. Devidasa Mahashaya began the kirtana;
what singing and playing it was could not be grasped.
258. Gaurangavallabha Raya plays the mridanga;
hearing it, one loses all composure, [as if] life itself goes out.
259. Gaura-raya is seated, Vallavikanta on his left;
as the sight [of them], so the singing.
260. How many mahanta-adhikaris — hundreds!
The Vaishnavas listen to the singing, maddened.

261. What sweet singing, what playing!
Hearing it with his ears, who could keep his composure?
262. With Acharya Prabhu are Sri Vyasacharya
and Ramachandra Kaviraja: they cannot contain themselves.
263. The Thakura dances and sings in such a way
that, unable to contain himself, he falls to the ground, weeping and weeping.
264. Tears flow from his eyes in hundreds of streams;
he cannot dance, he has become like a Baul.
265. No one can hold back [in him] the transformations of bhava;
seeing them, the hearts of others are amazed.
266. Thakura Mahashaya, seeing and hearing, is almost stunned:
what kind of prema this is cannot be understood.
267. As he listens, he laughs aloud in happiness;
tears pour from his eyes — how unchecked!
268. His composure left him, and he dances in the kirtana;
seeing his trembling and leaping, ten men hold him.
269. How his lips tremble — his teeth seem about to fall out!
Pressing his hand to his breast, again and again he falls to the earth.
270. His whole body [bristles] as if with the thorns of the shimul;⁴³
now his body swells, now it grows thin.
271. Such is the beauty of his body — the transformations of bhava;
the moon of bhava rose in everyone's body.
272. Krishnananda Majumdar, with all his people,
falls to the ground, weeping and weeping:
273. "When will there again be such a state, such happiness?"
Rolling on the ground, he weeps, clasping everyone's feet.
274. Again and again he looks into Narottama's face
and, weeping and weeping, falls down, clasping his feet:
275. "You have sanctified [me], my son, together with all my people;
who, born on this earth, has seen such happiness?"
276. My house has known happiness equal to Vrindavana;
all my people are Narottama's servants."
277. Such prema did Narottama reveal in [his] land;
he dances and speaks⁴⁴ in the delight of prema.
278. When everyone began to give [gifts] to the kirtana,
he brings out from the house and gives whatever comes to hand.
279. Thakura Mahashaya notices none of this;
what shall I say of [his] prema, how describe it?
280. To say nothing of dancing — as soon as he stood up,
everyone thought to himself: his form is just like Gauranga's.
281. Whomever he turns and looks at in the rapture of prema,
all those people fall weeping at his feet.

282. Acharya Thakura, weeping, embraced him
and, holding him by both arms, speaks very softly:
283. "Embodiment of prema, you have filled the world with prema;
seeing it, the heart rejoices and the eyes reach their fulfilment.
284. Who has the power to hold such a festival?
All Gaura's mercy is upon you with all your clan.
285. Gauranga has consented to be under your sway;
in life and in death no one has any [other] claim."⁴⁵
286. The kirtana ended; they ate and drank;
all go off, each to his own lodging.
287. The next day, as the festival was drawing to a close,
all go together to the lodging place.
288. A disciple of Thakura Mahashaya named Gokula Dasa
sang in the kirtana that day.
289. Beginning, he strikes up the sound of the mridanga;
all hear with their ears [a sound] surpassing nectar.
290. Everyone went to the circle of the kirtana;
leaving off the alapa,⁴⁶ all sing as they go.
291. First he sings — how sweetly! — of Gauranga's virtues;
as they listen, it touches everyone to the heart.
292. Thakura Mahashaya listens, overcome with bliss;
after that, at the end, he sings of Krishna's lila.
293. *Pada* (in the fitting raga):
*Filling the cupped hands of her eyes,
holding that face before her,
her soul longs to drink.
What has touched her eyes, that she drinks ever;
again and again Radha remembers.*
294. As soon as Thakura Mahashaya heard this with his ears,
he embraced him and fell to the ground.
295. "Gokula, what you have made me hear — you have robbed me of all peace!"
Saying this, [he weeps:] streams flow down his face and breast.
296. Holding the kirtaniya by the hand, he whirls and wanders about;
"What have you made me hear!" he says, crying "Alas, alas!"
297. "What perfection — Krishna's form, Radha's love!
She drinks with her eyes — such is her mind."
298. In the state of that bhava his heart and mind were immersed;
however much prema there can be, it doubles.
299. So, in dancing, the second prahara passed;
by the force of bhava his body was racked.
300. Hundreds and hundreds of times he flings himself on the ground;
who has the strength to hold him back?

301. What transformation of the heart it is cannot be grasped;
crying "Radha, Radha!"⁴⁷ he keeps rushing off.
302. How his body trembles, where he falls!
Seeing it, [it seems] life will not stay in the body.
303. Mother, father, kinsfolk — all weep;
they hold Narottama — his life is in turmoil.
304. Seeing this, Acharya Thakura grew anxious at heart;
sitting down, he held him, and he trembles all over.
305. He recites a verse from the Ujjvala — Sri Rupa's description —
by which [even] Sri Radha-ramana regains composure.
306. Again and again he recites the verse, but [Narottama] does not come to himself;
he devised a remedy: "Take him to another place."
307. They took him into the house and laid him down; after a prahara
he came to himself; the bhava changed, and he sat up as before.
308. That night all sat rapt in talk of Krishna;
someone raises objections, [another answers] in detail.
309. The next day they send off each according to his station;
how much shall I tell of the leave-takings?
310. Each was sent off as was fitting;
well pleased, they all go home together.
311. Thakura Mahashaya cannot bear the separation;
Acharya Thakura understood his mind.
312. He seats Thakura Mahashaya beside him on one seat;
[there is] conversation on Krishna's lila and Krishna's virtues.
313. [With them are] Ramachandra Kaviraja and Sri Vyasa Acharya;
Acharya Thakura speaks, and all listen calmly.
314. "Come, Ramachandra, speak — let us hear it from your lips;
let the night pass thus in joy and happiness."
315. For four dandas Ramachandra tells of Krishna's lila;
everyone's heart rejoices, all forget themselves.
316. Ramachandra says: "Listen, Thakura Mahashaya:
there is a wish to hear [it] from your own lips."
317. "As you command," said the Thakura and began to speak;
as soon as they hear, no one's heart keeps its composure.
318. His mind is overflowing with bhava, he is unaware of the outer world;
how many explanations he gives, how many ornaments of speech in them!
319. After this Acharya Thakura joyfully
began to tell of the state of Krishna's purva-raga:⁴⁸
320. what came before and after, how [the feeling] arises and subsides;
he tells it again and expounds it again and again at length.
321. All float in bliss, finding no footing;
that night they spent with their bodies blossoming.

322. For a month the Thakura stayed, rapt in talk of Krishna;
the happiness of even one day — what shall I say of it?
323. One day a certain plan arose in his mind;
the Thakura says to Thakura Mahashaya:
324. "There have come to be three homes — I shall speak of it in detail —
in three lands: Kheturi, Yajigrama and Vishnupura.
325. There is no way out — so much rises in my mind!
I wish to tell how everything everywhere can be arranged:
326. [here] the shelter of Gauranga, [there] my mother's love,
[and] in Vishnupura the king's new bhakti.
327. I shall go [there] once and come back again;
[but my] life is near you: this is the essence of the truth."
328. Hearing this, Thakura [Mahashaya] was deeply distressed;
"Cruel is the Creator!" he cries, weeping profusely.
329. Two or four days passed — he does not say a word;
[Srinivasa says:] "Ramachandra, you stay, hold fast to virtue.
330. The two of you — in talk of Krishna's lila, in discussion of bhajana;
stay with him, do not break the command."
331. [Ramachandra:] "Whatever command the Prabhu has given, that prevails;
I stay together [with him] — that is my own wish too."
332. Hearing these words, Thakura Mahashaya [resolved] in his heart:
"Whether we stay or go anywhere, we two will be together."
333. That day, at the parting, Thakura [Mahashaya] was in great grief;
he gave [Srinivasa] for the road two mohurs and two lengths of cloth,
334. to Vyasacharya five coins and a length of cloth,
and to the bearers and porters he gave [gifts] all together.
335. All the sorrow the two felt then —
that sorrow only he knows whose soul is burning.
336. My hard heart could not see it:
so much love, so much prema — and my heart did not melt.
337. Such a sight, such a festival, such transformations of bhava —
[and I,] hearing and writing, [remain] with a heart like wood.
338. Ramachandra Kaviraja and Thakura Mahashaya
sleep, eat and bathe in one place.
339. Ceaselessly they tell of Krishna's lila and ponder it;
they do not notice day or night — such is their love.
340. One day, to bathe in the Padmavati,
they go hand in hand with joy in their hearts.
341. In the water they splash at each other in mock battle and speak of Krishna;
at that time there came two brahmins, worthy men:
342. Harirama and Ramakrishna, sober panditas;
seeing the two, they composed their minds.

343. The two went into the water to bathe;
one raises an objection, [the other] sets out the doctrine in detail.
344. The two brahmins, learned in the shastras, say nothing;
all the doctrine the others set forth they understand in substance.
345. As they listened, the brahmins took up the discussion;
all that they said [the others] refuted with the arguments of the doctrine.
346. The brahmins speak words contrary to the doctrine;
all that they say [the others] refute.
347. [The brahmins] lay weight on varnashrama, as written in the smriti;
[the others] refute it all with the words of the Bhagavata Purana.
348. The two brahmins grow angry, [the others] show forbearance;
again they recite verses — and [the brahmins] stand there struck dumb.
349. Having bathed, the two mahashayas came home;
the two brahmins came with them and went inside.
350. The Mahashaya, who takes the essence, full of virtue,
offered them seats, and the brahmins sat down.
351. Giving them lodging, he had them fed excellent food;
in the evening they saw the Thakura's arati.⁴⁹
352. Seeing the extraordinary image, they rejoiced;
at night the two brahmins sit and reason.
353. All that they argue, [the others] do not accept,
and refute it with the evidence of those same shastras.
354. At night, lying down to sleep, the brahmins talk;
one says: "These two are great souls.
355. Ah, brother, what we studied under our teacher
does not agree with the doctrine of these two.
356. They serve Krishna and serve the sadhus without cease;
these two great men are fine scholars of all the shastras.
357. They have established that the highest is the worship of Ishvara;
he who does not worship is a traitor to his master, and Yama punishes him.
358. I see that in the worship of Sri Krishna no shudra-hood remains;
until now I had never heard that the shastras say so."
359. Saying this, the two fell into deep sleep;
towards the end of the night a great person came and says:
360. "O son of a brahmin, you do not understand in your heart:
by worshipping [Krishna] brahminhood is preserved — so the shastras say.
361. Those two are the gurus of your guru,⁵⁰
and you are proud, taking yourself for a brahmin.
362. In the morning go and take shelter at their feet;
come what may — [your] worldly existence is at an end.⁵¹
363. Worship Govinda, O living being — how long [will you wait]?
All you have done till now is mere clutter."

364. These two brahmins had worshipped Krishna before;
all will see the proof of it later.
365. Because of a slight [lack of] bhava, the two were born in brahmin families;
birth after birth guru and disciple — that is the essence of it.⁵²
366. Rising at dawn, the two prostrated themselves
and, with joined palms, plead at length:
367. "I was born in the world as a [mere] brahmin;⁵³
now be merciful and make me a true brahmin.
368. Where else can these two sinners go?
Owning us as your own, touch our heads with your feet.
369. Life will not stay in my body — have pity on me;
I am scorched by the threefold misery — give me the shade of your feet.
370. Your feet are spotless and grant fearlessness;
have mercy on the lowly — who else is there in the world?
371. Till now the time has passed in such false delights;
there was no longing for the two feet of Sri Krishna.
372. Be merciful, Prabhu, give such instruction
as to attain these two feet — that alone remains."
373. Each in his mind seized hold of these two feet;
Ramakrishna [says]: "My lord, my Prabhu is Narottama."
374. Harirama says: "My Prabhu is Ramachandra;
birth after birth I serve this pair of feet."
375. Saying this, they weep, calling the name of their own Prabhu;
crying "Shame, shame [on us]!" they roll on the ground.
376. In the heart of each of the two compassion arose for his own;
each of the two gave his own the Hari-nama mantra in his ear.
377. Receiving it, they bow down, tears pouring from their eyes:
"Have mercy: what are we two to do?"
378. The two say: "Always take the name of Krishna,
so that eating or sleeping there is nothing else in your minds."
379. Coming out into the courtyard, they cry "Gauranga, Gauranga!"
and, gazing at the form [of the image], both fall to the ground.
380. When there is kirtana, they show the transformations of bhava;
how meekly and lowly they speak of themselves!
381. Some days passed thus, as they themselves wished;
[then] the two mahashayas gave the two a command.
382. The brahmins bathed and came; [the mahashayas] give their command:
seating the two, they show them mercy:
383. with delight in their hearts they give the Radha-Krishna mantra;
hearing the mantra, their bodies blossom in the rapture of bhava.
384. Going outside, they make the eight-limbed prostration;
[the gurus] touched their heads with their feet and laid a hand on their backs.

385. They were told all the limbs of sadhana;
with joy in their hearts they read the method of remembrance.
386. Rapt in bliss, they practise sadhana for the goal;
when [some time] had passed, at last they were given a command:
387. "Read the books of bhakti, my sons, sitting together;
in practising sadhana you will find great happiness in your minds.
388. Whatever gives rise to firm attachment to sadhana —
read all those books: in them you will find the essence."
389. The two read the books composed by Sri Rupa;
reading and reading, they became very learned.
390. How much shall I write of the way these two worshipped?
Such mercy, such power [of theirs] we shall see later.
391. There is perfected worship accumulated before;
for that reason [such a one] is born in a high family.
392. A pandita has a fear of offences;
once he takes shelter, [worship] at once reveals itself.
393. Later he grows mighty — great power and strength;
all the Vaishnavas sing his virtues.
394. I shall write one more word — listen:
what is written in the book is made manifest everywhere.
395. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fourteenth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. That is, before the image of Gauranga served at Srikhanda by Narahari Sarakara and Raghunandana; "on the right" apparently means circumambulating it clockwise (pradakshina).
2. "basāiyā grāme", literally "settling in the village"; the reading is conjectural.
3. That is, he had died — Narahari Sarakara Thakura, Raghunandana's uncle and guru.
4. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he spoke of Krishna in every detail".
5. The Nata-mandira, the hall for singing and dancing in front of a temple.
6. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "sitting in that place, [each] contemplates [the other] in his mind". The line is obscure.
7. This couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; it is preceded by an illegible line of OCR.
8. Vyasa Acharya, Srinivasa's disciple from Vishnupura (cf. ch. 13).
9. The Thakura's words are not given in either edition; apparently he invites Vyasa to continue the debate.
10. The second line is obscure ("thākurerā saha vākya mora anubhava"); the translation is conjectural.
11. The speaker is not marked; apparently Ramachandra's reply begins here (cf. 77).
12. "kṣāra khali", lye and oil-cake, i.e. worthless food; an image of empty learning.
13. Charanamrita, the water that has washed the feet of the guru or of a deity.
14. "smaraṇa-paddhati", apparently a guide to remembering the lilas through the hours of the day (cf. Rupa Gosvami's Smarana-mangala).
15. Couplets 95–96 are found only in the 1913 edition.
16. In the 1913 edition the first word is corrupt ("...pa-padāśraya"); perhaps "rūpa-padāśraya", "shelter at Rupa's feet". Couplets 97–99 are found only in the 1913 edition.
17. Grahani, a severe digestive disorder (chronic diarrhoea, sprue).
18. According to tradition, Govinda Kaviraja was a Shakta, a worshipper of the Goddess, before his conversion.

19. Aja is Brahma, Bhava is Shiva.
 20. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "calling his son, he says: 'Go and bring a seat'" (?).
 21. That is, towards evening; the reckoning of time in this couplet is unclear.
 22. A variant given in both editions: "quickly reaching the tree at the gate, they halted".
 23. Banana trees and mango leaves are signs of a festive welcome.
 24. "adhara-śeṣa", remnants of food touched by the lips (of Srinivasa).
 25. "saṁskāra", here apparently initiation (diksha); cf. 169–171.
 26. "udara-bhaṅga", a disorder of the belly, i.e. the same grahani disease.
 27. That is, the verses Govinda Dasa composed before his conversion (when he was a Shakta), as against his later Vaishnava songs.
 28. The closing lines (bhanita) of a song on Shiva and Gauri; Govindadasa is the poetic name of Govinda Kaviraja.
 29. Literally "who has an obligation (dāya)"; the reading is conjectural.
 30. A widely known song of Govindadasa ("Bhajahū re mana..."). The last stanza lists the nine forms of bhakti (Bhagavata Purana 7.5.23); "friendship" (sakhya) is here replaced by "sakhis", i.e. service to Radha's friends; the text is partly corrupt in both editions.
 31. Vasudeva Ghosha, an associate of Mahaprabhu and author of songs on Gauranga.
 32. Rupa Gosvami's Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu and Ujjvala-nilamani.
 33. A variant given in both editions: "thirty-two years".
 34. Holding a straw between the teeth is a sign of utmost humility.
 35. Here begins the account of Narottama (Thakura Mahashaya) at Kheturi.
 36. The assignment of speakers in this couplet is conjectural.
 37. The sense is unclear; the "Prabhu" here is perhaps Lokanatha Gosvami. The speeches in 228–232 are assigned by sense: the speakers are not marked.
 38. The full moon of the month of Phalguna (February–March), the day of Mahaprabhu's appearance.
 39. Vallavikanta (literally "Beloved of the cowherd women") is Krishna; images of Gauranga and of several forms of Krishna were installed at Kheturi.
 40. Ukhra, a sweet made of puffed rice with molasses.
 41. A variant given in both editions: "as if the time [of the festival at] Kshetra (Puri) had come".
 42. Panchamrita, a mixture of milk, curd, ghee, honey and sugar for bathing a deity.
 43. The shimul, the silk-cotton tree with a thorny trunk; an image of hair standing on end (pulaka).
 44. Apparently Krishnananda; the subject is unclear.
 45. The sense of the second line is unclear; the translation is conjectural.
 46. The alapa, the unmetred introduction to a song, without words.
 47. Before this both editions have "sādhā sādḥā" (?), perhaps a corruption of "rādhā".
 48. Purva-raga, love before the first meeting, the initial stage of love in the doctrine of rasa.
 49. That is, the evening worship of the Gauranga installed by Narottama at Kheturi.
 50. The sense of the line is apparently that Narottama and Ramachandra stand above these brahmins' own teachers.
 51. The second line is obscure: "je hau se hau mora saṁsāra gela kṣaya" (the 1999 edition has "saṁśaya", "doubt"); perhaps these are already the brahmin's words.
 52. The couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; the sense is conjectural.
 53. So the 1913 edition ("a-brāhmaṇa"), "as a non-brahmin", i.e. a brahmin by birth only; the 1999 edition has "as a brahmin".
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Vilasa 15. Jahnava at Kheturi and in Vrindavana

Jahnava Devi, on her way to Vrindavana, stays four days at Kheturi and praises Narottama; her arrival in Vrindavana and meeting with Jiva, Gopala Bhatta and Lokanatha; the author on the command to write this book

1. Glory, glory to Sri Chaitanya, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaitachandra, glory to the devotees of Gaura!
2. The name of Sri Jahnava Gosani is prema embodied;
has not Chaitanya's own shakti descended [to earth]?
3. On her way to Vrindavana she came by that road;
hearing of it, Thakura Mahashaya rejoiced at heart.
4. He and Ramachandra Kaviraja, the two of them, went out to meet her
and, coming to the Thakurani, beheld her.
5. Humbly they praise her and bow down many times:
"Be merciful and come — this is your own home."
6. The Thakura arrived [with her] at his own dwelling;
he serves her, joyful, smiling gently.
7. The Thakurani herself, seeing Gaura-raya,
seeing his captivating beauty, wept.
8. For four days the Thakurani stayed in that place;
every day ever new service was shown to her.
9. How many provisions came — curd, flattened rice,
sugar, bananas, sweets — hundreds and hundreds of pots!
10. Food of how many kinds came,
ghee, milk, pickles, and kasundi¹ too.
11. Four days of the joy of feasting, kirtana and a great festival;
he who saw it knows what he experienced.
12. One night the Thakurani is sitting;
calling "Narottama!" she seated him close by.
13. With her own hand she strokes his body;
what fragrance from his body — as of kunkuma and the like!
14. "O Narottama, hear what is in my heart:
hearing of all your virtues, I longed [for you] with all my heart.
15. In you I see all the conduct of a Vaishnava;
boundless is the joy of mind, ears and eyes.
16. It seems to me that you are prema embodied;
truly your name is Thakura Mahashaya.
17. Seeing the way you serve the Vaishnavas,
my heart was gladdened.
18. Will there be such a day again, shall I see [you] once more?
Your bhava has filled my heart with wonder.

19. What I heard from the lips of the Vaishnavas,
that I have seen with my eyes — and more, in every way.
20. In Vrindavana you were named Thakura Mahashaya;
the Vaishnavas tell of all your ways of worship.
21. The Vaishnavas came and told me;
that I would come here I told no one.
22. I [alone] knew it, I said it — and Ramachandra knows;²
so too my eyes have found joy.
23. Such service, such bhajana, such Vaishnava conduct —
who [else] in the three worlds acts so? I see no other.
24. All these virtues of yours I shall sing everywhere —
in Vrindavana, in the land of Gauda, wherever I go.
25. Gauranga is merciful — who can understand it?
What power, what mercy he puts into the heart!
26. I have come to know that your body is a manifestation of prema;
coming and calling me, you have given me so much joy.³
27. I have heard that Ramachandra is your inseparable companion;
in life and in death your companionship will not be broken.
28. As I heard, so I have seen — boundless joy!
As is the guru, the Acharya, so is his disciple.
29. Have mercy on me — may I reach Vrindavana happily
and see everything everywhere with a joyful heart.
30. All those dear to Gauranga who are in Vrindavana
I long to see once with my eyes.
31. Such a blessed day will come — I shall see Vrindavana,
I shall see Radha-kunda and Govardhana with my own eyes."
32. The next day there was talk of the Thakurani's departure;
how many waves of separation arose then!
33. They gave her a hundred coins for the expenses of the road;
for half a krosha they walk with her, weeping and weeping.
34. After going a little way the Thakurani fell into thought;
seeing [this] with their eyes, both weep.
35. Taking their hands, she says to the two: "Calm your minds;
go home, you two are my life.
36. Worship Sri Krishna with my blessing;
[and may it be granted to me] to reach Vrindavana without hindrance."
37. The Thakurani goes on her way with joy in her heart,
and the two, downcast, came home.
38. So she goes on, road after road, along the royal highway;
after some days she reached Mathura.
39. Having seen Krishna's birthplace and the place of Vishrama,⁴
the next day she goes on happily to Vrindavana.

40. With her eyes she saw all the kunjās of Vrindavana
and felt herself fortunate.
41. She came and stayed with Sri Jiva Gosani;
the Gosani bows down, deeming [it] his good fortune.
42. All heard of the Thakurani's arrival;
everyone came to see her.
43. Sri Gopala Bhatta Gosani and Lokanatha
came and, beholding her in person, bowed down.
44. The Thakurani showed great affection to all,
[though] she did not know anyone's name, did not recognize anyone.
45. Sri Jiva Gosani says to the Thakurani:
"Here is Gopala Bhatta, who came first;
46. here, see, before you is Lokanatha Gosani:
by Chaitanya's command he dwells in this place."
47. [They say:] "The Thakurani herself is the very form of Chaitanya;
you have mercifully granted us sight of you — we count it our good fortune."
48. [The Thakurani says:] "I have come to Vrindavana by the strength of the Prabhu's command;
may all of you likewise show me mercy.
49. When there is your mercy, every perfection is attained —
I have heard it from the lips of sadhus; of this I am certain."
50. The Thakurani says to Lokanatha Gosani:
"You whose disciple is Narottama are renowned in the world.
51. I count myself blessed to have seen him;
such are his virtues — and on him is your mercy.
52. What service of Krishna, what service of the Vaishnavas,
what righteous conduct, what establishing of dharma!
53. In the three worlds I have not heard of nor seen anyone [like him];
seeing him, my heart was filled with great joy.
54. It seems to me he is prema embodied;
not in vain is his name Thakura Mahashaya.
55. Apart from you he knows nothing else in body or mind;
blessed in the three worlds is he who has such a servant."
56. The Thakurani says to Gopala Bhatta:
"How wondrous are the ways of your disciple's disciple!
57. Ramachandra and Narottama are one life;
seeing them both, my mind rejoiced.
58. As is the disciple Srinivasa, so is his servant;
I have seen that all of them are worthy vessels, deliverers of the fallen."
59. One with so many virtues, heard of from the Thakurani's own lips —
boundless is the joy of honouring them with praise.
60. Having taken shelter at the feet of this Thakurani,
by her command I write, without fear.

61. I write by the strength of the command — I have no understanding of my own;
again and again she told me to write all this.
62. [I said:] "My only need is sadhana and remembrance;
what gain is there in leaving that and taking to description?"
63. Many faults come to light in description;
this happens, and moreover writing gives rise to disputes over doctrine.
64. From this come offences; no one accepts [what is written]:
seeing what is written, they say otherwise of it.
65. From this come offences," say the mahajanas.
[But] there is fear if one disregards the guru's command.
66. If what I write should prove otherwise [than it should be],
let all the sadhus weigh it in their minds.
67. Those of whom I write by the guru's command,
I know, all people praise when the truth is determined.
68. Those who are dear to Gauranga, and those dear to them —
what their thoughts are cannot be understood.
69. Let no one feel disbelief at this:
what I hear, that I write — such is my intent.
70. And if anyone says: "This is not according to the shastras" —
mightiest of all is that in which the guru's command lies.
71. If anyone does not accept these essential words —
I have no capacity to write this.
72. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the fifteenth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. Kasundi, a Bengali mustard relish.
 2. The couplet is found only in the 1913 edition; the sense of the first line is unclear.
 3. A variant given in both editions: "drawing me here, you have caused [me] so much sorrow", i.e. apparently the sorrow of the coming separation.
 4. Vishrama ghat in Mathura.
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Vilasa 16. Instructions on Sadhana; Jahnava in Vrindavana

The author on himself and on Jahnava's command to write; a discourse on sadhana, the guru and discipleship, on those living in an ashrama and renunciants; Jahnava's journey to Vrindavana: her conversation with Rupa about the Gosvamis, the reading of the Dana-keli-kaumudi, Madanamohana's command to send an image of Radha; Jahnava at Radha-kunda with Raghunatha Dasa and the Kaviraja; farewell to the Gosvamis; instructions on the road about Vaishnavas' remnants and about celibacy; the return to Khanda and the author's first meeting with Srinivasa; Chaitanya Dasa the Auliya brings news from Vrindavana of how Gopala Bhatta received word of Srinivasa's marriage

1. Glory, glory to Gaurachandra, glory to Nityananda!
Glory to Advaitachandra, glory to the devotees of Gaura!
2. Glory to Gaurasundara, the life of Gadadhara!¹
Glory, glory to the Lord of Sri Jahnava's life!
3. Glory to the devotees of Gauranga — [his] embodiments!
Glory, glory to Virachandra, who bears the form of prema!
4. Hoping for those two feet that grant fearlessness,
I, whom the holy lips commanded to be called Nityananda Dasa, [write].
5. When Sri Gauranga helps, everything comes to pass:
whatever command is given to anyone, that is fulfilled.
6. I lived in Khanda, the only son of my father and mother;²
I did not know how much happiness there is in Gauranga's lila.
7. For what merit did the Thakurani herself show me mercy?
Wherever she goes, I go with her.
8. "By what merit will Gaura's prema remain on earth?" —
twice, in revelation,³ she herself said [to me]:
9. "[I think of] how prema will fare when I am no longer here;
otherwise all will be in vain — so I thought in my heart.
10. Narottama and Srinivasa bear the form of prema;
you will see their manifestation — describe it with joy in your heart."
11. However many commands were given to me, the lowly one,
all that I write — what I was commanded.
12. In great fear I lay before the Prabhu's feet
all that I describe by Gauranga's grace.⁴
13. There was the Thakurani's command to take up the description;
holding fast to the strength of the command, I have no fear in my heart.
14. As is Gauranga's command, so is the Thakurani:
seating me, she herself told [everything] in order.
15. I, the lowly one, write on paper in three ways;⁵
setting all that out at length [...].
16. My obeisance to the hearers, the devotees of Krishna;
I have no power to describe.

17. The learned in books write while beholding the lilas;
who it is that describes in a book — who knows that?
18. What I write in the book has no breadth;
my only strength is the command of the holy lips.
19. Let him who has need of it listen;
if it is disregarded, there will be no grief in my heart.⁶
20. He who is the maker of all, renouncing all,
revealed his mercy by himself practising [the dharma].⁷
21. Sri Rupa Gosani and all his companions,
practising renunciation, dwelt in Vrindavana.
22. The dharma and conduct they describe in their books —
that dharma became the means of attaining Krishna.
23. Sri Rupa's disciple Jiva is full of the same raga:
by the strength of his command [people] in Vrindavana renounce works.
24. The disciple of Dasa Gosani is the Kaviraja,
whose descriptions are proclaimed throughout the world.⁸
25. To the disciples of the two Gosanis two tasks were given:
"Living at home, practise renunciation" — this is the command —
26. "serving Krishna and serving the Vaishnavas in Gauda,
establish that dharma for living beings."⁹
27. This is my plea — hear, O Merciful One;
all the Vaishnava gosanis have hearts full of compassion.
28. He who has taken shelter at the feet dear to Krishna's Beloved
has the right to such bhajana.
29. All Radha's companions gave up household duties;
transgressing the shastras, they became devoted to the service of Krishna.
30. Living at home, they forsook their husbands, [defying] their elders,
and always surrender their bodies to the lilas with Krishna.¹⁰
31. For Krishna's happiness they gave up everything —
all the shastras proclaim it again and again.
32. One who is perfected has actions full of Krishna's radiance;
outwardly and inwardly his mind is such.
33. Whatever sadhana, whatever deeds he performs —
all accept his words and deeds as [those of] a mahajana.
34. Whom shall I call perfected in sadhana?
Of that I write; listen with attention.
35. The gopas¹¹ and mahantas, all Chaitanya's companions —
they are perfected; in others this is impossible.
36. All the Thakuranis, very dear to Chaitanya,
and the twenty-four sannyasis — I know them to be the same.
37. The sadhus tell of the way they worshipped —
if only I could enter into it with my own mind!

38. [Mahaprabhu] gave no mantra initiation — the Prabhu knows all;
yet Gauranga is pleased at heart when sadhana is practised.
39. See how eagerly the Prabhu desires it;
how many such devotees shall I write of?
40. And what he teaches his own devotees,
told in few syllables, awakens everything.
41. Then — what is the way of the sadhana to be practised:
all those forms of sadhana originate in the Bhagavata.
42. The means of attaining Krishna's feet, [hitherto] unattained —
such is the Vaishnava's goal and need.
43. The doings of one who is perfected cannot be told:
at times he thinks himself a practitioner, at times he is like an ordinary being.
44. All the shastras speak of his humility and meekness;
all the Vaishnavas savour them with their own lips.
45. There are two kinds: those in an ashrama and those beyond the ashramas;
what are the custom and conduct between them?¹²
46. Who speaks of the view of the mahajanas of old?
Not knowing those views, they expound otherwise.
47. For self-protection they speak of them otherwise;
by nature they say otherwise — whereby all is ruined.
48. Even one who lives in an ashrama does not become otherwise:
his deeds and conduct the Gosani has described.
49. This is what is called acting from a prior intention;
they say one thing and do another — it cannot be understood.
50. The reason is that they are bound to children and the rest;¹³
all those pleasures they take as happiness.
51. The Gosani has set out the limbs of sadhana at length;
without independence [from the world] they cannot be practised.
52. "Every effort for Krishna's sake, looking to [His] mercy"¹⁴ —
if [this is done] with one's family and there is joy in the mind, [it is well].
53. But if one is dependent, there is no bhakti or bhajana;
if one neglects [the world], fear rises ceaselessly in the mind
54. [lest] someone else should say something of good and bad —
and so they do all that is forbidden.
55. "I am an adhikari" — so he prides himself;
he performs ritual works and has no thought of bhajana.
56. "Serve Krishna: what comes of making disciples?" —
the Gosani's words in the shastras do not say so.¹⁵
57. He wrote of the adhikari with regard to Vaishnavas;
why do they not understand this and vainly boast?
58. Adhikaris are of the highest, middling and lowest kind;
each one's order and qualities are all described.

59. The adhikari of all the rasas is Chaitanya Gosani;
he is the guru of the world, there is no other equal to him.
60. Whatever the love in his worship may be,
the shastras describe [its] abode and object.¹⁶
61. How many disciples did he himself initiate with a mantra?
Say, what do the shastras write — who knows this?
62. By his mercy the world became pure —
so the shastras write, so all the mahajanas sing.
63. Each branch that he appointed of old —
the mercy of those mahantas is very hard to discern.
64. Not making many disciples has a certain purpose:
by this his mercy is recognized in every way.
65. He on whom his mercy rests is prema embodied;
who has the power to tell his virtues?
66. Someone, not understanding, will find fault with this;
he does not know the heart of that dharma, in which is what is essential and what is not.
67. Further I shall say: the guru is the very form of Chaitanya;
his mercy is by nature most wondrous.
68. Why, having made a disciple, does [he] not know prema-bhakti?
Among [the disciples] there are devotees, but not firm of mind.
69. A disciple and servant by prior intention is a jewel;¹⁷
in no way will he perish, not for a moment.
70. Whatever dharma the acharya practises,
that dharma the disciple too will establish.
71. He himself does one thing and speaks at length [of another];
the acharya says what is not in his heart.
72. He has no attachment to Krishna, the guru or the Vaishnavas,¹⁸
yet on his own he zealously establishes dharma.
73. On this I shall write no more words:
he is not perfected himself, yet wants to make [others perfect].
74. Bearing such a body, one takes shelter at the guru's feet;
some attain [the fruit], others have no understanding.
75. If with body, mind and speech one takes shelter in dharma,
all the acts of bhajana that there are
76. come to perfection on this path through body, mind and speech;
but he does not know this — from what, how, and what comes about.
77. What to do with the mind, what conduct to keep in deeds,
what to do with speech, and in what way —
78. the work of these three is always worldly business;
he does one thing and says another, as if he had a perfected body.
79. And by whatever means he sets himself up:
"I am perfected — is there anyone equal to me?" —

80. in this body the toil and the way of sadhana
are according to the shastras, I say again and again.
81. In the mind Krishna, with the body the guru, in speech the Vaishnavas:
he who knows this — to him comes such realization.
82. When body and mind help and speech is one with them,
then, if [he] writes [anything], I see no fault in it.
83. One whose speech is fettered and whose ears do not hear —
how is he to know what should and should not be done?
84. Grown like a senseless thing, where will he not wander!
From such an offence only by good fortune is anyone saved.
85. "What I shall gain by sadhana" — this he knows in his mind;
the author of the book writes this with reason and without.¹⁹
86. The living being, in the company of worldly people, knows [only] himself;
the pain of offences does not hold him back.
87. He who with true understanding follows the dharma of Krishna
will not debate what the guru has commanded.
88. To know that the dharma of the Vaishnavas is always the same —
in such a person prema-bhakti is born in the heart.
89. To know in one's own mind, "[My] conduct is not such,"
and always to listen to the shastras and the words of sadhus.
90. "After enjoying worldly things and family life for some days,
at the end I shall give up everything and become detached" —
91. such is the conduct he prescribes for those in an ashrama;
[but] the command of Sri Dasa Gosani is the essence of all:
92. all wretched pleasures he cast off like filth;
I see no other such adhikari anywhere.
93. He gave up worldly life, [holding to] the essence — Chaitanya's feet;²⁰
his deeds and conduct are like a line carved in stone.
94. I shall tell one more thing — listen, my mind:
the hearts of others cannot enter into this.
95. When my Thakurani went to Vrindavana,
I had the wish to go with her feet.
96. I asked her, and she showed me mercy;
I go with her, and great joy arose in my heart.
97. She goes along the roads, the royal highway — I know no hardship;
I, worthless, extol this mercy of the Prabhu.²¹
98. On the day she arrived in Vrindavana,
her mind was overflowing with prema, she was aware of nothing.
99. Hundreds of streams flowed from her eyes;
she came and stayed at the kunja of Sri Rupa Gosani.²²
100. How much love the Gosani showed on receiving the Thakurani!
He went with her himself and showed her everything.

101. All the Gosanis, gathering together,
showed her which lila [took place] at which spot.
102. She sees Govinda, Gopinatha, Madanamohana;
she sees them with her eyes, and her mind overflows with bhava.
103. Preparing provisions, they held a great festival;
all the Gosanis sat down and ate.
104. With my sinful eyes I saw all those forms;
I sense that [their] form is like Gauranga's.
105. Hearing the words of those lips, the heart breaks;
what I saw with my eyes — who can count it?²³
106. One day the Thakurani, sitting in the kunja,
seated Rupa Gosani and says something to him:
107. "Sanatana, Lokanatha, Gopala Bhatta —
tell me what virtues each of them has."
108. The Gosani speaks — and I am sitting right there —
and, smiling a little, he began to tell their virtues:
109. "Sanatana is my elder [brother], like a Prabhu to me;
what can I, lowest of beings, say of his virtues?"
110. From him is my learning, he shows me great mercy.
Lokanatha is deeply detached, his mind utterly pure;
111. his renunciation is severe, he lives without a companion,
he is very dear to Chaitanya, a seasoned pandita.
112. Here, see, is Gopala Bhatta, endowed with every virtue;
he is my close friend, Gaura is his life.
113. Bhugarbha Acharya is unequalled in virtues,
the most beloved disciple of Gadadhara Pandita.
114. All of them together are kind to me through my tie to the Prabhu;
they love me, [though] there is not a trace of virtue in me.
115. Thakurani! What shall I say of myself?
Who in the world is as low as I?"
116. Hearing his words, the Thakurani says:
"I know for certain: you are Chaitanya's shakti.
117. I have come here to see you;
in passing I have seen Vrindavana with my eyes.
118. What books on the lilas have you composed?
Let me hear them and gladden my mind."
119. [He named:] "The Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu, the Vidagdha-madhava,
the Dana-keli-kaumudi and the Lalita-madhava."
120. The Thakurani asked: with what intent,
in what way and in what order is the description in them?
121. "In the Bhagavata there is no description of that lila;²⁴
my mind longs to hear it."

122. All the Gosanis came and sat together;
the Thakurani asked about the contents of the book.
123. As soon as she spoke, the Gosani understood everything;
whoever hears [it], the pain of his heart goes away.
124. The Gosani went himself and brought the book;
Jiva, sitting on a seat, began to read.
125. The Thakurani listens, her mind overflowing with bhava;
all the Gosanis together listen.
126. Radha and her friends, gathering together,
are going along carrying golden vessels²⁵ on their heads,
127. on their heads fresh butter, kshirsa,²⁶ curd, milk and cream;
on both sides are paths among the kunjās, her friends are with her.
128. Krishna himself came there and demands a toll:
"What are you carrying on your head? Pay the toll, Radha!"
129. Laughter, jests, banter — all the friends together;
Krishna by force ate it all.
130. Radhika says: "Krishna, let me ask you:
since when have you become king in the kunjās of Vrindavana?"
131. Lalita says: "Krishna, I shall bring it all out
when I go before King Kāndarpa."²⁷
132. Radhika says: "I am the daughter of Vrishabhānu;
do I not know that your father is Nanda?"
133. You herd the cows in the forest and play the flute,
you plunder the gopis' curd and milk and eat it.
134. Laying your hand on a gopi's body, you say all sorts of things;
all your sport will be over when the king hears of it."
135. "Why be ashamed any more, Radha? Shall I forget [my] victory?" —
[and Krishna], offended, went into the kunja.²⁸
136. He played the flute with the sweetest sound;
hearing it, Radha and the gopis lose ear and mind.
137. Coming to herself, Radhika says to Lalita:
"Who in the three worlds is dearer to Krishna [than I]?"
138. Lalita says: "I know this well:
you are Krishna's beloved, praised everywhere."
139. Hearing this, Vishakha says: "It seems to me
that no one is as dear [to him] as the flute:
140. it always drinks the nectar of Krishna's lips;
hearing its sound, the gopis lose their lives."
141. Hearing these words, Radha says to Vishakha:
"Leaving this body, I shall be born as a flute!
142. I shall go where the wish-fulfilling tree of Govardhana stands:
there it fulfils all desires."

143. Hearing Sri Rupa's exposition, the Thakurani sits
and, in the transformations of bhava, weeps and rolls on the ground.
144. What shall I say of the sweetness, who can tell it?
In every syllable is the substance of prema.
145. The words of those lips surpass the kokila;
as one listens, life itself goes out.
146. Thus some days pass in Vrindavana;
on another day she went to see Madanamohana.
147. Madanamohana, a beautiful form bent in three places;
the dance of his brows mocks the bow of Kama.
148. The Thakurani beholds him and ponders in her mind:
"The Thakurani²⁹ is not at his left — there is no joy [in this]."
149. Whenever she goes to see him, she thinks:
"There is no Thakurani at his left" — so she ponders.
150. Who knows what is in her mind?
The mind is known to Madanamohana, the Indweller.
151. That very night Madanamohana, smiling, says:
"What are you pondering, Jahnava? Sit down and tell me at last.
152. Go to your country, think of nothing else in your mind:
all that you have resolved in your mind will be fulfilled.
153. Bringing forth one lovely image,
make it tall," he says in detail.³⁰
154. "Come quickly and unite [her] with me;
then the wish will be fulfilled, the desire accomplished.
155. Do not grieve in your mind — all will be well everywhere;
that is all I have to say from my heart.
156. From today I shall watch for your road:
when will the Thakurani come and bring about the union?"
157. Rising, the Thakurani ponders within herself:
how and by what means will the Thakura's command be fulfilled?
158. Her heart was in turmoil, she says nothing;
grief arose in her mind — who could bear it?
159. The next day she says to all the Gosanis:
"I shall go to see Radha-kunda and come back in three days."³¹
160. All agreed: "Only do not delay."
Knowing [that] separation [comes] after such happiness — what is the heart to do?
161. In the morning the Thakurani went to the bank of the Kunda;
seeing it, she grew somewhat calmer at heart.
162. Raghunatha Dasa Gosani was sitting [there];
the Thakurani came to him there.
163. When he prostrated himself, the Thakurani addressed him:
"My mind longed to see you."

164. The Kaviraja³² came there and bowed down [to her];
in many ways he showed her honour.
165. Sitting there in talk of Krishna,
having circumambulated the Kunda, she stayed at that place.
166. One day, at the end of the night, she is sitting;
some bhava came into her mind — she rises, laughing.
167. I made a plea at the Prabhu's feet:³³
"Tell this poor man something of the glory of the Kunda."
168. "Good, good," she said to me:
"Listen to the lila with a pure mind.
169. This Vrindavana exists for the lila of Radha and Krishna;
the place, Krishna and the lila — all three are equal.
170. Above all, this Kunda is Radhika's lake;
here is the wondrous lila of Krishna's Beloved."
171. With her holy lips she told of the midday [lila];
as she tells it, she floats in the happiness of the bliss of prema.
172. Again I made a plea at the Prabhu's feet:
"I long to hear more — tell it in your mercy.
173. Krishna is eternal, the place is eternal, [so are] all the beloveds —
how and by whom are they attained?" — [and she] explains.
174. "Be attentive at heart, so that there is no offence:
at which place which lila, what is [its] order.
175. All Krishna's lilas cannot be grasped;
if one reads Rupa's books, everything is in them.
176. If one does not read, one hears from the guru's lips;
hearing from the lips of one full of faith, [one gains] a firm mind.
177. Day and night is the lila of Radha and Krishna in Vrindavana;
at which place which lila — keep that in mind.
178. In Vrindavana Radha and Krishna sport ceaselessly;
this eternal lila is perceptible to no one.
179. This lila is parakiya,³⁴ its ways are wondrous;
the sakhis know it, it is perceptible to no one [else]."
180. [I said:] "There is a doubt in my heart;
if you permit, tell [me of it] in your mercy."
181. She was most gracious to my mind's wish to ask;
[I say:] "With your holy lips you said that all this is Vrindavana.
182. [But] from Vrindavana to the bank of the Kunda, I have heard, is eight kroshas,
and from there two kroshas to the best of hills,³⁵ I know;
183. from here to Sanketa the distance is eight kroshas,³⁶
two kroshas to Nandishvara, as all sing;
184. Javata is one krosha from there;
[yet the lila requires] coming and going within one danda.

185. How then do the sakhis travel?
How do those who have taken shelter with them travel?
186. For many days my mind has wished to hear this;
otherwise what is a sadhaka to hear?"³⁷
187. In her mercy she says: "Listen, Nityananda Dasa,
about all those places where Krishna ever sports.
188. The structure of Vrindavana is like a lotus;
so Mahaprabhu established it in the words of the shastras.
189. It is manifest in two ways, closed and open:
in sport [Vrindavana] closes, in the lila it spreads out.
190. In this way all the comings and goings take place;
such too is the state of mind of those who have taken shelter with them.
191. This happens by the power of Yogamaya:
the one who goes notices nothing."
192. [I asked:] "What then will be the conduct of the perfected?
Who else will show me such mercy [as to explain]?"
193. "This lila is the eternal Krishna and the eternal associates;
and further, the eternally perfected, the perfected by sadhana and the perfected by mercy."³⁸
194. Mahaprabhu is that same Krishna, the son of the king of Vraja;
all his associates are his eternal company.
195. It is of these eternal associates that I spoke:
they have no shelter at a guru's feet, no taking of mantras and the like.
196. Each merely holds the power of his own yutha;³⁹
to behold the lila and to serve — that is the mind of them all.⁴⁰
197. But one who practises sadhana [walks] the path of the perfected:
the sadhana of a Vaishnava — I have said — accords with it."
198. "How will a Vaishnava reach perfection by sadhana?
In your mercy tell me all of it in detail."
199. "With your own limbs keep the limbs of sadhana:
Rupa has written of many limbs, by which one is perfected.
200. Come — I shall have you hear it from his own lips;
how much joy you will have in hearing it!
201. He bears the mercy that is Chaitanya's own power;
by that power he unfolded [the teaching] in hundreds of thousands [of lines] of books.
202. Having described [sadhana], Rupa took it up [himself]
and established that dharma everywhere.
203. Seeing this, all his companions came;
he gave [them] Vrindavana, the land granted by Chaitanya.
204. If one sits and listens to his humility
and keeps [it] in the heart, prema for Krishna grows firm."
205. Hearing this, [I] bowed down, falling to the ground;
the Thakurani raised me and placed her foot on my head.

206. The next day, [preparing] to leave the bank of the Kunda,
she speaks to Raghunatha Dasa.
207. Taking his hand, she tells him all about herself:
"Only by the good fortune of many births can one see you."
208. The Kaviraja was sitting there too;
the Thakurani showed him great honour.
209. He says: "What shall I say? I do not know how to express humility;
give me Chaitanya's feet, O merciful one.
210. With longing I make my plea at your feet:
I beg that I, who have become so low, may attain Gaura's feet.
211. My life has passed without sadhana — what sadhana am I to do?
[Grant] that day and night I may not forget such feet."
212. The Thakurani weeps, holding Raghunatha's hand;
[Raghunatha says:] "Know Raghunatha as your own servant.
213. I was born in a worldly man's house — I feel shame and fear:
for what merit will [Chaitanya] give his feet that grant fearlessness?
214. Not for a single day have I served [his] feet,
and still I beg for those feet — such a wretch am I."
215. The Thakurani says: "Stop embarrassing me;
by your humility purify my mind.
216. I, a poor wretch, have not touched even a word of prema-bhakti;
I do not know why the Creator gave me birth.
217. That I may see you all again
and my wish be fulfilled — show me mercy."
218. Bowing down to the Kunda, she prays:
"Grant me a dwelling on your bank — this is my wish."
219. Thus, taking leave at that place,
making Raghunatha weep, she goes away weeping herself.
220. From there, coming to Vrindavana, to the Gosani's kunja,
she sat down and told about all the kundas.
221. Within two days she met everyone in the same way;
she went and saw Madana-gopala.
222. At night the Thakurani and the Gosani sit together:
"What are the sixty-four limbs of bhakti you have described in your book?
223. How is their order to be kept in worship?
How [is one to gain] attachment to them so that there is no offence?"
224. The Gosani, sitting, explains everything in detail;
the Thakurani listens and rejoices at heart.
225. The next day the Thakurani, gathering all the Gosanis,
told them that she was going back to her country.
226. Hearing it, all the Gosanis grieved at heart:
"Why blame the Creator? [Better] to give up our lives."

227. All together they go to see Madanamohana
and behold with their eyes the form bent in three places.
228. [The Thakurani prays:] "Give me leave to go to my country" —
and the flower garland slipped from his holy body.
229. The pujari brought it and put it into the Thakurani's hands;
bowing down, she places it round her own neck.
230. "Give me leave to come back soon and see [your] feet again,"
the Thakurani prays again and again.
231. In this way she came back to her lodging;
such companionship is broken by ill fate.
232. Morning came, the time of parting arrived;
each one tells what is in his heart.
233. All the Gosanis together walk along with her;
how many waves of separation arose then!
234. Having seen Govinda, she took her leave;
standing still, the Thakurani began to speak:
235. "I long to see you;
and amid such happiness the Creator has put grief into my heart.
236. All of you, in your mercy, fulfil my desire:
[grant] that I may soon come back and see [your] feet again."
237. Sanatana Gosani says with humility:⁴¹
"What mercy will you show me, so wicked-minded?"
238. You have the power to give Chaitanya's feet;
[but my] time has passed without sadhana, my life is fruitless."
239. The Thakurani says: "Restrain your humility;
I always long for your merciful glance."
240. Rupa says, looking into the Thakurani's eyes:
"Look [kindly] on me and grant me Gauranga's feet."
241. Lokanatha says: "There is none more helpless than I;
for what merit will Gauranga show me mercy?"
242. You are supremely merciful, happy in prema for Gaura;
prema has not touched me — I was born to sorrow."
243. What grief, what pain everyone felt!
What grief each had in his heart, he alone knows.
244. The Thakurani says: "Listen, all of you,
and fulfil the wish of my heart:
245. be merciful — [let me] see you again;
when shall I ever have such a state again?
246. Coming to Vrindavana, I shall see you with my eyes."
Weeping and weeping, they all go their ways.
247. Afterwards Rupa came and makes a request:
"Send Srinivasa Acharya to Vrindavana."

248. The Thakurani says: "Srinivasa is in his own country;
in such a vessel [the Lord] will at last keep Gaura's prema.
249. I shall surely go and seek him out
and soon send him to Vrindavana."
250. Saying this, the Thakurani set out;
on the road each one speaks of everyone's virtues, as is in his heart.
251. One day on the road I made a plea at [her] feet:
"By what means may I obtain the remnants [of food] of the Vaishnavas?
252. The water that has washed [a Vaishnava's] feet has great power for sadhana;
tell me, Thakurani, all about this."
253. The Thakurani says: "My son, what you have asked —
how to have faith in it and what comes of doing it:
254. touching a Vaishnava's feet, drinking the water from his feet,
a Vaishnava's food remnants — this is a secret teaching.
255. Keeping it secret, one should have faith in it;
[then] the highest bhajana shows itself in the body.
256. One should serve a Vaishnava who is foremost in virtues
in such a way that he does not know — knowing his mind.
257. One should not [ask] the Vaishnava to lift it up and give it himself;
there is no gain in that, but great harm.
258. If one practises sadhana for gain — and this happens everywhere —
it is not according to the words of old: such sadhana perishes.
259. There is the command of Mahaprabhu's holy lips — that is the essence;
for whoever will not accept it there is no other word.
260. By the Prabhu's command no one took the water from [his] feet;
[if] an intimate devotee took it, it pained him.
261. Some took it by a ruse so that the Prabhu did not know;
Mahaprabhu forbade [this] to Govinda.⁴²
262. Kalidasa Mahashaya, full of faith,
took the foot-water of Vaishnavas of every land⁴³
263. and took the food remnants of all; the Prabhu knew this
and sang his virtues with his own lips.
264. One day, as [the Prabhu] was washing his feet at the Lion Gate,
he began to drink [the water] handful after handful.
265. He drank three handfuls — and the Prabhu spoke;
[the Prabhu] was alarmed and let him drink no more.
266. Gaura is an ocean of prema, [yet] there was fear in his heart:
this is not fitting with regard to a sadhaka.
267. If it is given to another, how will he gain by it?
Gauranga's word is the firmest proof.
268. Only the guru, out of mercy, may give [it] to a disciple:
this word the shastras do not forbid."

269. Thus the Thakurani travelled back along the road;
so much prema for Krishna — and her mind joyful.
270. One day the Thakurani commanded me:
"Do not marry, my son, heed my word.
271. The mahajanas write that worldly life is the deadly kalakuta poison;
who would call it nectar?
272. The heart bewitched by maya forgets everything;
one practises a thousand [kinds of] sadhana — all goes for nothing.
273. [The mahajanas] write which deeds hinder bhakti;
if you disregard this, everyone will laugh at you.
274. Detachment comes [only] by the power of Krishna's mercy;
to attain [it] one takes shelter at the feet of Sri Guru.
275. Some attain it in this body, some in another body;
why then do thorns spring up in the heart from time to time?
276. He who is worthy becomes perfected by sadhana;
to him are revealed the bhava [and] qualities of those he aspires to.⁴⁴
277. The Vaishnava gosanis, my son, are Krishna's associates;
towards them one should be at heart simply free of pride.
278. As is the guru, so is Krishna, and so are the Vaishnavas;
if there is gain [in you], you will feel it.
279. Some accept the bhakti of a Vaishnava,
while others regard him as lesser: 'I am the guru.'
280. He whose mind is like that and who reasons so
will never receive the guru's mercy.
281. In seeing and hearing [Vaishnavas] many virtues arise in the mind,
if there is realization and one reflects in one's mind."
282. In this way the Thakurani went to her country;
hearing of it, Virachandra Raya came to see her.
283. On the day the Thakurani stayed at Khanda
there was so much joy that the eyes could not contain it.
284. On that very day the Prabhu⁴⁵ came to that place;
prostrating himself, he makes many requests.
285. He asked about all the joy of Vrindavana;
as she told it, the Thakurani was overcome.
286. Narahari, Sri Mukunda and Sri Raghunandana
float in bliss; none of them has outward awareness.⁴⁶
287. The Thakurani says: "Narahari, hear my word:
who is this Srinivasa? Send him to Vrindavana."
288. In the morning, taking her leave, she went home;
Narahari and the others then departed.
289. I had the command: "My son, go to your own home;
what I have commanded, keep in your heart.

290. Stay always happily in their company;
they will do what will be of help to me.
291. When you go anywhere, go with people;
and at times stay joyfully with me."
292. The Thakurani went away, and I stay in this place;
and this is what happened with him⁴⁷ in the days that followed.
293. One day there came with Narahari a certain person
named Srinivasa, a jewel among men.
294. I saw with my eyes: the boy is very handsome;
Raghunandana and the others were overjoyed.
295. The Thakurani⁴⁸ asked: "In what village do you live?"
"I live in Chakhandi; my mother and father are there."
296. "Good, my son, go to Vrindavana:
this is Sri Rupa's command — carry it out.
297. The Thakurani went to Vrindavana;
a few days ago she came back home.
298. She spoke to me about you:
there is Gauranga's command — do not break it."
299. That day I saw Srinivasa with my own eyes;
as he was commanded, so it came to light.
300. I have written of his virtues — the command is strong;
what I told before, of that there will be an account later.
301. A disciple of my Thakurani is Sri Chaitanya Dasa,
known everywhere as the Auliya.⁴⁹
302. He went from his country to Vrindavana;
in the rapture of prema he wanders day and night.
303. One day he went to Sri Gopala Bhatta;
seeing his state, [Gopala Bhatta] rose to greet him.
304. He asked for good news from the homeland;
the Gosani asks again and again:
305. "You yourself know — I shall ask you one thing:
do you know Srinivasa Acharya?
306. And Thakura Mahashaya lives at Garerhat;
speak, speak — let my heart rejoice in hearing."
307. What he knew, what he had heard, what was said of whom —
all of it he relates, just as things stood:
308. the Gosani sits and listens to it all from him;
he says a word — [and the Gosani] now and then breaks into a smile.
309. "My home is twelve kroshas from Vishnupura;
I live contentedly in the king's domain.
310. The Acharya's servant is King Sri Vira Hambira;
Srinivasa Acharya and the others are men of great depth.

311. The king has settled the Acharya in a village;
the village, lands, all the goods — all the king has given.
312. In this month of Phalguna he married";
and [the Auliya] told of his great merits.
313. "There are no children, are there?" said the Gosani;
[he] submitted: "I have heard that [his wife] has come of age."⁵⁰
314. "Garerhat is very far from there;
of Thakura Mahashaya I have heard much:
315. he has established the service of Gauranga [and held] a great festival;
he serves the Vaishnavas, having given up everything at home.
316. He is detached and renowned in the world;
more I do not know — I have told it plainly."
317. [The Gosani] fell silent and said no more;
again and again he speaks faltering words.
318. Thus, in the joy of beholding Vrindavana,
after some days he came back at ease to his country.
319. Arriving, he came to Khanda
and told everything to Sri Raghunandana.
320. Likewise he went to the feet of the Ishvari⁵¹
and told of all the happiness of Vrindavana.
321. She asked in order about all the Gosanis;
as she listened, her joy kept growing.
322. Then he went again to the king's domain;
what he had seen he tells, and the king listens.
323. "How is Gosani-jiu?" [the king] asked;
[he] tells it once, and again relates it.
324. The king, with joined palms, bows down:
"When shall I have the good fortune to see [him] with my own eyes?"
325. With him the king goes to the Thakura;
the Thakura, receiving them warmly, sits [with him] on one seat.
326. The Auliya speaks, the Acharya listens;
hearing news of his own Prabhu, he rejoices in his mind.
327. "Did the Gosani ask anything about me?"
[He], smiling and smiling, tells everything in detail.
328. "In passing I said that you had taken a wife" —
[Srinivasa,] rising from his seat, prostrated himself.
329. Again he asks: "What did the Gosani say to that?"
[He] began to speak in faltering words.
330. Hearing this, the Thakura cries: "Alas, alas!
To whom shall I tell the fault of my misfortune?
331. Without the Prabhu's command I did such a thing;
[to ask] the Prabhu's command — misfortune prevented it."

332. Saying this, he weeps: "Alas, alas!
Shall I ever see that pair of feet again?
333. The Prabhu has turned merciless towards Srinivasa;
[yet] he is my Prabhu, in life and in death, for certain."
334. From that day his mind was troubled:
"What shall I say before the Prabhu?"
335. Listen, hearers, to what took place;
let no one be pained on hearing these words!
336. The eternally perfect, embodied prema of Chaitanya
was born on earth in the form of Srinivasa.
337. Even so there is great fear of the guru in his mind:
who but he would establish [proper] order?
338. Know for certain that he is Sri Rupa's shakti;
his mind is not like the mind of ordinary people.
339. What was said and what happened, so I write;
so I have always seen him — detached.⁵²
340. All that I have written in this book —
the Prabhu's feet are my sole refuge.
341. The support of my life is the word of the holy lips;
writing this, I carry out that command.
342. Whoever hears this with devotion,
the dust of his feet I bear [on my head].
343. He whose hope is the feet of Sri Jahnava and Virachandra,
Nityananda Dasa, tells the Prema-vilasa.

Thus ends the sixteenth vilasa of the Prema-vilasa.

1. In the 1999 edition the word is cut off ("gaura ..."), in the 1913 edition corrupt; the reading "Gaurasundara" is conjectural.
2. An autobiographical indication by the author: he came from Srikhanda (Khanda).
3. "pratyādeśa", a command given in a dream or vision.
4. A variant given in both editions: "all that I describe by Gauranga's command (pratyādeśa)".
5. A variant given in both editions: "I write on paper the thread of the command in three ways". The second line is damaged in both editions.
6. A variant given in both editions: "there is no grief in my heart — I submit".
7. Apparently of Mahaprabhu. A variant given in both editions: "revealed all, practising it himself".
8. Krishnadasa Kaviraja, author of the Chaitanya-charitamrita, disciple of Raghunatha Dasa Gosvami (Dasa Gosani). "ghoṣe", "is proclaimed".
9. That is, Srinivasa (disciple of Gopala Bhatta) and Narottama (disciple of Lokanatha) were to preach in Gauda while living as householders; cf. ch. 13.
10. A variant given in both editions: "out of longing [they] surrender their bodies to the lilas with Krishna".
11. The gopalas, apparently the twelve associates of Nityananda revered as cowherd boys of Vraja.
12. A variant given in both editions: "what is such a custom, and whose?" In 45–92 the author discusses how householders and renunciants ought to behave; many couplets of this discussion are obscure, and their translation is at places conjectural.
13. A variant given in both editions: "bound to those who have renounced everything".
14. Cf. Bhakti-rasamrita-sindhu 1.2.61 ff. (one of the limbs of sadhana: "every effort for Krishna's sake").
15. That is, the "Gosani" (Rupa or Jiva) does not reject the making of disciples; cf. 57–64.

16. "āśraya" and "viṣaya", the "abode" and the "object" of love (the devotee and Krishna) in the doctrine of rasa.
17. A variant given in both editions: "disciples by prior intention — they are all jewels".
18. A variant given in the 1913 edition: "he who has no bhakti for Krishna, the guru and the Vaishnavas".
19. "kāraṇākāraṇa", a stock phrase of the author (cf. ch. 13, 407); the sense here is unclear.
20. A variant given in both editions: "he gave up the unessential".
21. "The Prabhu" here and below (167, 172) is Jahnava herself.
22. Here and below Rupa Gosvami is shown alive and conversing with Jahnava, although earlier (chs. 12–13) the passing of Rupa and Sanatana was mentioned; cf. also ch. 15, 41, where Jahnava stays with Jiva.
23. A variant given in both editions: "having seen [that] form with one's eyes, how can one forget it?"
24. That is, the lila of the "toll" (dana-lila) described by Rupa in the Dana-keli-kaumudi.
25. "suvarṇa mukuṭa", literally "golden crowns"; perhaps a corruption of "maṭuki", "pots".
26. Kshirsa, thickened milk.
27. Kandarpa (Kama), the god of love; the gopis jokingly threaten to complain to the "king".
28. The speaker is not marked; the first line is obscure ("jite ki pāśari").
29. That is, Radha.
30. That is, an image of Radha for Madanamohana; according to tradition, Jahnava sent an image of Radha to Vrindavana. "pramāṇa kariha ucca", "make the measure tall".
31. So by sense; both editions have "tina jane", "the three of us".
32. Krishnadasa Kaviraja; his passing was told in ch. 13 — here he is again shown alive.
33. That is, to Jahnava; the author calls her his Prabhu.
34. Parakiya, love for another's wife (here Radha's and the gopis' love for Krishna), the highest form of madhurya-rasa in Gaudiya Vaishnava doctrine.
35. That is, to Govardhana.
36. Both editions have "eight"; a shorter distance would be expected.
37. A variant given in both editions: "what is a sadhaka to remember?"
38. "Nitya-siddha, sadhana-siddha, kripa-siddha", the three kinds of perfected associates of Krishna. In the 1913 edition the first word is garbled.
39. The yutha, a group of sakhis under one of Radha's principal friends.
40. A variant given in both editions: "longing, beholding and service — that is the mind of them all".
41. Here Sanatana, Rupa and Krishnadasa Kaviraja are all shown alive (cf. notes 22, 32).
42. Govinda, Mahaprabhu's servant at Puri (cf. Chaitanya-charitamrita, Antya 16).
43. Cf. the story of Kalidasa in the Chaitanya-charitamrita, Antya 16: he ate the food remnants of Vaishnavas, and at the Lion Gate (Simha-dvara) of the Jagannatha temple drank three handfuls of the water that had washed Mahaprabhu's feet. The 1913 edition has "svadeśi", "of his own land".
44. "tadātmaka", "one with them [in nature]"; the 1999 edition has "guṇa", the 1913 edition "gaṇa" ("associates"). The translation is conjectural.
45. That is, Virachandra.
46. Mukunda is apparently Mukunda Dasa, Raghunandana's father and Narahari's brother. Here Narahari is shown alive: the narrative goes back to the time before Srinivasa left for Vrindavana (cf. chs. 4–5).
47. That is, with Srinivasa.
48. So in both editions, although Jahnava had already left (cf. 292, 297); by sense the speaker is Narahari.
49. Auliya, "one mad [in God]", a holy fool. This Chaitanya Dasa is not the same person as Srinivasa's father.
50. "ṛtumatī haila", literally "has become capable of conceiving"; the sense of the exchange is conjectural.
51. That is, to Jahnava.
52. The sense of the second line is unclear.